6 UNITS · 58 LESSONS · ENGLISH TO FRENCH

Le français facile

Learn French

Book & Workbook

Easy French for English speakers, from your first sound to real conversations.



Aa Sounds & Letters	**é** Writing & Spelling	**Bon** First Words & Phrases	**le** Grammar Made Easy	**Ça** Everyday Conversations	**Lu** Reading & Culture

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to use this book

This book and the interactive web app at **learnfrench.zyeemzia.com** are the same course. Write and practise in the book; use the web app to hear every word and sentence, take quizzes, review words with flashcards and play games.

1. Listen first

Open the same lesson in the web app and tap each word to hear it. Copy the sound, not the spelling.

2. Read aloud

Say every example and sentence out loud. Your mouth learns French sounds faster than your eyes do.

3. Use a pencil

Use a pencil for quizzes and writing so you can erase and retry. Answers are at the end of each unit.

4. Little but daily

15 minutes a day, 5 days a week: two or three lessons a week. Steady beats fast.

3′	7′	3′	2′
Review the last lesson	New lesson	Read aloud & write	Quiz or flashcards

Learner's name .....

Start date ..... My goal .....

Pronunciation help: an easy English-style respelling is printed under every word.

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AT A GLANCE

Sounds & Letters

The 26 letters

Same letters as English, French names. Tap to hear each name.

A a **a** /ah/ ami friend	**B b** **bé** /bay/ bonjour hello	**C c** **cé** /say/ café coffee	**D d** **dé** /day/ dimanche Sunday	**E e** **e** /uh/ petit small	**F f** **effe** /ef/ fleur flower
G g **gé** /zhay/ gare station	**H h** **ache** /ahsh/ homme man	**I i** **i** /ee/ lit bed	**J j** **ji** /zhee/ jour day	**K k** **ka** /kah/ kilo kilo	**L l** **elle** /el/ lune moon
M m **emme** /em/ maman mum	**N n** **enne** /en/ nuit night	**O o** **o** /oh/ orange orange	**P p** **pé** /pay/ pomme apple	**Q q** **qu** /kew/ quatre four	**R r** **erre** /ehr/ rouge red
S s **esse** /es/ soleil sun	**T t** **té** /tay/ thé tea	**U u** **u** /ew/ une one, a	**V v** **vé** /vay/ vélo bike	**W w** **double vé** /doo-bluh VAY/ wifi Wi-Fi	**X x** **ixe** /eeks/ taxi taxi
Y y **i grec** /ee GREK/ yaourt yogurt	**Z z** **zède** /zed/ zéro zero				

Accents & joined letters

Small marks that change the sound or the meaning.

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É é	È è	Ê ê	Ë ë	À à	Â â
e accent aigu /ay/ café coffee	**e accent grave** /eh/ mère mother	**e accent circonflexe** /eh/ fête party	**e tréma** /eh/ Noël Christmas	**a accent grave** /ah/ voilà there it is	**a accent circonflexe** /ah/ gâteau cake

Ç ç	Î î	Ï ï	Ô ô	Û û	Ù ù
c cédille /s/ garçon boy	**i accent circonflexe** /ee/ île island	**i tréma** /ee/ maïs corn	**o accent circonflexe** /oh/ hôtel hotel	**u accent circonflexe** /ew/ sûr sure	**u accent grave** /oo/ où where

Ü ü	Ÿ ÿ	Œ œ	Æ æ
u tréma /ew/ capharnaüm a messy junk room	**y tréma** /ee/ L'Haÿ-les-Roses a town near Paris	**e dans l'o** /uh/ cœur heart	**e dans l'a** /ay/ et cætera and so on

Sound spellings

Letter teams that make one French sound.

ou	oi	eau · au	ai · ei	eu · œu	-er · -ez
ou /oo/ nous we	**oi** /wah/ trois three	**eau, au** /oh/ beau beautiful	**ai, ei** /eh/ lait milk	**eu, œu** /uh/ deux two	**-er, -ez** /ay/ parler to speak

an · en	in · ain	on · om	un · um	gn	ch
an, en, am, em /ahn/ enfant child	**in, im, ain, ein** /an/ pain bread	**on, om** /ohn/ bonbon sweet, candy	**un, um** /uhn/ lundi Monday	**gn** /ny/ montagne mountain	**ch** /sh/ chat cat

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qu	ph	-tion	ill	ui
qu	**ph**	**-tion**	**ill, -il**	**ui**
/k/	/f/	/syohn/	/y/	/wee/
qui who	photo photo	nation nation	fille girl, daughter	nuit night

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Aa

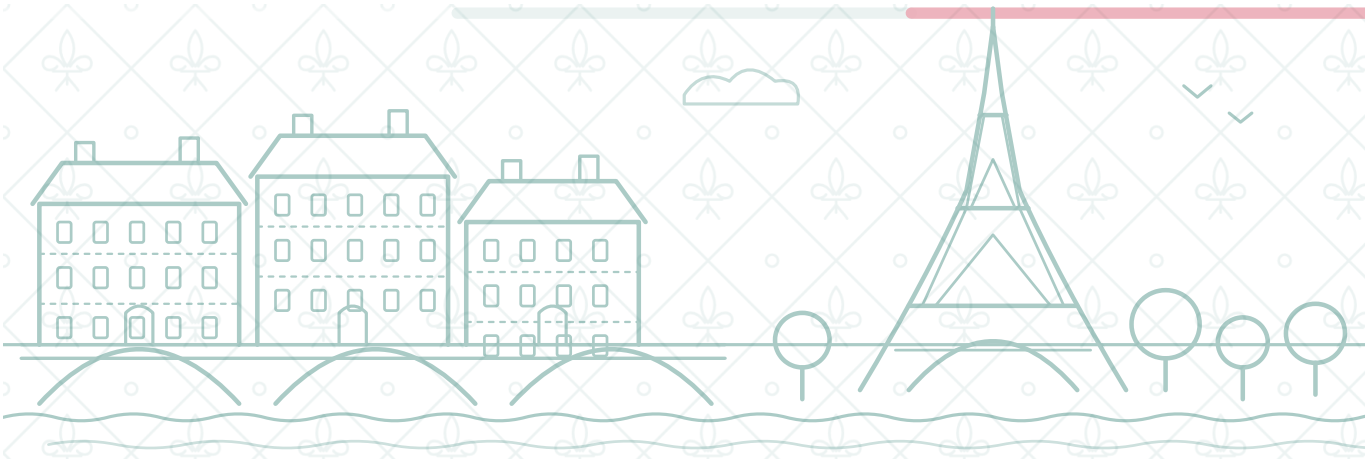
UNIT 1

Sounds & Letters

Hear, say and read French with confidence

1. How French Sounds
2. The French Alphabet
3. Vowels & Accents
4. Silent Final Letters
5. Nasal Vowels
6. The French R, U and OU
7. Sound Spellings
8. Liaison & Elision
9. Reading Lab

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UNIT 1 · LESSON 1 · 10 MINUTES

How French Sounds

Rhythm, stress and pure vowels

- Hear the smooth, even rhythm of French
- Put the stress at the end of a word group
- Read our easy respellings

Bienvenue! Welcome! Before learning words, let's tune your ears. French sounds smooth and flowing, like a gentle stream. Once you hear its rhythm, everything else gets easier.

Four golden rules

1 Even beats
Give every syllable about the same time: ca-fé, cho-co-lat. No syllable is swallowed.

2 Lean on the end
The last syllable of a word or a word group is a little longer. That's the French 'stress'.

3 Pure vowels
Keep each vowel clean and steady. café ends on a crisp 'ay', not 'ay-ee'.

4 Busy lips
French lips work hard: they smile for 'ee', round tightly for 'oo' and 'ew'.

Same word, different music

chocolat	chocolate
French: shoh-koh-LAH	**English: CHOK-lit**
Three even beats, the last one a little longer.	Strong first beat, the middle disappears.

Words you already know

hôtel	animal	important	restaurant
oh-TEL	ah-nee-MAHL	an-por-TAHN	res-toh-RAHN
hotel	animal	important	restaurant

Paris	téléphone
pah-REE	tay-lay-FON
Paris	telephone

In a sentence, French stresses only the **end of each word group**, not every word. Listen to how this flows as one long word:

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Bonjour, je m'appelle Léa.
bohn-ZHOOR, zhuh mah-pel lay-AH
Hello, my name is Léa. Two groups, two stresses: ZHOOR and AH.

Un café, s'il vous plaît.
uhn kah-FAY, seel voo PLEH
A coffee, please.

How to read our respellings

Respelling	Means	Example
CAPITALS	the stressed (slightly longer) syllable	merci = mehr-SEE
ew	French u: say 'ee' with round lips	tu = tew
uh	soft 'uh' with rounded lips	le = luh
zh	the s in 'measure'	jour = zhoor
ahn, ohn, an, uhn	nasal vowels: the n is NOT said	bon = bohn
r	French r, made in the throat	rouge = roozh

MEMORY TRICK

Imagine French as a wave that rises and lands at the end of each group: je voudrais un ca-FÉ. Ride the wave, land on the last beat!

DID YOU KNOW?

French is spoken on five continents, by more than 300 million people, from Paris to Montréal, Dakar and Tahiti.

Tap each word, listen, then say it with even beats and a longer last syllable.

merci

bonjour

chocolat

important

un café

s'il vous plaît

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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1. Where does French usually put the stress?

○ A) On the last syllable of a word group ○ B) On the first syllable of every word
○ C) On the longest word ○ D) On every second syllable

2. How should you say the vowel at the end of café?

○ A) 'ay' sliding into 'ee' ○ B) A clean, steady 'ay'
○ C) A long 'ee' ○ D) Silent

3. Which respelling fits chocolat?

○ A) CHOK-lit ○ B) shoh-koh-LAH
○ C) SHOH-koh-lah ○ D) choh-KOH-lat

4. In our respellings, what does 'ohn' mean?

○ A) 'oh' then a clear n ○ B) A long 'oo'
○ C) 'own' as in English ○ D) A nasal 'oh', with no real n

5. Listen. Which phrase do you hear? (listen in the web app: s'il vous plaît)

○ A) merci beaucoup ○ B) bonjour madame
○ C) s'il vous plaît ○ D) à bientôt

6. In Bonjour, je m'appelle Léa, which syllables carry the stress?

○ A) -jour and -a ○ B) bon- and je
○ C) je and -pelle ○ D) Every syllable equally

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UNIT 1 · LESSON 2 · 12 MINUTES

The French Alphabet

26 familiar letters with French names

- Say the names of the 26 letters
- Avoid the classic E/I and G/J traps
- Spell a word aloud in French

Good news: French uses the same 26 letters as English. Only the names are different. Tap each letter to hear its French name.

A to Z

A a	**a** /ah/ ami friend	B b	**bé** /bay/ bonjour hello
C c	**cé** /say/ café coffee	D d	**dé** /day/ dimanche Sunday
E e	**e** /uh/ petit small	F f	**effe** /ef/ fleur flower
G g	**gé** /zhay/ gare station	H h	**ache** /ahsh/ homme man
I i	**i** /ee/ lit bed	J j	**ji** /zhee/ jour day
K k	**ka** /kah/ kilo kilo	L l	**elle** /el/ lune moon
M m	**emme** /em/ maman mum	N n	**enne** /en/ nuit night
O o	**o** /oh/ orange orange	P p	**pé** /pay/ pomme apple
Q q	**qu** /kew/ quatre four	R r	**erre** /ehr/ rouge red
S s	**esse** /es/ soleil sun	T t	**té** /tay/ thé tea
U u	**u** /ew/ une one, a	V v	**vé** /vay/ vélo bike
W w	**double vé** /doo-bluh VAY/ wifi Wi-Fi	X x	**ixe** /eeks/ taxi taxi
Y y	**i grec** /ee GREK/ yaourt yogurt	Z z	**zède** /zed/ zéro zero

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The tricky ones

Letter	French name	Sounds like
E	e	uh
I	i	ee
G	gé	zhay
J	ji	zhee
H	ache	ahsh
R	erre	ehr
U	u	ew
W	double vé	doo-bluh VAY
Y	i grec	ee GREK

E and I swap

e

E = 'uh'

Soft, round lips. Not 'ee'!

i

I = 'ee'

Smiling lips. This is the English 'E' sound.

G and J swap

g

G = 'zhay'

Rhymes with 'day'.

j

J = 'zhee'

Rhymes with 'see'.

MEMORY TRICK

English speakers swap these pairs. Remember: **G**ay → 'zhay' (G rhymes with dAY), **J**ee → 'zhee'. And the French E is the shy 'uh', while I is the happy 'ee'.

Most letter names follow a pattern: vowel-like letters ending in 'ay' (bé, cé, dé, gé, pé, té, vé) and letters starting with 'e' (effe, elle, emme, enne, erre, esse).

Spelling aloud

People often ask Ça s'écrit comment ? (How is that spelled?). Then you spell letter by letter:

Léa : L, E accent aigu, A

el, uh ak-SAHN tay-GEW, ah

Léa: L, É, A

Paris : P, A, R, I, S

pay, ah, ehr, ee, es

Paris

deux L

duh el

double L (as in 'elle')

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TIP

For double letters, French says deux (two): deux L, deux S, deux M.

Spell these words aloud, letter by letter, using the French names.

ami

chat

jour

girafe

Québec

wifi

Quick quiz

QUIZ

7. What is the French name of the letter I?

- ○ A) eye
- ○ B) uh
- ○ C) ee
- ○ D) ay

8. Listen. Which letter is this? (listen in the web app: gé)

- ○ A) G
- ○ B) J
- ○ C) E
- ○ D) Z

9. Listen. Which letter is this? (listen in the web app: ji)

- ○ A) G
- ○ B) I
- ○ C) Y
- ○ D) J

10. What does the letter H sound like in a French word?

- ○ A) A breathy 'h'
- ○ B) Nothing: it is silent
- ○ C) Like 'sh'
- ○ D) Like a French r

11. How do you say 'double S' when spelling?

- ○ A) deux S
- ○ B) double esse
- ○ C) S S
- ○ D) deux double S

12. The French name of Y means...

- ○ A) Double i
- ○ B) Long u
- ○ C) Greek i
- ○ D) Why

13. Listen. Which letter is this? (listen in the web app: e)

- ○ A) I
- ○ B) E
- ○ C) A
- ○ D) U

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UNIT 1 · LESSON 3 · 12 MINUTES

Vowels & Accents

Small marks with big jobs

- Say the pure French vowels
- Tell é from è and ê
- Know what ç and the tréma do

French vowels are short, pure and steady. Accents are little helpers: some change the sound, some only change the meaning. Let's meet them.

Six key vowels

a	é	è	i
ah	ay	eh	ee
as in papa	as in été (summer)	as in mère (mother)	as in midi (noon)

o	u
oh	ew
as in vélo (bike)	as in tu (you)

The accents

É é — e accent aigu
/ay/
café coffee

È è — e accent grave
/eh/
mère mother

Ê ê — e accent circonflexe
/eh/
fête party

Ë ë — e tréma
/eh/
Noël Christmas

À à — a accent grave
/ah/
voilà there it is

Â â — a accent circonflexe
/ah/
gâteau cake

Ç ç — c cédille
/s/
garçon boy

Î î — i accent circonflexe
/ee/
île island

Ï ï — i tréma
/ee/
maïs corn

Ô ô — o accent circonflexe
/oh/
hôtel hotel

Û û — u accent circonflexe
/ew/
sûr sure

Ù ù — u accent grave
/oo/
où where

Œ œ — e dans l'o
/uh/
cœur heart

Mark	Name	What it does
é	accent aigu	only on e: says 'ay'
è à ù	accent grave	on e: says 'eh'; on a and u: changes the meaning only

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Mark	Name	What it does
ê â î ô û	accent circonflexe	on e: says 'eh'; often marks a lost s
ë ï	tréma	say this vowel separately
ç	cédille	makes c say 's' before a, o, u

é vs è / ê

é	è	ê
'ay' (closed)	**'eh' (open)**	**'eh' (open)**
Smile, mouth almost closed: été, café.	Drop your jaw a little: mère, très.	Same as è: fête, forêt.

MEMORY TRICK

Draw it in the air! The aigu accent (´) climbs up: your voice is high and tight, 'ay'. The grave accent (`) slides down: your jaw drops, 'eh'. The circonflexe (^) is a little hat that hides a lost s: forêt = forest, hôpital = hospital.

Accents can change meaning

Some words sound the same but the accent tells them apart.

How to say it: a = has, à = to. ou = or, où = where. la = the, là = there. sur = on, sûr = sure.

a / à (ah) ou / où (oo) la / là (lah) sur / sûr (sewr)

The cédille

C before a, o, u is hard 'k'. Add a tail (ç) to make it a soft 's'.

ça (sah) garçon (gar-SOHN) reçu (ruh-SEW)

The tréma

Two dots say: pronounce me on my own.

How to say it: Compare mais ('meh', but) with maïs ('mah-EES', corn).

Noël (noh-EL) maïs (mah-EES)

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Read each word. Watch the accent and adjust your mouth.

été

mère

fête

très

voilà

ça

Noël

hôtel

Quick quiz

QUIZ

14. Which accent makes e say 'ay'?

- ○ A) é (aigu)
- ○ B) è (grave)
- ○ C) ê (circonflexe)
- ○ D) ë (tréma)

15. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: mère)

- ○ A) mari
- ○ B) mère
- ○ C) marée
- ○ D) mûre

16. What does the cédille in garçon do?

- ○ A) Makes c say 's'
- ○ B) Makes c say 'k'
- ○ C) Makes c silent
- ○ D) Makes the o nasal

17. où means...

- ○ A) or
- ○ B) yes
- ○ C) where
- ○ D) who

18. Why does maïs have two dots on the i?

- ○ A) The i is silent
- ○ B) The i is long
- ○ C) It is a plural
- ○ D) Say a and i separately

19. The circumflex in forêt often reminds us of...

- ○ A) a silent t
- ○ B) a lost letter s
- ○ C) a long 'ee'
- ○ D) a capital letter

20. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: été)

- ○ A) été
- ○ B) étape
- ○ C) tête
- ○ D) thé

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UNIT 1 · LESSON 4 · 10 MINUTES

Silent Final Letters

Many last letters stay quiet

- Know which final letters are usually silent
- Use the CaReFuL trick
- Hear the change in petit / petite

French spelling keeps letters that people stopped saying centuries ago. Relax: there are clear patterns, and you'll soon read them without thinking.

Final consonants are usually silent

Most consonants at the very end of a word are not said.

petit	grand	Paris	beaucoup	deux	nez
puh-TEE	grahn	pah-REE	boh-KOO	duh	nay

Final e is usually silent

An e at the end of a word is not said, but it makes the consonant before it heard.

petite	grande	rose
puh-TEET	grahnd	rohz

One letter, a new sound

petit

puh-TEE

Final t silent: small (masculine).

petite

puh-TEET

Final e silent, but now you hear the t: small (feminine).

CaReFuL letters are often said

Final C, R, F and L are usually pronounced.

How to say it: Big exception: verbs ending in -er (parler, manger) say 'ay', with a silent r.

avec	bonjour	neuf	avril
ah-VEK	bohn-ZHOOR	nuhf	ah-VREEL

MEMORY TRICK

Be CaReFuL! The consonants in C-a-R-e-F-u-L (c, r, f, l) are the ones French usually says at the end of a word.

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Plural -s and verb -ent are silent

Plural s/x and the verb ending -ent make no sound.

How to say it: So il parle and ils parlent sound exactly the same.

les chats
lay SHAH

ils parlent
eel PARL

des gâteaux
day gah-TOH

WATCH OUT

One-syllable little words keep their e as a soft 'uh': le, de, je, me, que.

Spot the silent letters

le chocolat chaud
luh shoh-koh-lah SHOH
hot chocolate

un grand lit
uhn grahn LEE
a big bed

trois petits chats
trwah puh-tee SHAH
three little cats

Read aloud. Cover the last letter with your finger if it helps!

petit

petite

Paris

avec

parler

les chats

ils parlent

beaucoup

Quick quiz

QUIZ

21. How do you say petit?

- A) puh-TEE
- B) puh-TEET
- C) PET-it
- D) puh-TEES

22. Which final letters does the CaReFuL trick say are usually pronounced?

- A) s, t, d, x
- B) a, e, i, o
- C) c, r, f, l
- D) p, t, k, s

23. In parler, the final r is...

- A) a strong French r
- B) silent: the ending says 'ay'
- C) said like English r
- D) doubled

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24. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: petite)

- ○ A) petit
- ○ B) petite
- ○ C) petits
- ○ D) peut-être

25. il parle and ils parlent…

- ○ A) sound different
- ○ B) have a nasal ending
- ○ C) end in a 't' sound
- ○ D) sound the same

26. Which word ends with a pronounced consonant?

- ○ A) avec
- ○ B) grand
- ○ C) trois
- ○ D) beaucoup

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on

UNIT 1 · LESSON 5 · 12 MINUTES

Nasal Vowels

The famous French hum

- Make the four nasal vowels
- Spot when a vowel goes nasal
- Hear vent, vont and vin

Nasal vowels are the 'hum' that makes French sound French. The secret: let air flow through your nose and your mouth at the same time, and do NOT say the n.

Make a nasal vowel

1 **Hold your nose**
Say 'ah'. It sounds normal: that's an oral vowel.

2 **Let go and hum**
Now say 'ah' while letting some air out of your nose. Your tongue stays down.

3 **Stop before the n**
Never touch the roof of your mouth with your tongue. an = 'ahn' with no real n.

The four nasals

Sound	Spellings	Example
ahn	an, en, am, em	enfant (child)
ohn	on, om	bonbon (sweet)
an	in, im, ain, ein	pain (bread)
uhn	un, um	lundi (Monday)

an · en
an, en, am, em
/ahn/
enfant child

on · om
on, om
/ohn/
bonbon sweet, candy

in · ain
in, im, ain, ein
/an/
pain bread

un · um
un, um
/uhn/
lundi Monday

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Three words, three nasals

vent	vont	vin
ahn: vahn	**ohn: vohn**	**an: van**
wind: mouth open wide.	(they) go: lips very round.	wine: lips spread, smile.

MEMORY TRICK

One sentence holds all the nasals: un bon vin blanc (a good white wine) = uhn bohn van BLAHN. Say it like a little song!

When is it NOT nasal?

If the n or m is followed by a vowel, or doubled, the vowel is normal and you DO say the n.

bon / bonne	un / une	fin / fine
bohn / bon	uhn / ewn	fan / feen

américain	américaine
ah-may-ree-KAN	**ah-may-ree-KEN**
Nasal ending: American (man).	n followed by e: no nasal (woman).

TIP

M before b or p works the same way: jambon (ham), temps (time), simple.

maman	jambon	le temps	important
mah-MAHN	zhahn-BOHN	luh TAHN	an-por-TAHN
mum	ham	time, weather	important

un parfum
uhn par-FUHN
a perfume

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Hum the nasal vowels. Never touch your tongue to the roof of your mouth.

an

on

vin

un

vent, vont, vin

un bon vin blanc

bon, bonne

une maman

Quick quiz

QUIZ

27. To make a nasal vowel, you...

- ○ A) say a strong n at the end
- ○ B) let air out through the nose and skip the n
- ○ C) close your lips
- ○ D) add a 'g' sound

28. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: vin)

- ○ A) vin
- ○ B) vent
- ○ C) vont
- ○ D) vingt-deux

29. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: vont)

- ○ A) vin
- ○ B) vent
- ○ C) vont
- ○ D) vous

30. Which word has NO nasal vowel?

- ○ A) bon
- ○ B) pont
- ○ C) nom
- ○ D) bonne

31. Which spelling does NOT usually make the 'ahn' sound?

- ○ A) in
- ○ B) an
- ○ C) en
- ○ D) em

32. How many nasal vowels are in un bon vin blanc?

- ○ A) Two
- ○ B) Four
- ○ C) None
- ○ D) One

33. Why is the e in une needed for the sound?

- ○ A) It makes a nasal 'uhn'
- ○ B) It is said 'ay'
- ○ C) It stops the nasal, so you hear 'n'
- ○ D) It makes the u silent

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r

UNIT 1 · LESSON 6 · 12 MINUTES

The French R, U and OU

Two sounds English doesn't have

- Make a soft throat r
- Say the French u
- Hear tu vs tout

Two sounds give English speakers the most fun: the French r and the French u. With a few tricks and a little practice, you'll have both.

The French r in 3 steps

1 Find the spot

Say 'k' or 'g'. Feel the back of your tongue touch the back of your mouth.

2 Breathe there

Leave a tiny gap at that same spot and breathe out a soft, buzzing 'h'.

3 Keep the tip down

Your tongue tip rests behind your bottom teeth. No rolling, no curling.

MEMORY TRICK

Think of a light gargle, or a cat's soft purr. Too strong? Make it gentler. French people say it softly.

Practise the r

rouge	Paris	merci	très
roozh	pah-REE	mehr-SEE	treh
red	Paris	thank you	very

frère
frehr
brother

The French u in 3 steps

1 Smile

Say a long 'ee'.

2 Freeze

Keep your tongue exactly where it is.

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3 **Kiss**

Push your lips into a small round circle. Out comes the French u: 'ew'.

u vs ou

tu **u = 'ew'** you: tongue forward, lips round.	**tout** **ou = 'oo'** all: tongue back, like English 'too'.
rue **rew** street	**roue** **roo** wheel
dessus **duh-SEW** on top	**dessous** **duh-SOO** underneath

WATCH OUT

Mixing u and ou can change the meaning. tu is 'you', tout is 'all'. vu is 'seen', vous is 'you'.

une rue ewn REW a street	la lune lah LEWN the moon	tu as vu ? tew ah VEW did you see?	nous trouvons noo troo-VOHN we find

Slowly, then faster. Feel your lips move.

tu, tout

rue, roue

vu, vous

dessus, dessous

une rue rouge

Tu trouves tout ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

34. Where is the French r made?

- ○ A) With the tongue tip rolled
- ○ B) With curled tongue, like English
- ○ C) At the back of the mouth, near the throat
- ○ D) With the lips

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35. To make the French u, you...

- ○ A) say 'ee' and round your lips
- ○ B) say 'oo' with a smile
- ○ C) say 'uh' with your mouth open
- ○ D) say 'you' quickly

36. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: tu)

- ○ A) tout
- ○ B) tu
- ○ C) toi
- ○ D) thé

37. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: roue)

- ○ A) rue
- ○ B) rêve
- ○ C) rude
- ○ D) roue

38. dessous means...

- ○ A) underneath
- ○ B) on top
- ○ C) inside
- ○ D) behind

39. Which word has the French u sound ('ew')?

- ○ A) loup
- ○ B) nous
- ○ C) lune
- ○ D) rouge

40. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: vous)

- ○ A) vu
- ○ B) vous
- ○ C) veut
- ○ D) vos

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eau

UNIT 1 · LESSON 7 · 14 MINUTES

Sound Spellings

Letter teams that make one sound

- Read the most common letter teams
- Know soft and hard c and g
- Read new words with confidence

French often uses two or three letters for one sound. Learn these teams once, and you can read almost any French word aloud, even ones you've never seen.

The teams

ou — /oo/ — nous we

oi — /wah/ — trois three

eau, au — /oh/ — beau beautiful

ai, ei — /eh/ — lait milk

eu, œu — /uh/ — deux two

-er, -ez — /ay/ — parler to speak

gn — /ny/ — montagne mountain

ch — /sh/ — chat cat

qu — /k/ — qui who

ph — /f/ — photo photo

-tion — /syohn/ — nation nation

ill, -il — /y/ — fille girl, daughter

ui — /wee/ — nuit night

One sound, many spellings

Sound	Spellings	Examples
oh	o, au, eau	vélo, chaud, beau
eh	è, ê, ai, ei	mère, fête, lait, neige
ay	é, -er, -ez	été, parler, nez
wah	oi	moi, trois
oo	ou	nous, soupe
uh	eu, œu	deux, sœur
sh	ch	chat, chien

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Sound	Spellings	Examples
ny	gn	montagne
k	c, qu, k	café, qui, kilo
y	ill, y	fille, yaourt

MEMORY TRICK

E-A-U looks scary, but it's just 'oh'! Picture a bottle of water: eau = 'oh'. And a bateau (boat) floats on it: bah-TOH.

Don't read them the English way

oi
wah
moi: me. Never 'oy'.

ou
oo
nous: we.

eu
uh
deux: two.

Soft c and g

Before e, i, y: c = 's' and g = 'zh'. Before a, o, u: c = 'k' and g = 'g'.

cinéma (see-nay-MAH) café (kah-FAY) girafe (zhee-RAHF) gare (gahr)

Keeping g soft

To keep g soft before a or o, French adds an e: ge.

How to say it: And to make g hard before e or i, add a u: guitare (ghee-TAR).

mangeons (mahn-ZHOHN) Georges (zhorzh)

-tion = 'syohn'

At the end of a word, -tion says 'syohn'.

nation (nah-SYOHN) attention (ah-tahn-SYOHN) information (an-for-mah-SYOHN)

Decode these

le château
luh shah-TOH
the castle

un oiseau
uhn-nwah-ZOH
a bird

la neige
lah NEZH
snow

la campagne
lah kahn-PAHNY
the countryside

la feuille
lah FUHY
the leaf

huit
weet
eight

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Find the teams first, then read the whole word.

beau

moi

soupe

lait

deux

chat

montagne

nation

fille

oiseau

Quick quiz

QUIZ

41. How do you say eau?

- A) ee-ah-oo
- B) oh
- C) yoo
- D) ay-oh

42. How do you say oi in moi?

- A) wah
- B) oy
- C) oh-ee
- D) wee

43. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: chat)

- A) chaud
- B) chou
- C) chez
- D) chat

44. In cinéma, the c sounds like...

- A) k
- B) sh
- C) s
- D) ch

45. gn in montagne sounds like...

- A) the 'ny' in 'canyon'
- B) a hard g then n
- C) the 'gn' in 'sign'
- D) the 'ng' in 'sing'

46. Which word has the 'ay' sound at the end?

- A) lait
- B) mère
- C) fête
- D) parler

47. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: deux)

- A) doux
- B) deux
- C) de l'eau
- D) des

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48. attention ends with the sound…

- ○ A) shun
- ○ B) tee-on
- ○ C) syohn
- ○ D) tyohn

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UNIT 1 · LESSON 8 · 12 MINUTES

Liaison & Elision

How French words link together

- Link words with liaison
- Drop a vowel with elision
- Know where linking is not allowed

French loves smooth sound. When one word ends and the next begins with a vowel, French links them, so speech flows without bumps. Two tools do this: **liaison** and **elision**.

Liaison

A silent final consonant wakes up when the next word starts with a vowel or a silent h.

How to say it: s and x link with a 'z' sound; d links with a 't' sound (un grand homme = uhn grahn-TOM).

les amis	vous avez	un ami	deux enfants
lay-zah-MEE	voo-zah-VAY	uhn-nah-MEE	duh-zahn-FAHN

Silent or awake?

les chats	les amis
lay SHAH	**lay-zah-MEE**
Consonant next: s stays silent.	Vowel next: s wakes up as 'z'.

MEMORY TRICK

Imagine the silent letter is asleep. A vowel next door knocks and wakes it up: 'les… ZAMIS!'

Elision

Small words drop their last vowel before a vowel or silent h, and an apostrophe takes its place.

How to say it: le, la, je, me, te, se, de, ne, que, ce → l', j', m', t', s', d', n', qu', c'.

l'ami	j'aime	c'est	d'accord	l'hôtel
lah-MEE	zhem	seh	dah-KOR	loh-TEL

le chat	l'ami
luh SHAH	**lah-MEE**
Consonant next: le stays whole.	Vowel next: le becomes l'.

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No linking here!

Never link after et (and), and never before an 'aspirated' h (marked * in dictionaries).

et un
ay UHN

les haricots
lay ah-ree-KOH

le héros
luh ay-ROH

WATCH OUT

Most h words are 'silent h' (l'homme, l'hôtel, les hommes = lay-ZOM). A few block linking: le héros, les haricots, la Hollande. Learn them as you meet them.

Smooth sentences

Ils ont un ami.
eel-zohn-tuhn-nah-MEE
They have a friend.

C'est un hôtel.
seh-tuhn-noh-TEL
It's a hotel.

J'habite à Lyon.
zhah-beet ah lee-OHN
I live in Lyon.

Link the words smoothly, like one long word.

les amis

vous avez

un ami

deux enfants

l'ami

j'aime

c'est un hôtel

les haricots

Quick quiz

QUIZ

49. How do you say les amis?

- A) lay ah-MEE
- B) les-ah-MEES
- C) lay-zah-MEE
- D) lay-sah-MEE

50. Before a vowel, je becomes...

- A) j'
- B) je'
- C) jé
- D) j

51. In liaison, a final s sounds like...

- A) s
- B) sh
- C) t
- D) z

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52. Which phrase has NO liaison?

- ○ A) les amis
- ○ B) et un
- ○ C) vous avez
- ○ D) deux enfants

53. Listen. Which do you hear? (listen in the web app: l'ami)

- ○ A) l'ami
- ○ B) les amis
- ○ C) le mime
- ○ D) la nuit

54. Why is it le héros and not l'héros?

- ○ A) Héros is plural
- ○ B) The é is silent
- ○ C) Its h blocks linking
- ○ D) It's an English word

55. Listen. Which phrase do you hear? (listen in the web app: vous avez)

- ○ A) vous savez
- ○ B) vous allez
- ○ C) nous avons
- ○ D) vous avez

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UNIT 1 · LESSON 9 · 15 MINUTES

Reading Lab

From syllables to real sentences

- Read syllables, words and phrases
- Use everything from this unit together
- Read a short dialogue aloud

Time to put it all together! Read each level aloud, tap to check, and only move on when it feels easy. Slow and smooth beats fast and bumpy.

Level 1: syllables

la lah	le luh	li lee	lo loh
lu lew	lou loo	loi lwah	

Level 2: words

papa pah-PAH dad	ami ah-MEE friend	vélo vay-LOH bike	merci mehr-SEE thank you
maison meh-ZOHN house	bonjour bohn-ZHOOR hello		

TIP

In maison, the s is between two vowels, so it says 'z': meh-ZOHN.

Level 3: little groups

un café uhn kah-FAY a coffee	le chat luh SHAH the cat	la maison lah meh-ZOHN the house	les amis lay-zah-MEE the friends
mon ami mohn-nah-MEE my friend	l'école lay-KOL the school		

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Level 4: phrases

Bonjour, madame !
bohn-ZHOOR, mah-DAHM
Hello, madam!

Merci beaucoup !
mehr-SEE boh-KOO
Thank you very much!

Je m'appelle Léa.
zhuh mah-pel lay-AH
My name is Léa.

C'est un bon vin blanc.
seh-tuhn bohn van BLAHN
It's a good white wine.

Les enfants sont à l'école.
lay-zahn-FAHN sohn-tah lay-KOL
The children are at school.

Level 5: a mini dialogue

Léa Bonjour ! Ça va ?
bohn-ZHOOR! sah VAH?
Hello! How are you?

Hugo Très bien, merci. Et toi ?
treh BYAN, mehr-SEE. ay TWAH?
Very well, thanks. And you?

Léa Ça va bien. Un café ?
sah vah BYAN. uhn kah-FAY?
I'm fine. A coffee?

Hugo Oui, avec plaisir !
wee, ah-vek pleh-ZEER!
Yes, with pleasure!

Read the whole dialogue aloud twice: once slowly, once at a natural speed.

Bonjour ! Ça va ?

Très bien, merci. Et toi ?

Ça va bien. Un café ?

Oui, avec plaisir !

Can you...?

Check yourself

☐ I keep my vowels short and pure.

☐ I stress the end of each word group.

☐ I don't say most final consonants.

☐ I make nasal vowels without a real n.

☐ I link words with liaison and elision.

Give your work today some stars ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

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Quick quiz

QUIZ

56. How do you read maison?

- ○ A) MAY-son
- ○ B) meh-ZOHN
- ○ C) may-SOHN
- ○ D) mah-ee-SON

57. Listen. Which phrase do you hear? (listen in the web app: mon ami)

- ○ A) mon ami
- ○ B) mon avis
- ○ C) mes amis
- ○ D) un ami

58. In Très bien, the s of très is...

- ○ A) said 's'
- ○ B) said 'z'
- ○ C) silent
- ○ D) said 'sh'

59. Ça va ? means...

- ○ A) Thank you
- ○ B) Goodbye
- ○ C) Let's go to school
- ○ D) How are you?

60. Listen. Which sentence do you hear? (listen in the web app: Merci beaucoup !)

- ○ A) Bonjour, madame !
- ○ B) Merci beaucoup !
- ○ C) Avec plaisir !
- ○ D) Très bien, merci.

61. How many syllables are in l'école?

- ○ A) Two (lay-KOL)
- ○ B) Three (luh-ay-KOL)
- ○ C) One
- ○ D) Four

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UNIT 1

Answer key

1. A) On the last syllable of a word group

2. B) A clean, steady 'ay'

3. B) shoh-koh-LAH

4. D) A nasal 'oh', with no real n

5. C) s'il vous plaît

6. A) -jour and -a

7. C) ee

8. A) G

9. D) J

10. B) Nothing: it is silent

11. A) deux S

12. C) Greek i

13. B) E

14. A) é (aigu)

15. B) mère
mère (mother) has an open 'eh'.

16. A) Makes c say 's'

17. C) where

18. D) Say a and i separately

19. B) a lost letter s
forêt = forest.

20. A) été

21. A) puh-TEE

22. C) c, r, f, l

23. B) silent: the ending says 'ay'

24. B) petite

25. D) sound the same

26. A) avec

27. B) let air out through the nose and skip the n

28. A) vin

29. C) vont

30. D) bonne

31. A) in

32. B) Four

33. C) It stops the nasal, so you hear 'n'

34. C) At the back of the mouth, near the throat

35. A) say 'ee' and round your lips

36. B) tu

37. D) roue

38. A) underneath

39. C) lune

40. B) vous

41. B) oh

42. A) wah

43. D) chat

44. C) s

45. A) the 'ny' in 'canyon'

46. D) parler
-er at the end of a verb says 'ay'. The others end in 'eh'.

47. B) deux

48. C) syohn

49. C) lay-zah-MEE

50. A) j'

51. D) z

52. B) et un

53. A) l'ami

54. C) Its h blocks linking

55. D) vous avez

56. B) meh-ZOHN

57. A) mon ami

58. C) silent

59. D) How are you?

60. B) Merci beaucoup !

61. A) Two (lay-KOL)

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UNIT 2

Writing & Spelling

Write French neatly, with accents and confidence

1. Writing Letters & Accents
2. Common Spelling Patterns
3. Capitals & Punctuation
4. Apostrophes & Elision
5. Dictation Practice
6. Your First Sentences

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é

UNIT 2 · LESSON 1 · 14 MINUTES

Writing Letters & Accents

Clear letters, neat accents

- Write é, è, ê, ç, à and œ correctly
- Put each accent in the right direction
- Type accents on your phone and computer

You already know how to write the letters. In French, the magic is in the small marks. A missing or wrong accent can change a word, so let's write them with care. Grab a pen!

CULTURE NOTE

In France, children learn joined-up handwriting on paper with little squares and lines. Many people also write the number 1 with a long up-stroke and cross the 7 so it isn't confused with 1.

é

e accent aigu

1. Write a small e: start in the middle, go right, loop up and around, finish open at the bottom right.
2. Lift your pen.
3. Draw a short stroke above the e, rising from bottom left to top right (´).
4. Keep it small and just above the letter, not touching it.

★ Aigu climbs UP to the right, like your voice rising to 'ay'.

é é é é é é

è

e accent grave

1. Write a small e.
2. Lift your pen.
3. Draw a short stroke above it, sloping down from top left to bottom right (`).

★ Grave goes down: think of a slide going down to the right.

è è è è è è

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ê

e accent circonflexe

1. Write a small e.
2. Draw a small up-stroke to the right.
3. Without lifting, come down to the right: a tiny roof or hat (^).

★ A little hat sits on the letter, hiding a lost s: fête = feast.

ê ê ê ê ê ê

ç

c cédille

1. Write a small c.
2. Start just under the bottom of the c.
3. Add a small tail that curls down and to the left, like a tiny comma.

★ Only before a, o or u. Never write ç before e or i: c is already soft there.

ç ç ç ç ç ç

à

a accent grave

1. Write a small a.
2. Lift your pen.
3. Add a short stroke sloping down to the right (`).

★ à with an accent = to / at. a without = has.

à à à à à à

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œ

e dans l'o

1. Start a small o, but don't close it on the right.
2. Let the right side of the o become the start of the e.
3. Finish the e loop. The two letters share one side.

★ Common words: cœur (heart), sœur (sister), œuf (egg).

œ œ œ œ œ œ

Say the name of each one as you write it.

é é é é é é

è è è è è è

ê ê ê ê ê ê

ë ë ë ë ë ë

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à à à à à à

â â â â â â

ç ç ç ç ç ç

î î î î î î

ô ô ô ô ô ô

ù ù ù ù ù ù

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û û û û û û

œ œ œ œ œ œ

Write the word first, then add the accents.

café café café

mère mère mère

fête fête fête

garçon garçon garçon

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voilà voilà voilà

cœur cœur cœur

Noël Noël Noël

hôtel hôtel hôtel

WATCH OUT

Capital letters keep their accents: École, État, À bientôt, Ça va. Writing them is correct and clearer.

Typing accents

Device	How to get é, è, ç…
Phone or tablet	Press and hold the letter (e, a, c, o…) and slide to the accent you need.
Mac	Option + e then e = é; Option + ` then e = è; Option + i then e = ê; Option + c = ç
Windows	Add the French or 'US International' keyboard in Settings, or use the touch keyboard and hold the letter.

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Read each word aloud, then write it from memory.

été

très

forêt

ça

là

sœur

Quick quiz

QUIZ

1. Which way does the accent on é go?
   - ○ A) Up to the right (´)
   - ○ B) Down to the right (`)
   - ○ C) Like a hat (^)
   - ○ D) Two dots (¨)
2. Where does the cédille go on ç?
   - ○ A) Above the c
   - ○ B) After the c
   - ○ C) Under the c
   - ○ D) Inside the c
3. Which is spelled correctly?
   - ○ A) garcon
   - ○ B) garçon
   - ○ C) garççon
   - ○ D) gaŕçon
4. When do you write ç?
   - ○ A) Before e or i
   - ○ B) At the end of a word
   - ○ C) Only in capitals
   - ○ D) Before a, o or u
5. Which word means 'heart'?
   - ○ A) cœur
   - ○ B) cour
   - ○ C) cure
   - ○ D) car
6. Do capital letters keep their accents?
   - ○ A) No, never
   - ○ B) Yes, it is correct: École
   - ○ C) Only on the letter A
   - ○ D) Only in names
7. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: sœur)
   - ○ A) sœur
   - ○ B) sur
   - ○ C) sourd
   - ○ D) seul

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eau

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2 · 14 MINUTES

Common Spelling Patterns

Hear a sound, choose the letters

- Pick common spellings for a sound
- Use s vs ss and plural endings
- Turn English words into French ones

French spelling looks tricky, but it follows patterns. Once you know them, you can often guess how to write a word you hear. Let's become spelling detectives!

Sound → spelling

You hear	Often written	Examples
oh	o, au, eau	vélo, auto, gâteau
eh	è, ê, ai, e + 2 consonants	père, tête, maison, belle
ay	é, -er, -ez	été, manger, chez
s	s, ss, c, ç, -tion	sac, classe, ici, leçon, nation
k	c, qu, k	carte, quand, kiwi
ahn	an, en, am, em	blanc, vent, jambe, temps

s or ss?

Between two vowels, one s says 'z'. To keep the 's' sound, write ss.

rose (rohz) maison (meh-ZOHN) classe (klahs) poisson (pwah-SOHN)

Don't poison the fish!

poison

pwah-ZOHN

One s = 'z': poison.

poisson

pwah-SOHN

Double s = 's': fish.

désert

day-ZEHR

One s: desert.

dessert

deh-SEHR

Double s: dessert (you want more of it, so two s!).

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Plurals

Usually add a silent -s. Words in -eau and -eu add -x. Many words in -al change to -aux.

How to say it: You often can't hear the plural, so look at the little word in front: le/la vs les, un vs des.

un chat → des chats
uhn SHAH → day SHAH

un gâteau → des gâteaux
uhn gah-TOH → day gah-TOH

un jeu → des jeux
uhn ZHUH → day ZHUH

un animal → des animaux
uhn-nah-nee-MAHL → day-zah-nee-MOH

Feminine -e

Many words add -e for the feminine. Sometimes you hear it, sometimes not.

grand → grande
grahn → grahnd

petit → petite
puh-TEE → puh-TEET

ami → amie
ah-MEE → ah-MEE

MEMORY TRICK

Free vocabulary! Many English endings have French twins: -ty → -té (liberté, université), -ous → -eux (curieux, dangereux), -ly → -ment (rapidement), -tion stays -tion (information).

English → French

la liberté	curieux	rapidement	la société
lah lee-behr-TAY	kew-RYUH	rah-peed-MAHN	lah soh-syay-TAY
freedom, liberty	curious	quickly	society

Read, then cover and write each word. Check your s and ss!

rose

classe

poisson

dessert

des gâteaux

des animaux

une amie

la liberté

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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8. You hear 'pwah-SOHN' (fish). How is it written?

○ A) poison ○ B) poissson
○ C) poisson ○ D) poisonne

9. Which is the correct plural of gâteau?

○ A) gâteaux ○ B) gâteaus
○ C) gâteau ○ D) gâteaues

10. One s between two vowels sounds like…

○ A) s ○ B) z
○ C) sh ○ D) nothing

11. animal in the plural is…

○ A) animals ○ B) animales
○ C) animalx ○ D) animaux

12. Which is the French spelling of 'university'?

○ A) université ○ B) universitée
○ C) universitey ○ D) universitie

13. Listen. Which word do you hear? (listen in the web app: dessert)

○ A) désert ○ B) désir
○ C) dessert ○ D) dessin

14. dangereux means…

○ A) danger ○ B) dangerous
○ C) dangerously ○ D) endangered

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UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · 12 MINUTES

Capitals & Punctuation

Small rules that look very French

- Know which words have no capital
- Use « guillemets » for quotes
- Put a space before ! ? : ;

French punctuation has a few surprises. Get them right and your writing instantly looks French. They are easy to learn: just a few small habits.

No capitals for days, months and languages

Inside a sentence, days, months, languages and nationality adjectives start with a small letter.

lundi	en janvier	Je parle anglais.	un livre français
luhn-DEE	ahn zhahn-VYAY	zhuh parl ahn-GLEH	uhn leevr frahn-SEH

Français or français?

un Français	un livre français	le français
Capital F	**Small f**	**Small f**
A French person (a noun for people).	A French book (describing word).	The French language.

MEMORY TRICK

Only PEOPLE get a capital: les Français, une Anglaise. Books, food and languages stay small: le fromage français, l'anglais.

A space before two-part marks

Put a space before ! ? : ; and none before . or ,

How to say it: A good trick: marks made of two pieces (! ? : ;) get a space. One-piece marks (. ,) don't.

Bonjour !	Ça va ?	Attention : danger !
bohn-ZHOOR	sah VAH	ah-tahn-SYOHN : dahn-ZHAY

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« Guillemets » for quotes

French uses « » for quotations, with a space inside each one.

How to say it: In dialogues, a new speaker is often shown with a dash: — Ça va ? — Oui, merci.

Il dit : « Bonjour ! »
eel DEE : bohn-ZHOOR

DID YOU KNOW?

Guillemets (ghee-yuh-MEH) are said to be named after a French printer called Guillaume. They look like little arrows hugging the words.

Side by side

	English	French
Decimal	3.5	3,5
Thousands	10,000	10 000
Quote	"Hi!"	« Salut ! »
Question	Why?	Pourquoi ?

TIP

Write monsieur and madame with a small letter inside a sentence. Use a capital at the start of a letter (Chère Madame,) and in the short forms M. and Mme.

Read aloud, then copy each line with the French spacing.

Bonjour !

Comment ça va ?

Elle dit : « Merci ! »

Lundi, je parle français.

Il a 3,5 euros.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

15. Which is correct French?

- ○ A) J'aime le Français.
- ○ B) J'aime le français.
- ○ C) J'Aime le français.
- ○ D) j'aime Le français.

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16. Which is written correctly?

- ○ A) Ça va ?
- ○ B) Ça va?
- ○ C) Ça va ;
- ○ D) « Ça va »?

17. How do you write 'Monday' inside a sentence?

- ○ A) Lundi
- ○ B) LUNDI
- ○ C) Lun-di
- ○ D) lundi

18. Which marks does French use for quotations?

- ○ A) " "
- ○ B) ( )
- ○ C) « »
- ○ D) [ ]

19. Which needs a space before it in French?

- ○ A) .
- ○ B) :
- ○ C) ,
- ○ D) '

20. 'A French person' is written…

- ○ A) un Français
- ○ B) un français
- ○ C) un Francais
- ○ D) un françois

21. How is 2.5 written in French?

- ○ A) 2.5
- ○ B) 2-5
- ○ C) 2'5
- ○ D) 2,5

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UNIT 2 · LESSON 4 · 10 MINUTES

Apostrophes & Elision

When little words lose a letter

- Know the words that drop their vowel
- Write l', j', d', c', n', qu' correctly
- Avoid common apostrophe mistakes

In Unit 1 you heard elision: le ami becomes l'ami. Now let's write it. The rule is simple and very regular: a small word drops its vowel before another vowel or a silent h.

The elision family

Word	Before a vowel	Example
le, la	l'	l'ami, l'école
je	j'	j'aime
me, te, se	m', t', s'	je m'appelle, il s'appelle
de	d'	un verre d'eau
ne	n'	je n'aime pas
que	qu'	qu'est-ce que...
ce	c'	c'est
si	s' (only before il/ils)	s'il vous plaît

MEMORY TRICK

Think of the apostrophe as a little bandage where a vowel fell off: je + aime → j'aime. The two words now hold hands.

Silent h counts as a vowel

Before a silent h, elide just like before a vowel.

l'homme (lom) l'hôtel (loh-TEL) j'habite (zhah-BEET)

No elision here

Before a consonant or an 'aspirated' h, keep the full word.

How to say it: si becomes s' only before il and ils: s'il, but si elle.

le chat (luh SHAH) le héros (luh ay-ROH) la Hollande (lah oh-LAHND) si elle (see EL)

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Spot the mistake

le ami	l'ami
Wrong	**Right**
Two vowels bump into each other.	Smooth: one apostrophe, no space after it.

WATCH OUT

No space after the apostrophe: l'école, never l' école. And only the little words in the table elide: une amie, never un' amie.

Words to remember

aujourd'hui	quelqu'un	Qu'est-ce que c'est ?
oh-zhoor-DWEE	kel-KUHN	kes-kuh SEH
today	someone	What is it?
A word with a built-in apostrophe.		

Look at the model → write over the light copies → write on your own on the empty line.

l'ami l'ami l'ami

l'école l'école l'école

j'aime j'aime j'aime

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c'est c'est c'est

d'accord d'accord d'accord

aujourd'hui

aujourd'hui

quelqu'un quelqu'un quelqu'un

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s'il vous plaît

s'il vous plaît

Read aloud. Say each elided pair as one word.

J'aime l'école.

C'est l'hôtel.

Je n'ai pas d'argent.

Il s'appelle Hugo.

Qu'est-ce que c'est ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

22. je + habite is written...

- A) je habite
- B) j' habite
- C) j'habite
- D) jhabite

23. Which is correct?

- A) le chat
- B) l'chat
- C) l'e chat
- D) le' chat

24. Which is correct?

- A) s'elle
- B) s'il elle
- C) si' elle
- D) si elle

25. la + école becomes...

- A) la école
- B) l'école
- C) l' école
- D) la'école

26. Which word keeps its vowel before héros?

- A) le (le héros)
- B) l' (l'héros)
- C) la (la héros)
- D) lé (lé héros)

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27. Listen. Which do you hear? (listen in the web app: aujourd'hui)

- ○ A) au jour
- ○ B) à jeudi
- ○ C) aujourd'hui
- ○ D) d'accord

28. ce + est is written...

- ○ A) ce est
- ○ B) c' est
- ○ C) s'est
- ○ D) c'est

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UNIT 2 · LESSON 5 · 15 MINUTES

Dictation Practice

Listen, write, check

- Write what you hear, step by step
- Check accents and silent letters
- Tell a/à, et/est and ou/où apart

La dictée (dictation) is a French classic: someone reads, you write. It trains your ears and your spelling at the same time. Don't worry about mistakes: they show you exactly what to practise.

The 5-step method

1 Listen
Hear the whole item once without writing.

2 Write
Play it again and write what you hear.

3 Check sounds
Did you use the right team for each sound (eau, ai, ou…)?

4 Check silent letters
Plural s? Feminine e? Final t or d?

5 Check accents
Every é, è, à, ç in place?

Level 1: words

A teacher or friend reads each item aloud, or press "Listen" in the web app. Write what you hear; answers are at the end of the unit.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____

Level 2: little groups

A teacher or friend reads each item aloud, or press "Listen" in the web app. Write what you hear; answers are at the end of the unit.

7. _____
8. _____

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9. _____

10. _____

Sound-alikes

Same sound, different word. Use a swap test to choose.

How to say it: If you can say avait instead, write a. If you can say était, write est. If you can say ou bien, write ou.

a / à	et / est	ou / où
ah	ay / eh	oo

MEMORY TRICK

The swap test: Il a un chat → Il avait un chat ✓ so it's a. Il va à Paris → Il va avait Paris ✗ so it's à.

Level 3: sentences

A teacher or friend reads each item aloud, or press "Listen" in the web app. Write what you hear; answers are at the end of the unit.

11. _____

12. _____

13. _____

14. _____

15. _____

WATCH OUT

In jouent, the -ent is silent, but you must write it. The sound tells you the word; grammar tells you the ending.

After each dictation

Check yourself

☐ I listen once before writing.

☐ I check plural s and feminine e.

☐ I check every accent.

☐ I use the swap test for a/à, et/est, ou/où.

Give your work today some stars ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

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Read your answers aloud and compare them with the audio.

Il a un chat.

Je vais à Paris.

Léa est grande.

Où est le café ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

29. Listen. Write it in your head, then choose. (listen in the web app: bateau)

- ○ A) batteau
- ○ B) bateau
- ○ C) bâtot
- ○ D) batau

30. Listen. Which spelling is right? (listen in the web app: les amis)

- ○ A) les amis
- ○ B) lézamis
- ○ C) les zamis
- ○ D) l'es amis

31. Il ___ à Paris. (He is in Paris.)

- ○ A) et
- ○ B) es
- ○ C) est
- ○ D) ai

32. Tu viens ___ pas ? (Are you coming or not?)

- ○ A) où
- ○ B) oû
- ○ C) houx
- ○ D) ou

33. Je vais ___ l'école.

- ○ A) à
- ○ B) a
- ○ C) as
- ○ D) ah

34. Listen. Which spelling is right? (listen in the web app: une maison blanche)

- ○ A) une maison blanc
- ○ B) une maison blanche
- ○ C) un maison blanche
- ○ D) une maisson blanche

35. Les enfants jou___. Which ending is silent but needed?

- ○ A) -ont
- ○ B) -ez
- ○ C) -ent
- ○ D) -es

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Je

UNIT 2 · LESSON 6 · 15 MINUTES

Your First Sentences

Write about yourself in French

- Copy five useful sentence patterns
- Write three sentences about yourself
- Check spelling, accents and punctuation

This is a big moment: your first real French sentences! We'll copy useful patterns, then change one word to talk about you. Write slowly and neatly. Every sentence you write is a step forward.

Je m'appelle Léa.

Je	m'appelle	Léa
I	call myself	Léa

zhuh mah-pel lay-AH

My name is Léa.

Word for word: 'I call myself Léa'.

J'ai seize ans.

J'ai	seize	ans
I have	sixteen	years

zhay seh-ZAHN

I am sixteen.

French says 'I have 16 years'.

J'habite à Londres.

J'habite	à	Londres
I live	in	London

zhah-beet ah LOHNDR

I live in London.

Je parle anglais.

Je	parle	anglais
I	speak	English

zhuh parl ahn-GLEH

I speak English.

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J'aime la musique.

J'aime	la	musique
I like	the	music

zhem lah mew-ZEEK

I like music.

French keeps la (the) here: 'I like the music'.

Things you might like

French	Say it	Meaning
le football	luh foot-BOL	football, soccer
la lecture	lah lek-TEWR	reading
le chocolat	luh shoh-koh-LAH	chocolate
les animaux	lay-zah-nee-MOH	animals
le cinéma	luh see-nay-MAH	cinema, films

TIP

Remember: anglais has a small a (it's a language), but Londres has a capital (it's a place).

Copywork

Copy each line neatly. Check the apostrophes and accents.

Je m'appelle Léa.

Je m'appelle Léa.

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J'ai seize ans.

J'ai seize ans.

J'habite à Londres.

J'habite à Londres.

Je parle anglais.

Je parle anglais.

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J'aime la musique.

J'aime la musique.

Your turn

Now write about you: fill each gap with your own word.

Je m'appelle ...

Je m'appelle ...

J'ai ... ans.

J'ai ... ans.

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J'habite à ...

J'habite à ...

J'aime ...

J'aime ...

MEMORY TRICK

Use the 3-check rule before you finish: 1. a capital at the start, 2. a full stop at the end, 3. every accent in place.

A model introduction

Bonjour ! Je m'appelle Hugo.

bohn-ZHOOR! zhuh mah-pel ew-GOH

Hello! My name is Hugo.

J'ai quatorze ans et j'habite à Québec.

zhay kah-tor-ZAHN ay zhah-beet ah kay-BEK

I'm fourteen and I live in Quebec City.

Je parle français et anglais.

zhuh parl frahn-SEH ay ahn-GLEH

I speak French and English.

J'aime le football et le chocolat !

zhem luh foot-BOL ay luh shoh-koh-LAH

I love football and chocolate!

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Read the model aloud, then read your own sentences aloud.

Bonjour ! Je m'appelle Hugo.

J'ai quatorze ans et j'habite à Québec.

Je parle français et anglais.

J'aime le football et le chocolat !

Quick quiz

QUIZ

36. How do you write 'My name is Tom'?

- ○ A) Je appelle Tom.
- ○ B) J'appelle Tom.
- ○ C) Je m'appelle Tom.
- ○ D) Je m'apelle Tom.

37. 'I am sixteen' in French is...

- ○ A) J'ai seize ans.
- ○ B) Je suis seize.
- ○ C) Je seize ans.
- ○ D) J'ai ans seize.

38. Which sentence is correct?

- ○ A) Je parle Anglais.
- ○ B) je parle anglais.
- ○ C) Je parle anglais .
- ○ D) Je parle anglais.

39. J'aime la musique means...

- ○ A) I am the music.
- ○ B) I like music.
- ○ C) I make music.
- ○ D) I hear music.

40. Listen. Which sentence do you hear? (listen in the web app: J'habite à Londres.)

- ○ A) J'habite à Londres.
- ○ B) J'habite à Lyon.
- ○ C) J'aime Londres.
- ○ D) Je suis à Londres.

41. Which is the 3-check rule?

- ○ A) Nouns, verbs, plurals
- ○ B) Read, sing, repeat
- ○ C) Capital, full stop, accents
- ○ D) Spaces, colours, numbers

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UNIT 2

Answer key

Dictation

1. café (kah-FAY)
2. mère (mehr)
3. garçon (gar-SOHN)
4. bateau (bah-TOH)
5. fille (FEE-y)
6. montagne (mohn-TAHNY)
7. le petit chat (luh puh-tee SHAH)
8. une maison blanche (ewn meh-zohn BLAHNSH)
9. les amis (lay-zah-MEE)
10. l'école (lay-KOL)
11. Il a un chat. (eel ah uhn SHAH)
12. Je vais à Paris. (zhuh veh ah pah-REE)
13. Léa est grande. (lay-AH eh GRAHND)
14. Où est le café ? (oo eh luh kah-FAY)
15. Les enfants jouent dans le jardin. (lay-zahn-FAHN zhoo dahn luh zhar-DAN)

Quiz

1. A) Up to the right (´)
2. C) Under the c
3. B) garçon
4. D) Before a, o or u
5. A) cœur
6. B) Yes, it is correct: École
7. A) sœur
8. C) poisson
9. A) gâteaux
10. B) z
11. D) animaux
12. A) université
13. C) dessert
14. B) dangerous
15. B) J'aime le français.
16. A) Ça va ?
17. D) lundi
18. C) « »
19. B) :
20. A) un Français
21. D) 2,5
22. C) j'habite
23. A) le chat
24. D) si elle
25. B) l'école
26. A) le (le héros)
27. C) aujourd'hui
28. D) c'est
    s'est also exists (from se), but 'it is' is c'est.
29. B) bateau
30. A) les amis
31. C) est
32. D) ou
33. A) à
34. B) une maison blanche
35. C) -ent
36. C) Je m'appelle Tom.
37. A) J'ai seize ans.
38. D) Je parle anglais.
39. B) I like music.
40. A) J'habite à Londres.
41. C) Capital, full stop, accents

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Bon

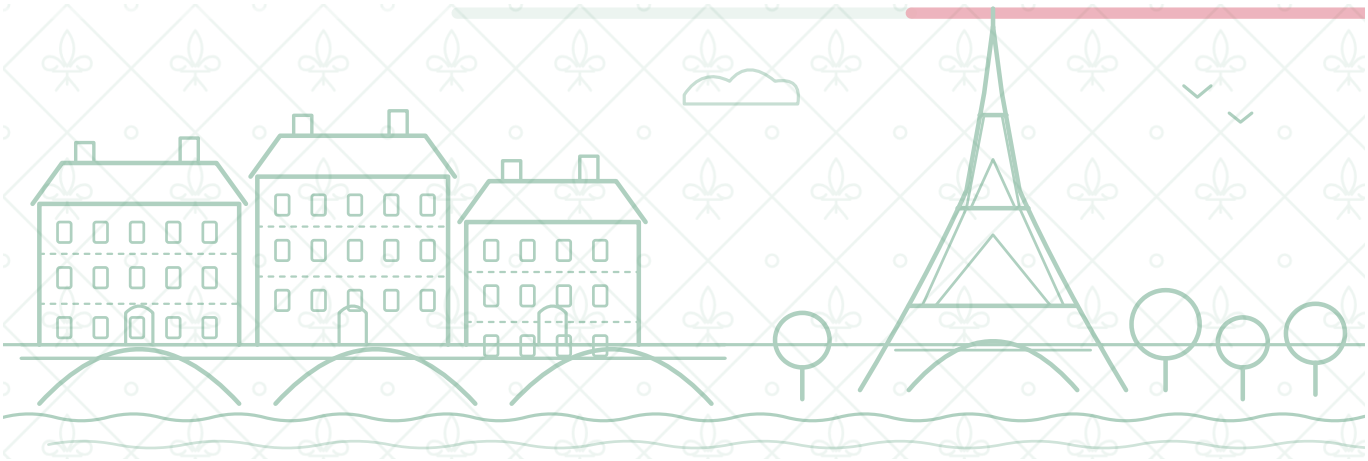
UNIT 3

First Words & Phrases

Greetings, numbers, time, family, food and everyday life

1. Hello, Goodbye & Please
2. Introducing Yourself
3. Numbers 0–20
4. Numbers to 100 & Prices
5. Days, Months & Dates
6. Telling the Time
7. Family
8. Food & Drinks
9. Colours & Clothes
10. Home & Everyday Objects

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Bon

UNIT 3 · LESSON 1 · 12 MINUTES

Hello, Goodbye & Please

Greet people and be polite, the French way

- Say hello and goodbye at any time of day
- Use please, thank you and sorry
- Choose between tu and vous

In France, you say **hello** before anything else: in shops, in lifts, on the bus. A simple Bonjour ! opens every door. Let's learn the words people use every day.

Hello & goodbye

French	Say it	Meaning
Bonjour	bohn-ZHOOR	Hello / Good morning (daytime) Bonjour, madame ! (bohn-ZHOOR, mah-DAHM) — Hello, madam!
Bonsoir	bohn-SWAHR	Good evening Bonsoir, monsieur. (bohn-SWAHR, muh-SYUH) — Good evening, sir.
Salut	sah-LEW	Hi / Bye (with friends) Salut, Léa ! (sah-LEW, lay-AH) — Hi, Léa!
Au revoir	oh ruh-VWAHR	Goodbye
À bientôt	ah byan-TOH	See you soon
À demain	ah duh-MAN	See you tomorrow
Bonne journée	bun zhoor-NAY	Have a good day
Bonne soirée	bun swah-RAY	Have a good evening
Bonne nuit	bun NWEE	Good night (at bedtime)

CULTURE NOTE

Say Bonjour until late afternoon, then switch to Bonsoir (from about 6 pm). Bonne nuit is only for going to bed: never use it to say hello.

Magic words

French	Say it	Meaning
S'il vous plaît	seel voo PLEH	Please (polite)
S'il te plaît	seel tuh PLEH	Please (to a friend)

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French	Say it	Meaning
Merci	mehr-SEE	Thank you
Merci beaucoup	mehr-SEE boh-KOO	Thank you very much
De rien	duh RYAN	You're welcome
Pardon	par-DOHN	Sorry / Excuse me (if you bump into someone)
Excusez-moi	ex-kew-zay-MWAH	Excuse me (to get attention)
Désolé / Désolée	day-zoh-LAY	I'm sorry (said by a man / a woman)
Oui	WEE	Yes
Non	NOHN	No

Tu or vous?

French has two words for **you**. tu is friendly: for family, friends, children and pets. vous is polite: for strangers, shop staff, older people and anyone at work. vous is also the plural **you** for a group.

tu

Friendly you

Family, friends, children, classmates. Relaxed and close.

vous

Polite or plural you

Strangers, shops, teachers, colleagues, or any group of people.

MEMORY TRICK

When in doubt, use vous. A French person will tell you when they want tu. You may hear On se tutoie ?, which means 'Shall we say tu?'

How are you?

Comment allez-vous ?
koh-mahn tah-lay-VOO
How are you? (polite)

Ça va ?
sah VAH
How's it going? (friendly)

Ça va bien, merci.
sah vah BYAN, mehr-SEE
I'm fine, thanks.

Très bien, et vous ?
treh BYAN, ay VOO
Very well, and you?

Pas mal.
pah MAHL
Not bad.

Bof...
BOF
Meh... so-so.
Very casual. A little shrug helps!

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Bonjour, comment allez-vous ?

Bonjour	comment	allez-vous
hello	how	go you (are you)

bohn-ZHOOR, koh-mahn tah-lay-VOO

Hello, how are you?

French literally asks 'How do you go?'. The T of comment links to allez.

At the bakery

Client Bonjour, madame !
bohn-ZHOOR, mah-DAHM
Hello, madam!

Baker Bonjour, monsieur. Vous désirez ?
bohn-ZHOOR, muh-SYUH. voo day-zee-RAY
Hello, sir. What would you like?

Client Une baguette, s'il vous plaît.
ewn bah-GET, seel voo PLEH
A baguette, please.

Baker Voilà. Un euro vingt, s'il vous plaît.
vwah-LAH. an nuh-roh VAN, seel voo PLEH
Here you are. One euro twenty, please.

Client Merci. Bonne journée !
mehr-SEE. bun zhoor-NAY
Thanks. Have a good day!

Baker Merci, vous aussi ! Au revoir !
mehr-SEE, voo-zoh-SEE. oh ruh-VWAHR
Thanks, you too! Goodbye!

CULTURE NOTE

Friends and family often greet each other with **la bise**: light kisses on the cheeks (usually two, but it depends on the region). With strangers and at work, a handshake is normal.

Read each line aloud. Smile: it really helps the sound!

Bonjour !

Bonsoir, madame.

Salut, ça va ?

Merci beaucoup !

De rien.

S'il vous plaît.

Au revoir, à bientôt !

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Quick quiz

QUIZ

1. It's 8 pm and you walk into a restaurant. What do you say?
   - ○ A) Bonne nuit !
   - ○ B) À demain !
   - ○ C) Bonsoir !

2. Which 'you' do you use with a shop assistant?
   - ○ A) tu
   - ○ B) vous
   - ○ C) toi

3. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: Merci beaucoup !)
   - ○ A) Thank you very much
   - ○ B) You're welcome
   - ○ C) See you very soon
   - ○ D) Excuse me, please

4. Someone says Merci ! What do you answer?
   - ○ A) S'il vous plaît.
   - ○ B) De rien.
   - ○ C) Pardon.
   - ○ D) Bonne nuit.

5. How do you say 'please' to a friend?
   - ○ A) S'il vous plaît
   - ○ B) Merci bien
   - ○ C) De rien
   - ○ D) S'il te plaît

6. Listen. When will you see this person again? (listen in the web app: À demain !)
   - ○ A) This evening
   - ○ B) Very soon
   - ○ C) Tomorrow
   - ○ D) Next week

7. What does this mean?

   Ça va ?

   - ○ A) Where are you going?
   - ○ B) What's your name?
   - ○ C) How's it going?
   - ○ D) Is it far?

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Moi

UNIT 3 · LESSON 2 · 12 MINUTES

Introducing Yourself

Your name, your country, your age

- Say your name and ask someone else's
- Say where you're from and your nationality
- Say how old you are

Let's talk about **you**! With a few short phrases you can give your name, your country and your age, and ask the same questions back.

Je m'appelle Sophie.

Je	m'appelle	Sophie
I	call myself	Sophie

zhuh mah-PEL soh-FEE

My name is Sophie.

Literally 'I call myself Sophie'. You can also say Je suis Sophie (I am Sophie).

Names

Comment vous appelez-vous ?
koh-mahn voo-zah-play-VOO
What's your name? (polite)

Tu t'appelles comment ?
tew tah-PEL koh-MAHN
What's your name? (friendly)

Je m'appelle Tom.
zhuh mah-PEL TOM
My name is Tom.

Moi, c'est Sam.
mwah, seh SAM
I'm Sam.
Relaxed and very common.

Enchanté. / Enchantée.
ahn-shahn-TAY
Nice to meet you.
Women add -e in writing. It sounds the same.

MEMORY TRICK

appeler means 'to call'. It's in the same family as the English word **appellation**, a name.

Countries & nationalities

French	Say it	Meaning
la France	lah FRAHNS	France
français / française	frahn-SEH / frahn-SEZ	French (man / woman)

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French	Say it	Meaning
l'Angleterre	lahn-gluh-TEHR	England
anglais / anglaise	ahn-GLEH / ahn-GLEZ	English (man / woman)
les États-Unis	lay-zay-tah-zew-NEE	the United States
américain / américaine	ah-may-ree-KAN / ah-may-ree-KEN	American (man / woman)
le Canada	luh kah-nah-DAH	Canada
canadien / canadienne	kah-nah-DYAN / kah-nah-DYEN	Canadian (man / woman)
l'Inde	LAND	India
indien / indienne	an-DYAN / an-DYEN	Indian (man / woman)
l'Australie	loh-strah-LEE	Australia
australien / australienne	oh-strah-LYAN / oh-strah-LYEN	Australian (man / woman)

WATCH OUT

Nationalities take **no capital letter** after être: Je suis anglais. Countries do: l'Angleterre.

Where are you from?

Vous venez d'où ?
voo vuh-nay DOO
Where are you from? (polite)

Tu viens d'où ?
tew vyan DOO
Where are you from? (friendly)

Je viens de Londres.
zhuh vyan duh LOHNDR
I'm from London.

Je suis américaine.
zhuh swee-zah-may-ree-KEN
I'm American. (woman)

J'habite à Paris.
zhah-BEET ah pah-REE
I live in Paris.

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J'ai vingt-cinq ans.

J'ai	vingt-cinq	ans
I have	twenty-five	years

zhay van-san-KAHN

I'm twenty-five.

In French you **have** your age: 'I have 25 years'. Never say je suis 25.

Your age

Tu as quel âge ?
tew ah kel AHZH
How old are you?

J'ai seize ans.
zhay seh-ZAHN
I'm sixteen.

J'ai trente ans.
zhay trahn-TAHN
I'm thirty.

At a language café

Léa Salut ! Je m'appelle Léa. Et toi ?
sah-LEW. zhuh mah-PEL lay-AH. ay TWAH
Hi! My name's Léa. And you?

Sam Moi, c'est Sam. Enchanté !
mwah, seh SAM. ahn-shahn-TAY
I'm Sam. Nice to meet you!

Léa Tu viens d'où, Sam ?
tew vyan DOO, SAM
Where are you from, Sam?

Sam Je suis canadien. J'habite à Toronto.
zhuh swee kah-nah-DYAN. zhah-BEET ah toh-rohn-TOH
I'm Canadian. I live in Toronto.

Léa Moi, je suis française, de Lyon.
mwah, zhuh swee frahn-SEZ, duh lee-OHN
I'm French, from Lyon.

Sam Super ! Tu as quel âge ?
sew-PEHR. tew ah kel AHZH
Great! How old are you?

Léa J'ai dix-neuf ans.
zhay deez-nuh-VAHN
I'm nineteen.

TIP

Et toi ? and Et vous ? (and you?) are the easiest way to keep a conversation going.

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Say these lines aloud, then make them true for you.

Bonjour, je m'appelle Alex.

Enchanté !

Je viens de Manchester.

Je suis anglaise.

J'ai dix-huit ans.

J'habite à Bruxelles.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

8. How do you say 'My name is Tom'?

- ○ A) Je m'appelle Tom.
- ○ B) Je suis appelle Tom.
- ○ C) Mon appelle Tom.
- ○ D) J'ai nom Tom.

9. How do you say 'I'm 20 years old'?

- ○ A) Je suis vingt ans.
- ○ B) Je vingt ans.
- ○ C) J'ai vingt ans.
- ○ D) J'ai vingt années.

10. Listen. What is this person saying? (listen in the web app: Enchantée !)

- ○ A) See you later.
- ○ B) Nice to meet you.
- ○ C) I'm very sorry.
- ○ D) Where are you from?

11. A woman from France says: Je suis ___.

- ○ A) française
- ○ B) français
- ○ C) France
- ○ D) Française

12. What does this mean?

Tu viens d'où ?

- ○ A) Where are you going?
- ○ B) Where do you work?
- ○ C) Where are you from?
- ○ D) How old are you?

13. Listen. What does the speaker tell you? (listen in the web app: J'habite à Paris.)

- ○ A) Their name
- ○ B) Their age
- ○ C) Their nationality
- ○ D) Where they live

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UNIT 3 · LESSON 3 · 12 MINUTES

20

Numbers 0–20

Count, listen and use your first numbers

- Count from 0 to 20
- Recognise numbers when you hear them
- Use numbers in short phrases

Numbers are everywhere: prices, phone numbers, ages, bus lines. The good news: 0 to 16 are single words you simply learn, and 17 to 19 build themselves.

0 to 10

French	Say it	Meaning
zéro	zay-ROH	0 (zero)
un / une	AN / EWN	1 (one), masculine / feminine une pomme (ewn POM) — one apple
deux	DUH	2 (two)
trois	TRWAH	3 (three)
quatre	KAHTR	4 (four)
cinq	SANK	5 (five)
six	SEESS	6 (six)
sept	SET	7 (seven) The P is silent
huit	WEET	8 (eight)
neuf	NUHF	9 (nine)
dix	DEESS	10 (ten)

WATCH OUT

The last sound of six, huit, dix changes before a noun: six alone is 'seess', but six livres is 'see LEEVR' and six amis is 'see-zah-MEE'. Don't worry: people understand you either way.

11 to 16

French	Say it	Meaning
onze	OHNZ	11 (eleven)

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French	Say it	Meaning
douze	DOOZ	12 (twelve)
treize	TREZ	13 (thirteen)
quatorze	kah-TORZ	14 (fourteen)
quinze	KANZ	15 (fifteen)
seize	SEZ	16 (sixteen)

17 to 20

French	Say it	Meaning
dix-sept	dee-SET	17 (ten-seven)
dix-huit	dee-ZWEET	18 (ten-eight)
dix-neuf	deez-NUHF	19 (ten-nine)
vingt	VAN	20 (twenty) The G and T are silent

MEMORY TRICK

17, 18 and 19 are simple maths: dix-sept = ten-seven, dix-huit = ten-eight, dix-neuf = ten-nine.

Don't mix them up

deux

2: short 'uh'

No sound at the end. Round your lips and say 'duh'.

douze

12: 'oo' + z

An 'oo' sound with a buzzing z at the end.

seize

16: 'eh' + z

Rhymes with treize (13). Don't confuse it with six (6).

Numbers in action

J'ai deux frères.

zhay duh FREHR

I have two brothers.

Le bus numéro douze.

luh bewss new-may-roh DOOZ

The number 12 bus.

Elle a dix-sept ans.

el ah dee-seh-TAHN

She's seventeen.

Il y a onze joueurs.

eel-yah ohnz zhoo-UHR

There are eleven players.

DID YOU KNOW?

neuf means both **nine** and **new**! Before ans (years) and heures (hours), its F sounds like a V: neuf ans = 'nuh-VAHN'.

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Count aloud from 0 to 20, then try it backwards!

zéro, un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq

six, sept, huit, neuf, dix

onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize

dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt

Listen and write

A teacher or friend reads each item aloud, or press "Listen" in the web app. Write what you hear; answers are at the end of the unit.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

Quick quiz

QUIZ

14. Listen. Which number do you hear? (listen in the web app: quinze)

- ○ A) 5
- ○ B) 50
- ○ C) 15
- ○ D) 14

15. How do you write 12 in French?

- ○ A) deux
- ○ B) treize
- ○ C) douze
- ○ D) doux

16. What number is this?

dix-huit

- ○ A) 18
- ○ B) 10
- ○ C) 8
- ○ D) 19

17. Listen. Which number? (listen in the web app: seize)

- ○ A) 16
- ○ B) 6
- ○ C) 7
- ○ D) 13

18. What is trois + quatre?

- ○ A) six
- ○ B) huit
- ○ C) cinq
- ○ D) sept

19. What number is vingt?

- ○ A) 12
- ○ B) 2
- ○ C) 20
- ○ D) 15

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20. How do you say 'I'm nine years old'?

- ○ A) Je suis neuf ans.
- ○ B) J'ai neuf ans.
- ○ C) Je neuf ans.
- ○ D) J'ai ans neuf.

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UNIT 3 · LESSON 4 · 15 MINUTES

Numbers to 100 & Prices

Tens, the famous 70-80-90, and euros

- Count by tens up to 100
- Understand 70, 80 and 90
- Read and say prices in euros

From 20 to 69, French numbers are regular. Then come 70, 80 and 90, where French does a little maths. Once you see the trick, you can read any price.

The tens

French	Say it	Meaning
vingt	VAN	20
trente	TRAHNT	30
quarante	kah-RAHNT	40
cinquante	san-KAHNT	50
soixante	swah-SAHNT	60
soixante-dix	swah-sahnt-DEESS	70 (sixty-ten)
quatre-vingts	kah-truh-VAN	80 (four twenties)
quatre-vingt-dix	kah-truh-van-DEESS	90 (four twenties + ten)
cent	SAHN	100

Building 21 to 69

Tens + hyphen + units. For 21, 31, 41, 51 and 61, say et un (and one) instead.

vingt et un (van-tay-AN) · vingt-deux (vant-DUH) · trente-cinq (trahnt-SANK) · quarante-huit (kah-rahn-TWEET) · soixante et un (swah-sahn-tay-AN)

70 to 99: French maths

soixante-dix
swah-sahnt-DEESS
70 = 60 + 10

soixante et onze
swah-sahn-tay-OHNZ
71 = 60 + 11

soixante-quinze
swah-sahnt-KANZ
75 = 60 + 15

quatre-vingts
kah-truh-VAN
80 = 4 × 20

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quatre-vingt-un
kah-truh-van-AN
81 = 4 × 20 + 1
No et here!

quatre-vingt-dix-sept
kah-truh-van-dee-SET
97 = 4 × 20 + 17

MEMORY TRICK
After 60, keep counting with 10 to 19: soixante-dix, soixante et onze, soixante-douze... After 80, do it again: quatre-vingt-dix, quatre-vingt-onze...

WATCH OUT
quatre-vingts (80) has an **s**, but it drops when another number follows: quatre-vingt-trois (83).

CULTURE NOTE
In Belgium and Switzerland people say septante (70) and nonante (90), and in parts of Switzerland huitante (80). Much easier! In France, use the forms above.

Money words

French	Say it	Meaning
un euro	an nuh-ROH	one euro
un centime	an sahn-TEEM	one cent
C'est combien ?	seh kohm-BYAN	How much is it?
Ça coûte...	sah KOOT	It costs...
Ça fait...	sah FEH	That comes to...
cher / chère	SHEHR	expensive
pas cher	pah SHEHR	cheap, not expensive
l'addition	lah-dee-SYOHN	the bill (in a restaurant)

TIP
French prices use a comma: 2,50 €. Say it as deux euros cinquante. People usually drop the word centimes.

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Prices

deux euros cinquante
duh-zuh-roh san-KAHNT
€2.50

un euro vingt
an nuh-roh VAN
€1.20

quinze euros
kan-zuh-ROH
€15

neuf euros quatre-vingt-dix-neuf
nuh-fuh-roh kah-truh-van-deez-NUHF
€9.99

soixante-quatorze euros
swah-sahnt-kah-tor-zuh-ROH
€74

C'est combien, le croissant ?

C'est	combien	le	croissant
it is	how much	the	croissant

seh kohm-BYAN, luh krwah-SAHN

How much is the croissant?

At the market

Client Bonjour ! Les tomates, c'est combien ?
bohn-ZHOOR. lay toh-MAHT, seh kohm-BYAN
Hello! How much are the tomatoes?

Seller Trois euros le kilo.
trwah-zuh-ROH luh kee-LOH
Three euros a kilo.

Client Un kilo, s'il vous plaît. Et deux citrons.
an kee-LOH, seel voo PLEH. ay duh see-TROHN
One kilo, please. And two lemons.

Seller Ça fait quatre euros vingt.
sah feh kah-truh-roh VAN
That's €4.20.

Client Voilà cinq euros.
vwah-LAH san-kuh-ROH
Here's five euros.

Seller Et quatre-vingts centimes. Merci !
ay kah-truh-van sahn-TEEM. mehr-SEE
And 80 cents change. Thank you!

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Read these numbers and prices aloud.

trente, quarante, cinquante, soixante

soixante-dix, quatre-vingts, quatre-vingt-dix, cent

vingt et un, trente-deux, quarante-trois

C'est combien ?

Ça fait douze euros cinquante.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

21. What number is quatre-vingts?

- ○ A) 24
- ○ B) 84
- ○ C) 90
- ○ D) 80

22. Listen. Which number? (listen in the web app: soixante-quinze)

- ○ A) 75
- ○ B) 65
- ○ C) 60
- ○ D) 57

23. How do you say 71?

- ○ A) soixante-dix-un
- ○ B) soixante et onze
- ○ C) septante-un-dix
- ○ D) sept et dix

24. What does this mean?

C'est combien ?

- ○ A) What is it?
- ○ B) Is it far?
- ○ C) Who is it?
- ○ D) How much is it?

25. Listen. What's the price? (listen in the web app: douze euros cinquante)

- ○ A) €2.50
- ○ B) €12.15
- ○ C) €12.50
- ○ D) €20.50

26. How is 99 built in French?

- ○ A) 4 × 20 + 19
- ○ B) 9 × 11
- ○ C) 90 + 9
- ○ D) 100 − 1

27. Which word means 'the bill' in a restaurant?

- ○ A) le centime
- ○ B) la monnaie
- ○ C) l'addition
- ○ D) le prix

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Lun

UNIT 3 · LESSON 5 · 12 MINUTES

Days, Months & Dates

Make plans and talk about birthdays

- Name the days of the week
- Name the twelve months
- Say today's date and your birthday

Making plans? You need days, months and dates. Good news: French dates are simpler than English ones.

Days of the week

French	Say it	Meaning
lundi	lun-DEE	Monday Moon (lune)
mardi	mar-DEE	Tuesday Mars
mercredi	mehr-kruh-DEE	Wednesday Mercury
jeudi	zhuh-DEE	Thursday Jupiter
vendredi	vahn-druh-DEE	Friday Venus
samedi	sahm-DEE	Saturday
dimanche	dee-MAHNSH	Sunday

MEMORY TRICK

Most days come from the planets: lundi Moon, mardi Mars, mercredi Mercury, jeudi Jupiter, vendredi Venus. All but dimanche end in **-di**, from Latin *dies* (day).

WATCH OUT

Days and months take **no capital letter** in French: lundi, janvier.

Months

French	Say it	Meaning
janvier	zhahn-VYAY	January
février	fay-vree-YAY	February
mars	MARSS	March
avril	ah-VREEL	April

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French	Say it	Meaning
mai	MEH	May
juin	ZHWAN	June
juillet	zhwee-YEH	July
août	OOT	August Often just 'oo'
septembre	sep-TAHMBR	September
octobre	ok-TOBR	October
novembre	noh-VAHMBR	November
décembre	day-SAHMBR	December

WATCH OUT

juin (June) and juillet (July) sound close. Listen to the end: 'zhwan' versus 'zhwee-YEH'.

Saying the date

le + number + month. Use ordinary numbers, except for the 1st: le premier.

How to say it: Today is... = On est le... or Nous sommes le...

le quatorze juillet
luh kah-torz zhwee-YEH

le premier mai
luh pruh-myay MEH

le vingt-cinq décembre
luh vant-sank day-SAHMBR

le trois mars
luh trwah MARSS

Useful time words

French	Say it	Meaning
aujourd'hui	oh-zhoor-DWEE	today
demain	duh-MAN	tomorrow
hier	ee-YEHR	yesterday
la semaine	lah suh-MEN	the week
le week-end	luh wee-KEND	the weekend
le mois	luh MWAH	the month
l'année	lah-NAY	the year

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Mon anniversaire, c'est le dix mai.

Mon	anniversaire	c'est	le	dix	mai
my	birthday	it is	the	ten	May

moh-nah-nee-vehr-SEHR, seh luh dee MEH

My birthday is on the tenth of May.

Le lundi or lundi?

Le lundi, j'ai sport.

luh lun-DEE, zhay SPOR

On Mondays, I have sport.

le + day = every Monday.

Lundi, je vais à Paris.

lun-DEE, zhuh veh ah pah-REE

On Monday, I'm going to Paris.

No article = this coming Monday.

Anna On est le combien aujourd'hui ?
ohn-neh luh kohm-BYAN oh-zhoor-DWEE
What's the date today?

Marc On est le premier avril.
ohn-neh luh pruh-myay-rah-VREEL
It's the first of April.

Anna Le premier avril ? C'est mon anniversaire !
luh pruh-myay-rah-VREEL? seh moh-nah-nee-vehr-SEHR
The first of April? It's my birthday!

Marc Vraiment ? Ce n'est pas un poisson d'avril ?
vreh-MAHN? suh neh pah-zan pwah-sohn dah-VREEL
Really? It's not an April Fool's joke?

Anna Non ! Je suis née le premier avril.
NOHN. zhuh swee NAY luh pruh-myay-rah-VREEL
No! I was born on the first of April.

Marc Alors, joyeux anniversaire !
ah-LOR, zhwah-yuh-zah-nee-vehr-SEHR
Well then, happy birthday!

CULTURE NOTE

On 1 April, French children try to stick a paper fish on people's backs without being noticed: a poisson d'avril (April fish)!

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Say the days and months in order, then the dates.

lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi, samedi, dimanche

janvier, février, mars, avril, mai, juin

juillet, août, septembre, octobre, novembre, décembre

Aujourd'hui, on est le premier juin.

Mon anniversaire, c'est le vingt mars.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

28. Which day comes after mardi?

- A) jeudi
- B) lundi
- C) mercredi
- D) dimanche

29. Listen. Which day is it? (listen in the web app: jeudi)

- A) Tuesday
- B) Thursday
- C) Wednesday
- D) Saturday

30. How do you say 'the 1st of May'?

- A) le premier mai
- B) le un mai
- C) le une mai
- D) la première mai

31. Which month is août?

- A) April
- B) October
- C) August
- D) July

32. What does demain mean?

- A) tomorrow
- B) yesterday
- C) today
- D) next week

33. Which is written correctly in a French sentence?

- A) le 3 Mars
- B) le Mars 3
- C) Le 3 de Mars
- D) le 3 mars

34. Listen. Which date is it? (listen in the web app: le quatorze juillet)

- A) 14 July
- B) 4 July
- C) 14 June
- D) 24 July

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UNIT 3 · LESSON 6 · 14 MINUTES

h Telling the Time

Hours, quarters, halves and the 24-hour clock

- Ask and say the time
- Use et quart, et demie and moins le quart
- Understand the 24-hour clock

Quelle heure est-il ? means 'What time is it?'. French uses heure (hour) for every time, and the 24-hour clock is very common for trains, shops and TV.

Il est trois heures.

Il	est	trois	heures
it	is	three	hours

eel eh trwah-ZUHR

It's three o'clock.

Always say heures, even when English says nothing: 'It is three hours'.

Asking the time

Quelle heure est-il ?
kel uh-reh-TEEL
What time is it?

Il est quelle heure ?
eel eh kel UHR
What time is it? (relaxed)

Vous avez l'heure ?
voo-zah-vay LUHR
Do you have the time?

On the hour

Il est une heure.
eel eh-tew-NUHR
It's one o'clock.
une, because heure is feminine.

Il est deux heures.
eel eh duh-ZUHR
It's two o'clock.

Il est midi.
eel eh mee-DEE
It's noon.

Il est minuit.
eel eh mee-NWEE
It's midnight.

Minutes, quarters and halves

Il est trois heures dix.
eel eh trwah-zuhr DEESS
3:10

Il est trois heures et quart.
eel eh trwah-zuhr ay KAR
3:15 (quarter past)

Il est trois heures et demie.
eel eh trwah-zuhr ay duh-MEE
3:30 (half past)

Il est quatre heures moins le quart.
eel eh kah-truhr mwan luh KAR
3:45 (quarter to four)

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Il est quatre heures moins dix.

eel eh kah-truhr mwan DEESS

3:50 (ten to four)

MEMORY TRICK

moins means **minus**: quatre heures moins dix = four o'clock minus ten = 3:50.

The 24-hour clock

Time	Everyday French	Official (trains, shops)
8:00 am	huit heures (du matin)	huit heures
2:00 pm	deux heures (de l'après-midi)	quatorze heures
6:30 pm	six heures et demie (du soir)	dix-huit heures trente
9:15 pm	neuf heures et quart (du soir)	vingt et une heures quinze

TIP

With the 24-hour clock, use plain minutes: trente (30) and quinze (15), not et demie or et quart.

Time words

French	Say it	Meaning
le matin	luh mah-TAN	the morning
l'après-midi	lah-preh-mee-DEE	the afternoon
le soir	luh SWAHR	the evening
la nuit	lah NWEE	the night
tôt	TOH	early
tard	TAR	late
en retard	ahn ruh-TAR	late (for something) Je suis en retard ! (zhuh swee-zahn ruh-TAR) — I'm late!
à l'heure	ah LUHR	on time
une demi-heure	ewn duh-mee-UHR	half an hour

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Le train part à dix-huit heures.

Le	train	part	à	dix-huit	heures
the	train	leaves	at	eighteen	hours

luh tran par ah dee-zwee-TUHR

The train leaves at 6 pm.

Use à for 'at' a time.

Tom Excusez-moi, vous avez l'heure ?
ex-kew-zay-MWAH, voo-zah-vay LUHR
Excuse me, do you have the time?

Woman Oui, il est midi moins le quart.
WEE, eel eh mee-dee mwan luh KAR
Yes, it's quarter to twelve.

Tom Merci ! Le musée ferme à quelle heure ?
mehr-SEE. luh mew-ZAY fehrm ah kel UHR
Thanks! What time does the museum close?

Woman À dix-sept heures trente, je crois.
ah dee-seh-tuhr TRAHNT, zhuh KRWAH
At 5:30 pm, I think.

Tom Parfait, j'ai le temps !
par-FEH, zhay luh TAHN
Perfect, I have time!

Read the times aloud.

Quelle heure est-il ?

Il est une heure.

Il est six heures et quart.

Il est neuf heures et demie.

Il est midi moins le quart.

Le film commence à vingt heures.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

35. How do you say 'It's 2:30'?

- ○ A) Il est deux heures et quart.
- ○ B) Il est deux heures moins le quart.
- ○ C) Il est deux heures et demie.
- ○ D) Il est demie deux heures.

36. Listen. What time is it? (listen in the web app: Il est huit heures moins le quart.)

- ○ A) 8:15
- ○ B) 8:45
- ○ C) 7:45
- ○ D) 7:15

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37. dix-neuf heures is...

- ○ A) 9 pm
- ○ B) 9 am
- ○ C) 10 pm
- ○ D) 7 pm

38. Why do we say une heure, not un heure?

- ○ A) Un is only used for money.
- ○ B) Une is the plural of un.
- ○ C) Heure is a feminine noun.

39. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: minuit)

- ○ A) noon
- ○ B) one o'clock
- ○ C) midnight
- ○ D) half past

40. What does le soir mean?

- ○ A) the morning
- ○ B) the afternoon
- ○ C) the evening
- ○ D) the weekend

41. How do you say 'at five o'clock'?

- ○ A) dans cinq heures
- ○ B) en cinq heures
- ○ C) à cinq heures
- ○ D) il cinq heures

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UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · 12 MINUTES

Family

Talk about the people closest to you

- Name family members
- Say 'my' with mon, ma and mes
- Describe your family in a few sentences

Family is a favourite topic in any first conversation. Learn the words, then use mon, ma and mes (my) to talk about your own.

Close family

French	Say it	Meaning
la famille	lah fah-MEEY	the family
le père	luh PEHR	the father
la mère	lah MEHR	the mother
les parents	lay pah-RAHN	the parents (also: relatives)
le frère	luh FREHR	the brother
la sœur	lah SUHR	the sister
le fils	luh FEESS	the son
la fille	lah FEEY	the daughter / the girl
l'enfant	lahn-FAHN	the child
le mari	luh mah-REE	the husband
la femme	lah FAHM	the wife / the woman

WATCH OUT

fils (son) sounds like 'feess': the L is silent and the S is pronounced. fille (daughter) sounds like 'feey': the double L sounds like 'y'.

The wider family

French	Say it	Meaning
le grand-père	luh grahn-PEHR	the grandfather
la grand-mère	lah grahn-MEHR	the grandmother

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French	Say it	Meaning
les grands-parents	lay grahn-pah-RAHN	the grandparents
l'oncle	LOHNKL	the uncle
la tante	lah TAHNT	the aunt
le cousin / la cousine	luh koo-ZAN / lah koo-ZEEN	the cousin (male / female)
le neveu	luh nuh-VUH	the nephew
la nièce	lah NYESS	the niece

DID YOU KNOW?

Children call their parents papa and maman, and their grandparents papi and mamie.

My: mon, ma, mes

Before...	'my' is...	Example
a masculine noun	mon	mon père (my father)
a feminine noun	ma	ma mère (my mother)
a plural noun	mes	mes parents (my parents)
a feminine noun starting with a vowel	mon	mon amie (my friend, female)

TIP

'Your' (friendly) works the same way: ton frère, ta sœur, tes cousins. You'll meet all the possessives in Unit 4.

J'ai une sœur et deux frères.

J'ai	une	sœur	et	deux	frères
I have	one / a	sister	and	two	brothers

zhay ewn SUHR ay duh FREHR

I have one sister and two brothers.

Tu as des frères et sœurs ?

tew ah day frehr ay SUHR

Do you have brothers and sisters?

Je suis fils unique.

zhuh swee fee-sew-NEEK

I'm an only child. (boy)

Je suis fille unique.

zhuh swee fee-yew-NEEK

I'm an only child. (girl)

Ma mère s'appelle Claire.

mah mehr sah-pel KLEHR

My mother's name is Claire.

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Mes grands-parents habitent à Nice.

may grahn-pah-RAHN ah-beet ah NEESS

My grandparents live in Nice.

Inès C'est qui, sur la photo ?
seh KEE, sewr lah foh-TOH
Who's that in the photo?

Ben C'est ma famille. Voici mon père et ma mère.
seh mah fah-MEEY. vwah-SEE mohn pehr ay mah MEHR
That's my family. Here are my father and my mother.

Inès Et la petite fille ?
ay lah puh-teet FEEY
And the little girl?

Ben C'est ma sœur, Zoé. Elle a six ans.
seh mah SUHR, zoh-AY. el ah see-ZAHN
That's my sister, Zoé. She's six.

Inès Elle est mignonne ! Tu as des cousins ?
el eh mee-NYON. tew ah day koo-ZAN
She's cute! Do you have cousins?

Ben Oui, beaucoup ! Ma tante a cinq enfants.
WEE, boh-KOO. mah tahnt ah san-kahn-FAHN
Yes, lots! My aunt has five children.

Describe this family aloud, then your own.

Voici ma famille.

Mon père s'appelle Paul.

Ma sœur a douze ans.

J'ai deux cousins et une cousine.

Mes grands-parents habitent à Lyon.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

42. How do you say 'my mother'?

- ○ A) mon mère
- ○ B) mes mère
- ○ C) ma mère
- ○ D) me mère

43. Listen. Who is it? (listen in the web app: mon grand-père)

- ○ A) my grandfather
- ○ B) my grandmother
- ○ C) my big brother
- ○ D) my uncle

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44. la sœur de ma mère is my...

- ○ A) cousin
- ○ B) aunt
- ○ C) sister
- ○ D) niece

45. Which word means 'son'?

- ○ A) la fille
- ○ B) le frère
- ○ C) le neveu
- ○ D) le fils

46. Complete (my): ___ parents sont sympas.

- ○ A) Mon
- ○ B) Mes
- ○ C) Ma

47. Listen. What is the question? (listen in the web app: Tu as des frères et sœurs ?)

- ○ A) Do you have brothers and sisters?
- ○ B) Are your parents at home today?
- ○ C) Is your sister older than you?
- ○ D) How old is your brother?

48. How does a girl say 'I'm an only child'?

- ○ A) J'ai une seule fille.
- ○ B) Je suis fille unique.
- ○ C) Je suis la fille.
- ○ D) Je suis une fille seule.

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Thé

UNIT 3 · LESSON 8 · 14 MINUTES

Food & Drinks

Order in a café and say what you like

- Name everyday foods and drinks
- Order politely in a café
- Say what you like and don't like

Food is at the heart of French life. Learn the basics and you're ready for a café, a bakery or a market.

Food

French	Say it	Meaning
le pain	luh PAN	bread
la baguette	lah bah-GET	baguette (long loaf)
le croissant	luh krwah-SAHN	croissant
le fromage	luh froh-MAHZH	cheese
le beurre	luh BUHR	butter
l'œuf	LUHF	egg des œufs (day-ZUH) — (some) eggs
la viande	lah VYAHND	meat
le poulet	luh poo-LEH	chicken
le poisson	luh pwah-SOHN	fish
les légumes	lay lay-GEWM	vegetables
les frites	lay FREET	chips / fries
le riz	luh REE	rice
les pâtes	lay PAHT	pasta
la pomme	lah POM	apple
la salade	lah sah-LAHD	salad / lettuce

WATCH OUT

poisson (fish) is 'pwah-SOHN' with a hissing S. poison (poison) is 'pwah-ZOHN' with a buzzing Z. One S or two makes a big difference!

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Drinks

French	Say it	Meaning
l'eau	LOH	water
le café	luh kah-FAY	coffee
le thé	luh TAY	tea
le lait	luh LEH	milk
le jus d'orange	luh zhew doh-RAHNZH	orange juice
le vin	luh VAN	wine
la bière	lah BYEHR	beer
le chocolat chaud	luh shoh-koh-lah SHOH	hot chocolate

CULTURE NOTE

In a French café, un café is a small espresso. Want it with milk? Ask for un café crème (or just un crème).

I'd like...

To order politely, say Je voudrais... (I would like...). It's softer than Je veux (I want).

Je voudrais un café, s'il vous plaît.
zhuh voo-DREH an kah-FAY, seel voo PLEH

Je voudrais de l'eau.
zhuh voo-dreh duh LOH

Pour moi, un thé.
poor MWAH, an TAY

Likes and dislikes

J'aime le chocolat.
zhem luh shoh-koh-LAH
I like chocolate.

J'adore les frites !
zhah-dor lay FREET
I love fries!

Je n'aime pas le poisson.
zhuh nem pah luh pwah-SOHN
I don't like fish.

Je préfère le thé.
zhuh pray-fehr luh TAY
I prefer tea.

TIP

After aimer, adorer and préférer, use le / la / les: J'aime le fromage = I like cheese (in general).

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Je voudrais un croissant et un café, s'il vous plaît.

Je	voudrais	un	croissant	et	un	café	s'il	vous	plaît
I	would like	a	croissant	and	a	coffee	if it	you	pleases

zhuh voo-DREH an krwah-SAHN ay an kah-FAY, seel voo PLEH

I'd like a croissant and a coffee, please.

s'il vous plaît literally means 'if it pleases you'.

At the café

Waiter Bonjour ! Qu'est-ce que je vous sers ?
bohn-ZHOOR. kes-kuh zhuh voo SEHR
Hello! What can I get you?

Emma Je voudrais un chocolat chaud, s'il vous plaît.
zhuh voo-DREH an shoh-koh-lah SHOH, seel voo PLEH
I'd like a hot chocolate, please.

Waiter Et pour monsieur ?
ay poor muh-SYUH
And for you, sir?

Léo Pour moi, un café et un croissant.
poor MWAH, an kah-FAY ay an krwah-SAHN
For me, a coffee and a croissant.

Waiter Très bien. Et avec ceci ?
treh BYAN. ay ah-vek suh-SEE
Very good. Anything else?

Léo Une carafe d'eau, s'il vous plaît.
ewn kah-rahf DOH, seel voo PLEH
A jug of tap water, please.

Waiter Avec plaisir !
ah-vek pleh-ZEER
With pleasure!

CULTURE NOTE

Une carafe d'eau is free tap water in French restaurants and cafés. Just ask!

Order these aloud, as if you're in a café.

Je voudrais un thé, s'il vous plaît.

Pour moi, un jus d'orange.

J'adore le fromage !

Je n'aime pas le café.

L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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49. Listen. What is it? (listen in the web app: le fromage)

- ○ A) bread
- ○ B) cheese
- ○ C) butter
- ○ D) milk

50. Which is the most polite way to order?

- ○ A) Je veux un thé, moi.
- ○ B) Donne-moi un thé !
- ○ C) Un thé. Vite !
- ○ D) Je voudrais un thé.

51. What does l'eau mean?

- ○ A) water
- ○ B) milk
- ○ C) wine
- ○ D) juice

52. How do you say 'I don't like fish'?

- ○ A) Je n'aime pas le poison.
- ○ B) Je ne pas aime le poisson.
- ○ C) Je n'aime pas le poisson.
- ○ D) Je aime ne le poisson.

53. In a French café, un café is...

- ○ A) a big mug of filter coffee
- ○ B) a coffee with lots of milk
- ○ C) a small espresso
- ○ D) an iced coffee

54. Listen. What is the waiter asking? (listen in the web app: Et avec ceci ?)

- ○ A) Is that to take away?
- ○ B) Anything else?
- ○ C) Did you enjoy it?
- ○ D) Cash or card?

55. What does les légumes mean?

- ○ A) the vegetables
- ○ B) the meat
- ○ C) the fruit
- ○ D) the drinks

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Or

UNIT 3 · LESSON 9 · 13 MINUTES

Colours & Clothes

Describe what people wear

- Name the main colours
- Name everyday clothes
- Make colours agree with the noun

Shopping for clothes or describing what someone is wearing? You need colours. In French, colours usually come **after** the noun.

Colours

French	Say it	Meaning
rouge	ROOZH	red
bleu / bleue	BLUH	blue
vert / verte	VEHR / VEHRT	green
jaune	ZHOHN	yellow
noir / noire	NWAHR	black
blanc / blanche	BLAHN / BLAHNSH	white
gris / grise	GREE / GREEZ	grey
rose	ROHZ	pink
violet / violette	vyoh-LEH / vyoh-LET	purple
orange	oh-RAHNZH	orange
marron	mah-ROHN	brown

Colours agree

Most colours add **-e** for feminine and **-s** for plural, like other adjectives. Colours already ending in -e (rouge, jaune, rose) don't change for feminine.

How to say it: orange and marron never change at all: des chaussures marron.

un pull vert
an pewl VEHR

une robe verte
ewn rob VEHRT

des chaussettes noires
day shoh-set NWAHR

une chemise blanche
ewn shuh-meez BLAHNSH

des chaussures marron
day shoh-sewr mah-ROHN

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MEMORY TRICK

Noun first, colour second: une voiture rouge = 'a car red'. Name the thing, then describe it.

Clothes

French	Say it	Meaning
le pantalon	luh pahn-tah-LOHN	trousers / pants un pantalon noir (an pahn-tah-lohn NWAHR) — (a pair of) black trousers
le jean	luh DJEEN	jeans
la chemise	lah shuh-MEEZ	shirt
le tee-shirt	luh tee-SHUHRT	T-shirt
le pull	luh PEWL	jumper / sweater
la robe	lah ROB	dress
la jupe	lah ZHEWP	skirt
la veste	lah VEST	jacket
le manteau	luh mahn-TOH	coat
les chaussures	lay shoh-SEWR	shoes
les chaussettes	lay shoh-SET	socks
le chapeau	luh shah-POH	hat

WATCH OUT

False friend! la veste is a **jacket**, not a vest. And un pantalon is one pair of trousers: it's singular in French.

What are you wearing?

Je porte un jean bleu.
zhuh port an djeen BLUH
I'm wearing blue jeans.

Elle porte une robe rouge.
el port ewn rob ROOZH
She's wearing a red dress.

Il a un manteau noir.
eel ah an mahn-toh NWAHR
He has a black coat.

Tu aimes ma veste ?
tew em mah VEST
Do you like my jacket?

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Je cherche une chemise blanche.

Je	cherche	une	chemise	blanche
I	am looking for	a	shirt	white

zhuh shehrsh ewn shuh-meez BLAHNSH

I'm looking for a white shirt.

chemise is feminine, so blanc becomes blanche.

In a shop

Assistant Bonjour ! Je peux vous aider ?
bohn-ZHOOR. zhuh puh voo-zeh-DAY
Hello! Can I help you?

Client Oui, je cherche un pull.
WEE, zhuh shehrsh an PEWL
Yes, I'm looking for a jumper.

Assistant De quelle couleur ?
duh kel koo-LUHR
What colour?

Client Bleu ou gris.
bluh oo GREE
Blue or grey.

Assistant Vous faites quelle taille ?
voo fet kel TAHY
What size are you?

Client Du M. Je peux l'essayer ?
dew EM. zhuh puh leh-seh-YAY
Medium. Can I try it on?

Assistant Bien sûr, la cabine est là-bas.
byan SEWR, lah kah-BEEN eh lah-BAH
Of course, the fitting room is over there.

Describe each outfit aloud.

un tee-shirt blanc et un jean bleu

une robe verte et des chaussures noires

un manteau gris et un chapeau rouge

Je porte une veste marron.

Ma sœur porte une jupe jaune.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

56. How do you say 'a green dress'?

- ○ A) une verte robe
- ○ B) une robe verte
- ○ C) une robe vert
- ○ D) un robe verte

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57. Listen. Which colour? (listen in the web app: noir)

- ○ A) white
- ○ B) brown
- ○ C) grey
- ○ D) black

58. What is la veste?

- ○ A) a vest
- ○ B) a skirt
- ○ C) a jacket
- ○ D) a scarf

59. Which colour never changes its form?

- ○ A) marron
- ○ B) vert
- ○ C) blanc
- ○ D) gris

60. How do you say 'white shoes'?

- ○ A) des chaussures blancs
- ○ B) des blanches chaussures
- ○ C) des chaussures blanches
- ○ D) des chaussures blanc

61. Listen. What does the shop assistant ask? (listen in the web app: Quelle taille ?)

- ○ A) What size?
- ○ B) What colour?
- ○ C) How much?
- ○ D) Which shop?

62. What does Je porte mean here: Je porte un pull?

- ○ A) I'm buying
- ○ B) I'm selling
- ○ C) I'm washing
- ○ D) I'm wearing

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Lit

UNIT 3 · LESSON 10 · 13 MINUTES

Home & Everyday Objects

Rooms, furniture and il y a

- Name the rooms of a home
- Name everyday objects
- Say what there is with il y a

Bienvenue chez moi ! Welcome to my home! Let's name the rooms and the things you use every day.

Rooms

French	Say it	Meaning
la maison	lah meh-ZOHN	house / home
l'appartement	lah-par-tuh-MAHN	flat / apartment
la pièce	lah PYESS	room
la cuisine	lah kwee-ZEEN	kitchen (also: cooking)
le salon	luh sah-LOHN	living room
la chambre	lah SHAHMBR	bedroom
la salle de bains	lah sahl duh BAN	bathroom
les toilettes	lay twah-LET	toilet
le jardin	luh zhar-DAN	garden
l'escalier	les-kah-LYAY	stairs

WATCH OUT

False friend: une chambre is a **bedroom**. Any room in general is une pièce.

Everyday objects

French	Say it	Meaning
la table	lah TAHBL	table
la chaise	lah SHEZ	chair
le lit	luh LEE	bed
le canapé	luh kah-nah-PAY	sofa

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French	Say it	Meaning
la porte	lah PORT	door
la fenêtre	lah fuh-NETR	window
la lampe	lah LAHMP	lamp
le frigo	luh free-GOH	fridge
le téléphone	luh tay-lay-FON	phone
l'ordinateur	lor-dee-nah-TUHR	computer
la clé	lah KLAY	key
le livre	luh LEEVR	book

There is / there are: il y a

il y a means both **there is** and **there are**. It never changes.

How to say it: Negative: il n'y a pas de... = there isn't any / there are no...

Il y a un lit.
eel-yah an LEE

Il y a deux chaises.
eel-yah duh SHEZ

Il n'y a pas de télé.
eel nyah pah duh tay-LAY

Where is it?

Le livre est sur la table.
luh leevr eh sewr lah TAHBL
The book is on the table.

Le chat est sous le lit.
luh shah eh soo luh LEE
The cat is under the bed.

Les clés sont dans la cuisine.
lay klay sohn dahn lah kwee-ZEEN
The keys are in the kitchen.

TIP

Three tiny words go a long way: sur (on), sous (under) and dans (in). You'll learn more in Unit 4.

Dans ma chambre, il y a un lit et une fenêtre.

Dans	ma	chambre	il	y	a	un	lit	et	une	fenêtre
in	my	bedroom	it	there	has	a	bed	and	a	window

dahn mah SHAHMBR, eel-yah an lee ay ewn fuh-NETR

In my bedroom, there is a bed and a window.

il y a is literally 'it there has'.

Flat hunting

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Agent Voici le salon. Il est grand, non ?
vwah-SEE luh sah-LOHN. eel eh GRAHN, NOHN
Here's the living room. It's big, isn't it?

Julie Oui, très ! Il y a combien de chambres ?
WEE, TREH. eel-yah kohm-byan duh SHAHMBR
Yes, very! How many bedrooms are there?

Agent Il y a deux chambres et une salle de bains.
eel-yah duh SHAHMBR ay ewn sahl duh BAN
There are two bedrooms and a bathroom.

Julie Et la cuisine ?
ay lah kwee-ZEEN
And the kitchen?

Agent Elle est à côté du salon. Il y a un frigo neuf.
el eh-tah koh-TAY dew sah-LOHN. eel-yah an free-goh NUHF
It's next to the living room. There's a new fridge.

Julie Parfait ! Il y a un jardin ?
par-FEH. eel-yah an zhar-DAN
Perfect! Is there a garden?

Agent Non, mais il y a un grand balcon.
NOHN, meh eel-yah an grahn bal-KOHN
No, but there's a big balcony.

Describe a home aloud.

Bienvenue chez moi !

Il y a trois pièces.

Dans le salon, il y a un canapé et une lampe.

Il n'y a pas de jardin.

Mes clés sont sur la table.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

63. What is la chambre?

- A) the kitchen
- B) the bedroom
- C) the bathroom
- D) the living room

64. Listen. What do you hear? (listen in the web app: Il y a deux chaises.)

- A) There are two cats.
- B) I have two chairs.
- C) There are two chairs.
- D) Two chairs are missing.

65. How do you say 'There's no fridge'?

- A) Il n'y a pas de frigo.
- B) Il ne pas y a frigo.
- C) Il y a non frigo.
- D) Pas il y a de frigo.

66. Le chat est sous le lit. Where is the cat?

- A) on the bed
- B) next to the bed
- C) under the bed
- D) in the bedroom

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67. Listen. What is it? (listen in the web app: la fenêtre)

- ○ A) the door
- ○ B) the window
- ○ C) the sofa
- ○ D) the lamp

68. Which word means 'key'?

- ○ A) la chaise
- ○ B) la cuisine
- ○ C) la clé
- ○ D) le lit

69. Which room do you cook in?

- ○ A) le salon
- ○ B) la salle de bains
- ○ C) la chambre
- ○ D) la cuisine

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UNIT 3

Answer key

Dictation

1. quatorze (kah-TORZ)
2. onze (OHNZ)
3. dix-neuf (deez-NUHF)
4. six (SEESS)
5. treize (TREZ)

Quiz

1. C) Bonsoir !
Bonsoir is the evening greeting. Bonne nuit is only for bedtime.

2. B) vous
Use polite vous with people you don't know.

3. A) Thank you very much

4. B) De rien.
De rien = it's nothing / you're welcome.

5. D) S'il te plaît
te goes with tu, vous with vous.

6. C) Tomorrow

7. C) How's it going?

8. A) Je m'appelle Tom.

9. C) J'ai vingt ans.
Use avoir for age: I **have** 20 years.

10. B) Nice to meet you.

11. A) française
Feminine ending -e, and no capital letter.

12. C) Where are you from?

13. D) Where they live

14. C) 15

15. C) douze

16. A) 18

17. A) 16

18. D) sept

19. C) 20

20. B) J'ai neuf ans.

21. D) 80
4 × 20 = 80.

22. A) 75
60 + 15 = 75.

23. B) soixante et onze

24. D) How much is it?

25. C) €12.50

26. A) 4 × 20 + 19

27. C) l'addition

28. C) mercredi

29. B) Thursday

30. A) le premier mai
Only the 1st uses premier; all other dates use plain numbers.

31. C) August

32. A) tomorrow

33. D) le 3 mars
No capital letters for months.

34. A) 14 July
France's national day!

35. C) Il est deux heures et demie.

36. C) 7:45
Eight o'clock minus a quarter = 7:45.

37. D) 7 pm
19 − 12 = 7, so 7 pm.

38. C) Heure is a feminine noun.

39. C) midnight

40. C) the evening

41. C) à cinq heures
dans cinq heures means 'in five hours' (from now).

42. C) ma mère

43. A) my grandfather

44. B) aunt

45. D) le fils

46. B) Mes
parents is plural, so use mes.

47. A) Do you have brothers and sisters?

48. B) Je suis fille unique.

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49. B) cheese

50. D) Je voudrais un thé.

51. A) water

52. C) Je n'aime pas le poisson.
Careful: poison means poison!

53. C) a small espresso

54. B) Anything else?

55. A) the vegetables

56. B) une robe verte

57. D) black

58. C) a jacket
False friend: veste = jacket.

59. A) marron

60. C) des chaussures blanches

61. A) What size?

62. D) I'm wearing

63. B) the bedroom

64. C) There are two chairs.

65. A) Il n'y a pas de frigo.

66. C) under the bed

67. B) the window

68. C) la clé

69. D) la cuisine

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UNIT 4

Grammar Made Easy

The patterns behind French, explained simply

1. Nouns & Gender
2. Articles: the, a, some
3. Être: to be
4. Avoir: to have
5. Regular -er Verbs
6. Saying No: ne... pas
7. Asking Questions
8. Adjectives: Agreement & Placement
9. Possessives: my, your, his, her
10. Aller & the Near Future
11. Key Irregular Verbs
12. Pronouns: I, me, him, it
13. The Past (1): Passé Composé with Avoir
14. The Past (2): Passé Composé with Être
15. Prepositions of Place

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UNIT 4 · LESSON 1 · 13 MINUTES

Nouns & Gender

Masculine, feminine and plural nouns

- Know that every noun is masculine or feminine
- Spot typical masculine and feminine endings
- Make nouns plural

In French, every noun has a gender: **masculine** or **feminine**. Even tables and chairs! It isn't about meaning: it's simply part of the word. So learn each noun **with its article**.

Every noun has a gender

le livre
luh LEEVR
the book (masculine)

la table
lah TAHBL
the table (feminine)

le soleil
luh soh-LEY
the sun (masculine)

la lune
lah LEWN
the moon (feminine)

le problème
luh proh-BLEM
the problem (masculine!)

la voiture
lah vwah-TEWR
the car (feminine)

MEMORY TRICK

Learn une table, not just table. The article is the word's gender label: le / un = masculine, la / une = feminine.

Endings that give a clue

Usually masculine	Example	Usually feminine	Example
-ment	le moment	-tion / -sion	la nation
-age	le fromage	-té	la liberté
-eau	le bateau	-ette	la baguette
-isme	le tourisme	-ure	la voiture
-er / -ier	le cahier	-ance / -ence	la chance

WATCH OUT

These are strong hints, not laws. la plage (beach), la page and l'eau (water) are feminine; le silence and l'été (summer) are masculine.

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People: gender follows the person

French	Say it	Meaning
un ami / une amie	an-nah-MEE / ew-nah-MEE	a friend (male / female)
un étudiant / une étudiante	an-nay-tew-DYAHN / ew-nay-tew-DYAHNT	a student (male / female)
un acteur / une actrice	an-nak-TUHR / ew-nak-TREESS	an actor / an actress
un chanteur / une chanteuse	an shahn-TUHR / ewn shahn-TUHZ	a singer (male / female)
un boulanger / une boulangère	an boo-lahn-ZHAY / ewn boo-lahn-ZHEHR	a baker (male / female)

Plurals: add -s

Most nouns add a silent **-s**. You hear the plural in the article: le / la becomes les, un / une becomes des.

How to say it: Words in -eau and most in -eu add -x. Most words in -al change to -aux.

un livre, des livres
an LEEVR, day LEEVR

le gâteau, les gâteaux
luh gah-TOH, lay gah-TOH

le jeu, les jeux
luh ZHUH, lay ZHUH

le cheval, les chevaux
luh shuh-VAL, lay shuh-VOH

TIP

The final -s and -x are silent: livre and livres sound the same. Listen to the article instead: le ('luh') versus les ('lay').

Les gâteaux sont sur la table.

Les	gâteaux	sont	sur	la	table
the (plural)	cakes	are	on	the (fem.)	table

lay gah-TOH sohn sewr lah TAHBL

The cakes are on the table.

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Read each noun with its article. Feel the gender!

le livre, la table

le moment, la nation

le fromage, la liberté

le bateau, les bateaux

un ami, une amie

le cheval, les chevaux

Quick quiz

QUIZ

1. Which noun is most likely feminine?
   - ○ A) situation
   - ○ B) fromage
   - ○ C) moment
   - ○ D) bateau
2. What is the plural of le bateau?
   - ○ A) les bateaus
   - ○ B) les bateau
   - ○ C) les bateaux
   - ○ D) la bateaux
3. Why learn nouns with le or la?
   - ○ A) To spell the plural
   - ○ B) To know their gender
   - ○ C) To make them louder
   - ○ D) To show they're plural
4. Listen. Singular or plural? (listen in the web app: les livres)
   - ○ A) Singular: you hear 'luh'
   - ○ B) Plural: you hear 'lay'
   - ○ C) You can't tell at all
5. Which ending usually means a masculine noun?
   - ○ A) -tion
   - ○ B) -té
   - ○ C) -ment
   - ○ D) -ure
6. The feminine of un acteur is...
   - ○ A) une acteure
   - ○ B) une actrice
   - ○ C) une acteuse
   - ○ D) un actrice
7. Which word is feminine even though it ends in -age?
   - ○ A) fromage
   - ○ B) voyage
   - ○ C) plage
   - ○ D) garage

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un

UNIT 4 · LESSON 2 · 15 MINUTES

Articles: the, a, some

le, la, les · un, une, des · du, de la

- Use le, la, l' and les (the)
- Use un, une and des (a, some)
- Use du, de la and de l' (some) with food and drink

English has 'the', 'a' and 'some'. French has a few more forms, because articles change with **gender** and **number**. Here's the whole set in three small tables.

The: le, la, l', les

	Masculine	Feminine	Plural
the	le livre	la table	les livres
the (before a vowel or silent h)	l'ami	l'eau	les amis

TIP

le and la shorten to l' before a vowel or a silent h: l'hôtel, l'école. This is called elision, and it makes French flow.

A / some: un, une, des

	Masculine	Feminine	Plural
a / some	un livre	une pomme	des amis
meaning	a book	an apple	(some) friends

MEMORY TRICK

English often drops 'some', but French needs des: J'ai des amis = I have (some) friends. A French noun almost never stands alone.

Some: du, de la, de l', des

Masculine	Feminine	Before a vowel	Plural
du pain	de la confiture	de l'eau	des pâtes
some bread	some jam	some water	some pasta

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When to use du / de la

Use du, de la, de l' for an amount of something you don't count: food, drinks, money, time, courage.

Je mange du pain.
zhuh mahnzh dew PAN

Tu veux de la salade ?
tew vuh duh lah sah-LAHD

Il boit de l'eau.
eel bwah duh LOH

Elle a du courage.
el ah dew koo-RAHZH

J'aime le fromage.

In general: le, la, les

Use after aimer, adorer, détester, préférer: cheese as a whole.

Je mange du fromage.

An amount: du, de la

Use when you eat, drink, buy or have **some** of it.

After a negative: de

After ne... pas, the articles un, une, des, du, de la all become de (or d').

Je n'ai pas de chien.
zhuh neh pah duh SHYAN

Il ne boit pas d'eau.
eel nuh bwah pah DOH

Nous n'avons pas de pain.
noo nah-vohn pah duh PAN

WATCH OUT

One exception: with être the article stays. C'est un chat becomes Ce n'est pas un chat.

Je voudrais du pain et de la confiture.

Je	voudrais	du	pain	et	de	la	confiture
I	would like	some	bread	and	some (of)	the	jam

zhuh voo-dreh dew PAN ay duh lah kohn-fee-TEWR

I'd like some bread and some jam.

de la works as one unit: 'some' for a feminine noun.

Read aloud and notice each article.

le pain, la confiture, l'eau, les pâtes

un croissant, une pomme, des fraises

Je mange du fromage.

Tu bois de l'eau ?

Je n'ai pas de voiture.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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8. Complete (the school): ___ école

- ○ A) la
- ○ B) le
- ○ C) les
- ○ D) l'

9. Complete (some milk): Je bois ___ lait.

- ○ A) de la
- ○ B) du
- ○ C) des

10. Complete: Je n'ai pas ___ voiture.

- ○ A) une
- ○ B) des
- ○ C) de

11. Complete: J'adore ___ chocolat.

- ○ A) le
- ○ B) du
- ○ C) de

12. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: des pommes)

- ○ A) an apple
- ○ B) some apples
- ○ C) the apple

13. Which sentence is correct?

- ○ A) J'ai des amis à Paris.
- ○ B) J'ai amis à Paris.
- ○ C) J'ai de amis à Paris.
- ○ D) J'ai un amis à Paris.

14. What does de l'eau mean?

- ○ A) the water
- ○ B) water's
- ○ C) some water
- ○ D) a waterfall

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est

UNIT 4 · LESSON 3 · 12 MINUTES

Être: to be

The most important verb in French

- Conjugate être in the present
- Describe people and say jobs with être
- Choose between c'est and il est / elle est

être (to be) is the most important verb in French. It's irregular, so learn it like a little song: je suis, tu es, il est...

être (to be): present

Pronoun	être	Say it	Meaning
je	suis	zhuh SWEE	I am
tu	es	tew EH	you are (friendly)
il / elle / on	est	eel / el / ohn EH	he / she / one is
nous	sommes	noo SOM	we are
vous	êtes	voo-ZET	you are (polite / plural)
ils / elles	sont	eel / el SOHN	they are

TIP

on literally means 'one', but in everyday French it usually means **we**: On est en retard ! = We're late!

WATCH OUT

ils = they (all male, or a mixed group). elles = they (all female). One man in a group of women? It's ils.

Je suis étudiant.
zhuh swee-zay-tew-DYAHN
I'm a student.
No 'a' before a job after être.

Tu es fatigué ?
tew eh fah-tee-GAY
Are you tired?

Elle est médecin.
el eh mayd-SAN
She's a doctor.

Nous sommes en France.
noo som-zahn FRAHNS
We're in France.

Vous êtes très gentil.
voo-zet treh zhahn-TEE
You're very kind.

Ils sont à la maison.
eel sohn-tah lah meh-ZOHN
They're at home.

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MEMORY TRICK

Jobs after être drop the article: Il est professeur = 'He is teacher'. Think of the job as a description, like 'He is tall'.

C'est or il est?

C'est...

It's / he's / she's + a noun

Use with an article or a name: C'est un ami. C'est ma sœur. C'est Paris.

Il est / Elle est...

+ an adjective or a bare job

Il est grand. Elle est avocate.

Nous sommes contents d'être ici.

Nous	sommes	contents	d'être	ici
we	are	happy	to be	here

noo som kohn-TAHN DETR ee-SEE

We're happy to be here.

First day

Teacher Vous êtes nouveau ?
voo-zet noo-VOH
Are you new?

Raj Oui, je suis Raj. Je suis indien.
WEE, zhuh swee RAHDJ. zhuh swee-zan-DYAN
Yes, I'm Raj. I'm Indian.

Teacher Bienvenue ! Les étudiants sont sympas ici.
byan-vuh-NEW. lay-zay-tew-DYAHN sohn san-PAH ee-SEE
Welcome! The students are nice here.

Raj C'est super. Vous êtes professeur de maths ?
seh sew-PEHR. voo-zet proh-feh-suhr duh MAHT
That's great. Are you the maths teacher?

Teacher Non, je suis professeur de français !
NOHN, zhuh swee proh-feh-suhr duh frahn-SEH
No, I'm the French teacher!

Chant être three times, faster each time!

je suis, tu es, il est, elle est, on est

nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont, elles sont

Je suis content.

C'est mon frère. Il est grand.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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15. nous ___ (être)

- ○ A) êtes
- ○ B) sont
- ○ C) est
- ○ D) sommes

16. vous ___ (être)

- ○ A) es
- ○ B) êtes
- ○ C) sommes
- ○ D) sont

17. Listen. Who is tired? (listen in the web app: Ils sont fatigués.)

- ○ A) They are.
- ○ B) We are.
- ○ C) You are.
- ○ D) He is.

18. How do you say 'She's a doctor'?

- ○ A) Elle est un médecin.
- ○ B) C'est médecin.
- ○ C) Elle a médecin.
- ○ D) Elle est médecin.

19. Complete: ___ un bon livre.

- ○ A) Il est
- ○ B) C'est
- ○ C) Elle est

20. What does On est prêts ! usually mean?

- ○ A) One is ready.
- ○ B) They're ready!
- ○ C) We're ready!
- ○ D) You're ready!

21. je ___ (être)

- ○ A) es
- ○ B) est
- ○ C) sommes
- ○ D) suis

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ai

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4 · 13 MINUTES

Avoir: to have

Having things, and saying how you feel

- Conjugate avoir in the present
- Use avoir for age, hunger, thirst and more
- Hear the difference between ils sont and ils ont

avoir (to have) is the second key verb. French also uses it where English uses 'to be': for age, hunger, thirst, fear and more.

avoir (to have): present

Pronoun	avoir	Say it	Meaning
j'	ai	zhay	I have
tu	as	tew AH	you have
il / elle / on	a	eel / el / ohn AH	he / she / one has
nous	avons	noo-zah-VOHN	we have
vous	avez	voo-zah-VAY	you have
ils / elles	ont	eel-ZOHN / el-ZOHN	they have

Listen carefully

ils sont

they are: S sound

'eel SOHN', a hissing S.

ils ont

they have: Z sound

'eel ZOHN', the S of ils links with a buzzing Z.

J'ai deux sœurs.

zhay duh SUHR

I have two sisters.

Tu as un stylo ?

tew ah an stee-LOH

Do you have a pen?

Nous avons un chien.

noo-zah-vohn an SHYAN

We have a dog.

Elles ont dix-huit ans.

el-zohn dee-zwee-TAHN

They're eighteen.

Avoir where English says 'to be'

French says 'I **have** hunger', not 'I am hungry'. Learn these as fixed phrases.

J'ai faim. — zhay FAN

J'ai froid. — zhay FRWAH

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Avoir expressions

French	Say it	Meaning
avoir faim	ah-vwahr FAN	to be hungry J'ai faim ! (zhay FAN) — I'm hungry!
avoir soif	ah-vwahr SWAHF	to be thirsty
avoir chaud	ah-vwahr SHOH	to be hot / warm
avoir froid	ah-vwahr FRWAH	to be cold
avoir peur (de)	ah-vwahr PUHR	to be afraid (of) Il a peur des chiens. (eel ah puhr day SHYAN) — He's afraid of dogs.
avoir sommeil	ah-vwahr soh-MEY	to be sleepy
avoir raison	ah-vwahr reh-ZOHN	to be right
avoir tort	ah-vwahr TOR	to be wrong
avoir besoin de	ah-vwahr buh-ZWAN duh	to need J'ai besoin d'aide. (zhay buh-zwan DED) — I need help.
avoir … ans	ah-vwahr … AHN	to be … years old

WATCH OUT

For temperature, never say Je suis chaud: it sounds like slang for 'I'm all fired up!'. Say J'ai chaud.

J'ai très faim et un peu froid.

J'ai	très	faim	et	un	peu	froid
I have	very	hunger	and	a	little	cold

zhay treh FAN ay an puh FRWAH

I'm very hungry and a bit cold.

A picnic

Lucas Tu as faim ?
tew ah FAN
Are you hungry?

Chloé Oui, j'ai très faim ! Et j'ai soif aussi.
WEE, zhay treh FAN. ay zhay swahf oh-SEE
Yes, I'm starving! And I'm thirsty too.

Lucas On a des sandwichs dans le sac, non ?
ohn-nah day sahnd-WEETSH dahn luh SAK, NOHN
We've got sandwiches in the bag, haven't we?

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Chloé Ah oui, tu as raison !
ah WEE, tew ah reh-ZOHN
Oh yes, you're right!

Lucas Tu as froid ? Tu veux ma veste ?
tew ah FRWAH? tew vuh mah VEST
Are you cold? Do you want my jacket?

Chloé Non merci, j'ai chaud maintenant !
nohn mehr-SEE, zhay shoh mant-NAHN
No thanks, I'm warm now!

Say each line aloud with feeling!

j'ai, tu as, il a, elle a, on a

nous avons, vous avez, ils ont, elles ont

J'ai faim !

Tu as raison.

Nous avons froid.

Ils ont peur.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

22. nous ___ (avoir)

- ○ A) avez
- ○ B) avons
- ○ C) ont
- ○ D) sommes

23. How do you say 'I'm cold'?

- ○ A) Je suis froid.
- ○ B) J'ai chaud.
- ○ C) J'ai froid.
- ○ D) Je froid.

24. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: Ils ont faim.)

- ○ A) They're thirsty.
- ○ B) They're hungry.
- ○ C) They're famous.
- ○ D) We're hungry.

25. What does avoir besoin de mean?

- ○ A) to be busy
- ○ B) to be afraid of
- ○ C) to need
- ○ D) to be sleepy

26. Listen. Which verb is it? (listen in the web app: Elles ont vingt ans.)

- ○ A) avoir (they have)
- ○ B) être (they are)
- ○ C) aller (they go)

27. What does Tu as tort mean?

- ○ A) You're wrong.
- ○ B) You're right.
- ○ C) You're tired.
- ○ D) You're late.

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28. Complete: j'___ (avoir)

- ○ A) ai
- ○ B) as
- ○ C) a
- ○ D) es

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-er

UNIT 4 · LESSON 5 · 15 MINUTES

Regular -er Verbs

One pattern, hundreds of verbs

- Recognise -er verbs
- Conjugate them in the present
- Know which endings are silent

Most French verbs end in **-er**, and almost all of them follow one pattern. Learn it once and you can use hundreds of verbs: parler (to speak), aimer (to like), habiter (to live)...

How to conjugate

1 **Start with the infinitive**

parler

par-LAY

to speak

2 **Remove -er to find the stem**

parl-

This part never changes.

3 **Add the ending for the person**

je parle

zhuh PARL

I speak

parler (to speak)

Pronoun	Ending	parler	Say it
je	-e	je parle	zhuh PARL
tu	-es	tu parles	tew PARL
il / elle / on	-e	il parle	eel PARL
nous	-ons	nous parlons	noo par-LOHN
vous	-ez	vous parlez	voo par-LAY
ils / elles	-ent	ils parlent	eel PARL

MEMORY TRICK

Four forms, one sound: je parle, tu parles, il parle, ils parlent all sound like 'parl'. Only nous (-ons) and vous (-ez) sound different.

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WATCH OUT

The -ent of ils parlent is **silent**. Never say 'parl-ENT'!

Useful -er verbs

French	Say it	Meaning
parler	par-LAY	to speak Tu parles anglais ? (tew parl ahn-GLEH) — Do you speak English?
aimer	eh-MAY	to like / to love
habiter	ah-bee-TAY	to live (somewhere)
travailler	trah-vah-YAY	to work
manger	mahn-ZHAY	to eat
regarder	ruh-gar-DAY	to watch / to look at Elle regarde un film. (el ruh-gard an FEELM) — She's watching a film.
écouter	ay-koo-TAY	to listen (to)
jouer	zhoo-AY	to play
chercher	shehr-SHAY	to look for
acheter	ash-TAY	to buy
étudier	ay-tew-DYAY	to study
adorer	ah-doh-RAY	to love / to adore

Before a vowel: j'

je becomes j' before a vowel or a silent h.

j'aime (ZHEM) j'habite (zhah-BEET) j'écoute (zhay-KOOT)

WATCH OUT

Small spelling changes keep the sound right: nous mangeons keeps an E so the G stays soft, and j'achète gets an accent. The sound is your guide.

TIP

One French present = three English ones. Je parle means 'I speak', 'I'm speaking' and 'I do speak'.

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Vous aimez le jazz ?
voo-zeh-may luh DJAZZ
Do you like jazz?

Ils écoutent de la musique.
eel-zay-koot duh lah mew-ZEEK
They're listening to music.

Je cherche mes clés.
zhuh shehrsh may KLAY
I'm looking for my keys.

On joue au tennis ?
ohn zhoo oh teh-NEESS
Shall we play tennis?

Nous habitons à Lyon et nous travaillons ensemble.

Nous	habitons	à	Lyon	et	nous	travaillons	ensemble
we	live	in	Lyon	and	we	work	together

noo-zah-bee-TOHN ah lee-OHN ay noo trah-vah-YOHN ahn-SAHMBL

We live in Lyon and we work together.

Nina Tu habites où ?
tew ah-beet OO
Where do you live?

Hugo J'habite à Marseille. Je travaille dans un restaurant.
zhah-beet ah mar-SEY. zhuh trah-vahy dahn-zan res-toh-RAHN
I live in Marseille. I work in a restaurant.

Nina Tu cuisines bien ?
tew kwee-zeen BYAN
Are you a good cook?

Hugo Oui ! Et le soir, je joue de la guitare.
WEE. ay luh SWAHR, zhuh zhoo duh lah gee-TAR
Yes! And in the evening, I play the guitar.

Nina Génial ! Nous adorons la musique aussi.
zhay-NYAL. noo-zah-doh-rohn lah mew-ZEEK oh-SEE
Great! We love music too.

Conjugate aloud, then read the sentences.

je parle, tu parles, il parle

nous parlons, vous parlez, ils parlent

J'aime le cinéma.

Nous regardons la télé.

Vous travaillez où ?

Elles écoutent la radio.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

29. tu ___ (parler)

- ○ A) parle
- ○ B) parlez
- ○ C) parles
- ○ D) parlons

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30. nous ___ (aimer)

- ○ A) aimez
- ○ B) aimons
- ○ C) aiment
- ○ D) aimes

31. Listen to the verb. How is the ending -ent said? (listen in the web app: Ils regardent la télé.)

- ○ A) It is silent
- ○ B) Like English 'ant'
- ○ C) Like the 'on' of nous

32. Which two forms sound exactly the same?

- ○ A) nous parlons and vous parlez
- ○ B) je parle and ils parlent
- ○ C) tu parles and vous parlez

33. How do you say 'I'm listening to music'?

- ○ A) Je suis écoute la musique.
- ○ B) Je écoute de la musique.
- ○ C) J'écoute de la musique.
- ○ D) J'écoutons la musique.

34. vous ___ (habiter)

- ○ A) habitons
- ○ B) habitent
- ○ C) habitez
- ○ D) habites

35. Elle travaille can mean...

- ○ A) she works / she's working
- ○ B) only: she worked
- ○ C) only: she will work

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pas

UNIT 4 · LESSON 6 · 13 MINUTES

Saying No: ne… pas

Negative sentences, never, nothing, nobody

- Make sentences negative with ne… pas
- Use n' before a vowel
- Use jamais, plus, rien and personne

To make a sentence negative, French wraps the verb in two little words: ne before it and pas after it. Think of it as a sandwich, with the verb as the filling.

The ne… pas sandwich

ne + verb + pas.

How to say it: ne becomes n' before a vowel or a silent h.

Je ne parle pas allemand.
zhuh nuh parl pah-zahl-MAHN

Il n'aime pas le café.
eel nem pah luh kah-FAY

Nous ne sommes pas fatigués.
noo nuh som pah fah-tee-GAY

Tu n'habites pas ici ?
tew nah-beet pah-zee-SEE

Je ne mange pas de viande.

Je	ne	mange	pas	de	viande
I	(not)	eat	not	any	meat

zhuh nuh mahnzh pah duh VYAHND

I don't eat meat.

Remember: after pas, du, de la, des, un, une become de.

CULTURE NOTE

In relaxed speech, people often drop the ne: Je sais pas (Dunno). Understand it when you hear it, but write the full ne… pas.

Other negatives

French	Meaning	Example
ne… jamais	never	Je ne mange jamais de viande.
ne… plus	no longer, not any more	Il n'habite plus ici.
ne… rien	nothing, not anything	Je ne vois rien.
ne… personne	nobody, not anyone	Je ne connais personne.

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WATCH OUT

On its own, une personne means 'a person'. With ne, personne means **nobody**!

Two verbs together

With two verbs, the sandwich goes around the first (conjugated) one.

Je ne veux pas partir.
zhuh nuh vuh pah par-TEER

Elle ne va pas venir.
el nuh vah pah vuh-NEER

Short answers

Non, pas du tout.
nohn, pah dew TOO
No, not at all.

Non, jamais !
nohn, zhah-MEH
No, never!

Moi non plus.
mwah nohn PLEW
Me neither.

Pas encore.
pah-zahn-KOR
Not yet.

Max Tu aimes le foot ?
tew em luh FOOT
Do you like football?

Sara Non, je n'aime pas le sport.
NOHN, zhuh nem pah luh SPOR
No, I don't like sport.

Max Tu ne regardes jamais les matchs ?
tew nuh ruh-gard zhah-meh lay MATSH
You never watch the matches?

Sara Jamais ! Je ne comprends rien aux règles.
zhah-MEH. zhuh nuh kohm-prahn ryan oh REGL
Never! I don't understand anything about the rules.

Max Moi non plus, en fait !
mwah nohn PLEW, ahn FET
Me neither, actually!

Make each sentence negative aloud, then check with the line below it.

Je parle chinois.

Je ne parle pas chinois.

Il aime le thé.

Il n'aime pas le thé.

Nous avons une voiture.

Nous n'avons pas de voiture.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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36. Make it negative: Je parle chinois.

- ○ A) Je parle ne pas chinois.
- ○ B) Je ne parle pas chinois.
- ○ C) Je pas parle chinois.
- ○ D) Ne je parle pas chinois.

37. Complete: Il ___ aime pas le thé.

- ○ A) ne
- ○ B) n'
- ○ C) pas
- ○ D) non

38. What does Je ne mange jamais de poisson mean?

- ○ A) I don't eat fish any more.
- ○ B) I eat nothing at all.
- ○ C) I never eat fish.
- ○ D) Nobody eats fish.

39. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: Il n'habite plus ici.)

- ○ A) He has never lived here.
- ○ B) He doesn't live here any more.
- ○ C) He lives here now.
- ○ D) Nobody lives here.

40. Which sentence is correct?

- ○ A) Je n'ai pas des voiture.
- ○ B) Je n'ai pas de voiture.
- ○ C) Je ne pas ai de voiture.
- ○ D) Je n'ai de pas voiture.

41. What does Moi non plus mean?

- ○ A) Me too
- ○ B) Me neither
- ○ C) Not any more
- ○ D) No more for me

42. Make it negative: Je veux partir.

- ○ A) Je ne veux partir pas.
- ○ B) Je veux partir pas.
- ○ C) Ne je veux partir pas.
- ○ D) Je ne veux pas partir.

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?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · 15 MINUTES

Asking Questions

Three ways to ask, plus who, what, where…

- Ask yes/no questions in three ways
- Use the question words
- Ask natural everyday questions

French gives you three ways to ask a yes/no question, from relaxed to formal. Start with the easiest: you probably know it already!

Three ways to ask

1

1. Raise your voice (relaxed)

Tu parles anglais ?

tew parl ahn-GLEH?

Do you speak English?

Just say the sentence with a rising tone. Very common in speech.

2

2. Add est-ce que (neutral)

Est-ce que tu parles anglais ?

ess-kuh tew parl ahn-GLEH?

Do you speak English?

Put est-ce que at the front. It works everywhere.

3

3. Swap verb and subject (formal)

Parles-tu anglais ?

parl-tew ahn-GLEH?

Do you speak English?

Join them with a hyphen. Common in writing and polite speech.

TIP

est-ce que sounds like 'ESS-kuh'. It literally means 'is it that…?'. Before a vowel it becomes est-ce qu': Est-ce qu'il vient ?

Inversion with il / elle / on

If the verb ends in a vowel, add -t- between the verb and il, elle, on so it sounds smooth.

Parle-t-il français ?
parl-teel frahn-SEH

A-t-elle un chien ?
ah-tel an SHYAN

Va-t-on au cinéma ?
vah-tohn oh see-nay-MAH

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Question words

French	Say it	Meaning
qui	KEE	who Qui est-ce ? (kee ESS) — Who is it?
qu'est-ce que	KESS-kuh	what Qu'est-ce que tu manges ? (kess-kuh tew MAHNZH) — What are you eating?
quoi	KWAH	what (at the end) Tu manges quoi ? (tew mahnzh KWAH) — You're eating what?
où	OO	where Où est la gare ? (oo eh lah GAR) — Where is the station?
quand	KAHN	when Tu pars quand ? (tew par KAHN) — When are you leaving?
comment	koh-MAHN	how Comment tu t'appelles ? (koh-mahn tew tah-PEL) — What's your name?
pourquoi	poor-KWAH	why Pourquoi tu ris ? (poor-kwah tew REE) — Why are you laughing?
combien	kohm-BYAN	how much / how many Combien de frères as-tu ? (kohm-byan duh frehr ah-TEW) — How many brothers do you have?
quel / quelle	KEL	which / what Quel âge as-tu ? (kel ahzh ah-TEW) — How old are you?

MEMORY TRICK

pourquoi (why) is answered with parce que (because): Pourquoi tu ris ? Parce que c'est drôle !

Same question, three styles

Relaxed	Neutral	Formal
Tu vas où ?	Où est-ce que tu vas ?	Où vas-tu ?
Il arrive quand ?	Quand est-ce qu'il arrive ?	Quand arrive-t-il ?
Vous voulez quoi ?	Qu'est-ce que vous voulez ?	Que voulez-vous ?

Qu'est-ce que tu fais ce soir ?

Qu'est-ce	que	tu	fais	ce	soir
what is it	that	you	do	this	evening

kess-kuh tew feh suh SWAHR

What are you doing tonight?

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Yasmine Salut ! Qu'est-ce que tu fais ce week-end ?
sah-LEW. kess-kuh tew feh suh wee-KEND
Hi! What are you doing this weekend?

Noah Je vais à la plage. Tu veux venir ?
zhuh veh ah lah PLAHZH. tew vuh vuh-NEER
I'm going to the beach. Do you want to come?

Yasmine Oui ! Quand est-ce que tu pars ?
WEE. kahn-tess-kuh tew PAR
Yes! When are you leaving?

Noah Samedi matin.
sahm-dee mah-TAN
Saturday morning.

Yasmine Et comment on y va ?
ay koh-mahn ohn-nee VAH
And how do we get there?

Noah En train. Ce n'est pas cher !
ahn TRAN. suh neh pah SHEHR
By train. It isn't expensive!

Ask each question aloud. Let your voice go up at the end of yes/no questions.

Tu parles anglais ?

Est-ce que tu as faim ?

Parlez-vous français ?

Où est la gare ?

Pourquoi tu ris ?

Combien ça coûte ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

43. Which question is the most formal?

- ○ A) Vous parlez anglais ?
- ○ B) Est-ce que vous parlez anglais ?
- ○ C) Parlez-vous anglais ?

44. What does où mean?

- ○ A) where
- ○ B) when
- ○ C) who
- ○ D) why

45. Listen. What is the question? (listen in the web app: Pourquoi tu pars ?)

- ○ A) When are you leaving?
- ○ B) Where are you going?
- ○ C) How are you leaving?
- ○ D) Why are you leaving?

46. Complete (neutral style): ___ tu habites à Paris ?

- ○ A) Est-ce que
- ○ B) Qu'est-ce que
- ○ C) Pourquoi que
- ○ D) Quoi

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47. Turn into an inversion question: Il parle français.

- ○ A) Parle-il français ?
- ○ B) Parle-t-il français ?
- ○ C) Il parle-t-il français ?
- ○ D) Parle français-il ?

48. How do you start an answer to Pourquoi ?

- ○ A) Pour quoi…
- ○ B) Quand…
- ○ C) Parce que…
- ○ D) Comme…

49. Listen. What is the question? (listen in the web app: Combien ça coûte ?)

- ○ A) How does it work?
- ○ B) When does it close?
- ○ C) How much does it cost?
- ○ D) What is that thing?

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bel

UNIT 4 · LESSON 8 · 15 MINUTES

Adjectives: Agreement & Placement

Match the noun, and find the right spot

- Make adjectives agree in gender and number
- Put most adjectives after the noun
- Know the BAGS adjectives that go before

French adjectives are like chameleons: they change to match their noun, masculine or feminine, singular or plural. And most of them come **after** the noun.

Agreement: petit (small)

	Singular	Plural
Masculine	petit	petits
Feminine	petite	petites

TIP

Adding -e often makes the last consonant heard: petit is 'puh-TEE', petite is 'puh-TEET'. The plural -s stays silent.

WATCH OUT

Adjectives that already end in -e don't change for feminine: un homme calme, une femme calme.

Special feminine forms

heureux, heureuse
uh-RUH, uh-RUHZ
happy (-eux becomes -euse)

sportif, sportive
spor-TEEF, spor-TEEV
sporty (-f becomes -ve)

bon, bonne
BOHN, BUN
good (double the N)

gentil, gentille
zhahn-TEE, zhahn-TEEY
kind (double the L)

cher, chère
SHEHR, SHEHR
dear / expensive (add an accent)

blanc, blanche
BLAHN, BLAHNSH
white (fully irregular)

Most adjectives go after the noun

Colours, nationalities, shapes and most descriptions follow the noun.

un film français
an feelm frahn-SEH

une voiture rouge
ewn vwah-tewr ROOZH

des gens sympas
day zhahn san-PAH

une idée intéressante
ew-nee-day an-tay-reh-SAHNT

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BAGS adjectives go before

Short, common adjectives of **B**eauty, **A**ge, **G**oodness and **S**ize come before the noun.

How to say it: Beauty: beau, joli · Age: jeune, vieux, nouveau · Good/bad: bon, mauvais · Size: petit, grand, gros

un beau jardin
an boh zhar-DAN

une jolie maison
ewn zhoh-lee meh-ZOHN

un vieux livre
an vyuh LEEVR

une bonne idée
ewn bun-nee-DAY

un petit chat
an puh-tee SHAH

un grand appartement
an grahn-tah-par-tuh-MAHN

MEMORY TRICK

BAGS = **B**eauty, **A**ge, **G**ood or bad, **S**ize. If the adjective fits in a BAG, it goes before the noun!

Three special adjectives

Masculine	Masculine before a vowel	Feminine
beau	bel: un bel homme	belle
nouveau	nouvel: un nouvel ami	nouvelle
vieux	vieil: un vieil ami	vieille

J'ai une petite voiture rouge.

J'ai	une	petite	voiture	rouge
I have	a	small	car	red

zhay ewn puh-teet vwah-tewr ROOZH

I have a small red car.

petite (size) goes before the noun, rouge (colour) goes after.

Describing people

Il est grand et sportif.
eel eh grahn ay spor-TEEF
He's tall and sporty.

Elle est intelligente et drôle.
el eh-tan-teh-lee-ZHAHNT ay DROHL
She's clever and funny.

Mes amis sont sympas.
may-zah-mee sohn san-PAH
My friends are nice.

Ma grand-mère est petite mais très active.
mah grahn-mehr eh puh-TEET meh treh-zak-TEEV
My grandmother is small but very active.

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Read aloud and listen for the feminine endings.

un garçon grand, une fille grande

un chat noir, une chemise noire

un homme heureux, une femme heureuse

un beau jardin, une belle maison

un vieil ami, une vieille amie

Quick quiz

QUIZ

50. Complete: une maison ___ (blanc)

- ○ A) blanche
- ○ B) blanc
- ○ C) blance
- ○ D) blanches

51. How do you say 'an interesting book'?

- ○ A) un livre intéressant
- ○ B) un intéressant livre
- ○ C) intéressant un livre

52. Which adjective goes BEFORE the noun?

- ○ A) rouge
- ○ B) française
- ○ C) jolie
- ○ D) intéressante

53. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: une bonne idée)

- ○ A) a good idea
- ○ B) a nice house
- ○ C) a new idea
- ○ D) a bad idea

54. Complete (old): un ___ ami

- ○ A) vieux
- ○ B) vieille
- ○ C) vieil

55. Complete (happy): Elles sont ___.

- ○ A) heureuses
- ○ B) heureux
- ○ C) heureuse
- ○ D) heureuxes

56. How do you say 'a big red car'?

- ○ A) une grande voiture rouge
- ○ B) une voiture grande rouge
- ○ C) une rouge grande voiture
- ○ D) un grand voiture rouge

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mon

UNIT 4 · LESSON 9 · 13 MINUTES

Possessives: my, your, his, her

Match the thing, not the owner

- Use all the possessive adjectives
- Choose the right form for gender and number
- Avoid the his/her trap

In French, 'my', 'your', 'his' and 'her' agree with the **thing owned**, not with the owner. This one idea makes everything click.

Possessive adjectives

Owner	Masculine noun	Feminine noun	Plural noun
my	mon	ma	mes
your (tu)	ton	ta	tes
his / her / its	son	sa	ses
our	notre	notre	nos
your (vous)	votre	votre	vos
their	leur	leur	leurs

His or her? Same word!

son, sa, ses agree with the noun, not the owner. So sa mère can mean **his** mother or **her** mother.

Paul aime sa mère.
pohl em sah MEHR

Julie aime son père.
zhew-lee em sohn PEHR

MEMORY TRICK

Look at the thing, not the person. voiture is feminine, so it's always sa voiture: his car or her car. The context tells you which.

mon, ton, son before a vowel

Before a feminine noun starting with a vowel or silent h, use mon, ton, son so the words flow.

mon amie
moh-nah-MEE

ton école
toh-nay-KOL

son histoire
soh-nees-TWAHR

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Voici notre maison. vwah-see noh-truh meh-ZOHN Here's our house.	**Où sont vos clés ?** oo sohn voh KLAY Where are your keys?	**Leurs enfants sont gentils.** luhr-zahn-FAHN sohn zhahn-TEE Their children are kind.	**C'est ton sac ?** seh tohn SAK Is this your bag?

TIP

French has no apostrophe-s. 'My brother's jumper' is le pull de mon frère: 'the jumper of my brother'.

Marc cherche ses clés et son téléphone.

Marc	cherche	ses	clés	et	son	téléphone
Marc	is looking for	his (plural)	keys	and	his (masc.)	phone

mark shehrsh say KLAY ay sohn tay-lay-FON

Marc is looking for his keys and his phone.

Whose is it?

Mum Lina, c'est ton pull ?
lee-NAH, seh tohn PEWL
Lina, is this your jumper?

Lina Non, c'est le pull de mon frère.
NOHN, seh luh pewl duh mohn FREHR
No, it's my brother's jumper.

Mum Et ces chaussures ?
ay say shoh-SEWR
And these shoes?

Lina Ce sont ses chaussures aussi !
suh sohn say shoh-sewr oh-SEE
They're his shoes too!

Mum Les enfants, votre chambre est un désastre !
lay-zahn-FAHN, voh-truh shahmbr eh-tan day-ZASTR
Kids, your room is a disaster!

Read aloud. Point at the thing, not the owner!

mon frère, ma sœur, mes parents

ton livre, ta clé, tes amis

son chat, sa maison, ses enfants

notre ville, votre voiture, leurs vacances

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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57. Complete (my): ___ sœur

- ○ A) mon
- ○ B) mes
- ○ C) ma

58. Il aime sa voiture. Whose car is it?

- ○ A) His car
- ○ B) Her car
- ○ C) Your car

59. Complete (my): ___ amie Léa

- ○ A) mon
- ○ B) ma
- ○ C) m'

60. How do you say 'their parents'?

- ○ A) leur parents
- ○ B) ses parents
- ○ C) son parents
- ○ D) leurs parents

61. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: nos enfants)

- ○ A) your children
- ○ B) their children
- ○ C) no children
- ○ D) our children

62. How do you say 'Anna's book'?

- ○ A) Anna's livre
- ○ B) le livre d'Anna
- ○ C) le Anna livre
- ○ D) livre de l'Anna

63. Complete (your, polite): Vous avez ___ passeport ?

- ○ A) votre
- ○ B) vos
- ○ C) ton

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va

UNIT 4 · LESSON 10 · 14 MINUTES

Aller & the Near Future

Going places and talking about plans

- Conjugate aller
- Use au, à la, à l' and aux
- Talk about plans with aller + infinitive

aller (to go) is irregular but super useful. Bonus: it also builds the easiest future tense in French, the **futur proche** (near future).

aller (to go): present

Pronoun	aller	Say it	Meaning
je	vais	zhuh VEH	I go / I'm going
tu	vas	tew VAH	you go
il / elle / on	va	eel / el / ohn VAH	he / she / one goes
nous	allons	noo-zah-LOHN	we go
vous	allez	voo-zah-LAY	you go
ils / elles	vont	eel / el VOHN	they go

Going to: à + the

à +	becomes	Example
le	au	Je vais au parc.
la	à la	Je vais à la gare.
l'	à l'	Je vais à l'hôpital.
les	aux	Je vais aux magasins.

WATCH OUT

Never say à le or à les: they always merge into au and aux.

TIP

Going to someone's place? Use chez: Je vais chez Marie (to Marie's), chez le médecin (to the doctor's).

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The near future: aller + infinitive

Present of aller + a verb in the infinitive = 'going to do'. It's the everyday way to talk about plans.

Je vais manger.
zhuh veh mahn-ZHAY

Tu vas voir !
tew vah VWAHR

Nous allons voyager en Italie.
noo-zah-lohn vwah-yah-ZHAY ahn-nee-tah-LEE

Ils vont arriver demain.
eel vohn-tah-ree-VAY duh-MAN

MEMORY TRICK

Just like English: 'I'm going to eat' = Je vais manger. Just don't add a word for 'to'!

Negative: wrap aller

ne... pas goes around aller, not around the infinitive.

Je ne vais pas travailler demain.
zhuh nuh veh pah trah-vah-YAY duh-MAN

Il ne va pas pleuvoir.
eel nuh vah pah pluh-VWAHR

Future time words

French	Say it	Meaning
ce soir	suh SWAHR	tonight / this evening
demain	duh-MAN	tomorrow
après-demain	ah-preh-duh-MAN	the day after tomorrow
ce week-end	suh wee-KEND	this weekend
la semaine prochaine	lah suh-men proh-SHEN	next week
l'année prochaine	lah-nay proh-SHEN	next year
bientôt	byan-TOH	soon
plus tard	plew TAR	later

Ce soir, je vais regarder un film.

Ce	soir	je	vais	regarder	un	film
this	evening	I	am going	to watch	a	film

suh SWAHR, zhuh veh ruh-gar-DAY an FEELM

Tonight, I'm going to watch a film.

Weekend plans

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Zoé Qu'est-ce que tu vas faire ce week-end ?
kess-kuh tew vah fehr suh wee-KEND
What are you going to do this weekend?

Adam Je vais aller à la montagne avec mes parents.
zhuh veh-zah-LAY ah lah mohn-TANY ah-vek may pah-RAHN
I'm going to go to the mountains with my parents.

Zoé Vous allez faire du ski ?
voo-zah-lay fehr dew SKEE
Are you going to ski?

Adam Non, on va faire de la randonnée. Et toi ?
NOHN, ohn vah fehr duh lah rahn-doh-NAY. ay TWAH
No, we're going to go hiking. And you?

Zoé Moi, je vais rester à la maison et dormir !
MWAH, zhuh veh res-TAY ah lah meh-ZOHN ay dor-MEER
Me? I'm going to stay at home and sleep!

Say your plans aloud.

je vais, tu vas, il va, nous allons, vous allez, ils vont

Je vais au cinéma ce soir.

Nous allons à la plage demain.

Elle va étudier ce week-end.

Je ne vais pas sortir.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

64. nous ___ (aller)

- A) allez
- B) vont
- C) vais
- D) allons

65. Complete: Je vais ___ cinéma.

- A) à le
- B) à la
- C) aux
- D) au

66. How do you say 'I'm going to eat'?

- A) Je vais à manger.
- B) Je mange aller.
- C) Je vais manger.
- D) Je vais mange.

67. Listen. When will they leave? (listen in the web app: Ils vont partir demain.)

- A) yesterday
- B) right now
- C) every day
- D) tomorrow

68. Make it negative: Je vais travailler.

- A) Je vais travailler pas.
- B) Je ne vais travailler pas.
- C) Je ne vais pas travailler.
- D) Ne je vais pas travailler.

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69. Complete: Elle va ___ États-Unis.

- ○ A) au
- ○ B) aux
- ○ C) à les
- ○ D) à la

70. What does la semaine prochaine mean?

- ○ A) last week
- ○ B) this week
- ○ C) every week
- ○ D) next week

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fait

UNIT 4 · LESSON 11 · 18 MINUTES

Key Irregular Verbs

faire, prendre, vouloir, pouvoir, venir

- Conjugate faire, prendre, vouloir, pouvoir and venir
- Use them in everyday phrases
- Spot the patterns they share

A handful of irregular verbs turn up in almost every conversation. Learn these five and you can **do**, **take**, **want**, **be able to** and **come**!

faire (to do / to make)

Pronoun	faire	Say it
je	fais	zhuh FEH
tu	fais	tew FEH
il / elle / on	fait	eel FEH
nous	faisons	noo fuh-ZOHN
vous	faites	voo FET
ils / elles	font	eel FOHN

Everyday faire

French	Say it	Meaning
faire les courses	fehr lay KOORS	to do the shopping
faire la cuisine	fehr lah kwee-ZEEN	to cook
faire du sport	fehr dew SPOR	to do sport
faire une promenade	fehr ewn prom-NAHD	to go for a walk
Il fait beau.	eel feh BOH	The weather's nice.
Il fait froid.	eel feh FRWAH	It's cold (weather).

WATCH OUT

faisons is said 'fuh-ZOHN', not 'fay-ZOHN'. And it's vous faites, never 'vous faisez'!

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prendre (to take)

Pronoun	prendre	Say it
je	prends	zhuh PRAHN
tu	prends	tew PRAHN
il / elle / on	prend	eel PRAHN
nous	prenons	noo pruh-NOHN
vous	prenez	voo pruh-NAY
ils / elles	prennent	eel PREN

TIP

Use prendre for food, drinks and transport: Je prends un café (I'll have a coffee), Je prends le bus. Its cousins follow the same pattern: apprendre (to learn), comprendre (to understand).

Twin verbs: vouloir & pouvoir

Pronoun	vouloir (to want)	pouvoir (can, to be able to)
je	veux	peux
tu	veux	peux
il / elle / on	veut	peut
nous	voulons	pouvons
vous	voulez	pouvez
ils / elles	veulent	peuvent

Tu veux un café ?
tew vuh an kah-FAY
Do you want a coffee?

Je peux entrer ?
zhuh puh ahn-TRAY
Can I come in?

Vous pouvez répéter, s'il vous plaît ?
voo poo-vay ray-pay-TAY, seel voo PLEH
Could you repeat that, please?

Ils veulent partir.
eel vuhl par-TEER
They want to leave.

CULTURE NOTE

Je veux can sound blunt. Soften it with je voudrais (I would like) or ask Tu pourrais...? (Could you...?).

venir (to come)

Pronoun	venir	Say it
je	viens	zhuh VYAN

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Pronoun	venir	Say it
tu	viens	tew VYAN
il / elle / on	vient	eel VYAN
nous	venons	noo vuh-NOHN
vous	venez	voo vuh-NAY
ils / elles	viennent	eel VYEN

MEMORY TRICK

Spot the 'boot' pattern in prendre, vouloir, pouvoir, venir: nous and vous keep the short stem from the infinitive (pren-, voul-, pouv-, ven-), while the other forms change.

TIP

venir de + infinitive = 'to have just done': Je viens de manger = I've just eaten.

Tu veux venir au cinéma avec nous ?

Tu	veux	venir	au	cinéma	avec	nous
you	want	to come	to the	cinema	with	us

tew vuh vuh-NEER oh see-nay-MAH ah-vek NOO

Do you want to come to the cinema with us?

Ana Qu'est-ce que tu fais ?
kess-kuh tew FEH
What are you doing?

Tom Je fais mes devoirs.
zhuh feh may duh-VWAHR
I'm doing my homework.

Ana On va au parc. Tu veux venir ?
ohn vah oh PARK. tew vuh vuh-NEER
We're going to the park. Do you want to come?

Tom Je ne peux pas, je dois finir.
zhuh nuh puh PAH, zhuh dwah fee-NEER
I can't, I have to finish.

Ana Dommage ! Tu viens demain, alors ?
doh-MAHZH. tew vyan duh-MAN, ah-LOR
Shame! Will you come tomorrow, then?

Tom Oui, je prends le bus à dix heures.
WEE, zhuh prahn luh bewss ah dee-ZUHR
Yes, I'll take the bus at ten.

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Conjugate each verb aloud.

je fais, tu fais, il fait, nous faisons, vous faites, ils font

je prends, nous prenons, ils prennent

je veux, nous voulons, ils veulent

je peux, nous pouvons, ils peuvent

je viens, nous venons, ils viennent

Quick quiz

QUIZ

71. vous ___ (faire)

- A) faisez
- B) faites
- C) font
- D) faisons

72. ils ___ (prendre)

- A) prendent
- B) prenent
- C) prennent
- D) prends

73. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: Je peux entrer ?)

- A) Do I want to come in?
- B) Can I come in?
- C) Can you come in?
- D) Must I come in?

74. How do you say 'The weather is nice'?

- A) Il est beau temps.
- B) C'est beau météo.
- C) Il a beau.
- D) Il fait beau.

75. What does Je viens de manger mean?

- A) I've just eaten.
- B) I'm about to eat.
- C) I'm coming to eat.

76. nous ___ (vouloir)

- A) veulons
- B) voulez
- C) voulons
- D) veux

77. Which is the most polite?

- A) Je veux un café, moi.
- B) Donne-moi un café !
- C) Je voudrais un café.

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lui

UNIT 4 · LESSON 12 · 15 MINUTES

Pronouns: I, me, him, it

Subject, object and stressed pronouns

- Know all the subject pronouns
- Use direct object pronouns: le, la, les
- Use stressed pronouns: moi, toi, lui…

Pronouns save you from repeating nouns. You already know the subject pronouns (je, tu, il…). Now meet the pronouns that replace objects, and find out where they hide in the sentence.

Three kinds of pronoun

Subject	Object	Stressed	English
je	me (m')	moi	I / me
tu	te (t')	toi	you
il	le (l')	lui	he / him / it
elle	la (l')	elle	she / her / it
nous	nous	nous	we / us
vous	vous	vous	you
ils	les	eux	they / them (m)
elles	les	elles	they / them (f)

Object pronouns go BEFORE the verb

Unlike English, the object pronoun comes before the verb. le and la become l' before a vowel.

Je le regarde.
zhuh luh ruh-GARD

Tu la connais ?
tew lah koh-NEH

Il les aime.
eel lay-ZEM

From noun to pronoun

Je le regarde.
zhuh luh ruh-GARD
I'm watching it.
le = le film, from Je regarde le film.

Tu la connais ?
tew lah koh-NEH
Do you know her?
la = Marie, from Tu connais Marie ?

Il les aime.
eel lay-ZEM
He likes them.
les = les chats, from Il aime les chats.

Elle m'appelle ce soir.
el mah-pel suh SWAHR
She's calling me tonight.

Je t'aime.
zhuh TEM
I love you.

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MEMORY TRICK

Think of a magnet: the object pronoun sticks to the **front** of the verb. Je t'aime is literally 'I you love'.

With ne... pas and with two verbs

Negative: ne + pronoun + verb + pas. With two verbs, the pronoun goes before the infinitive.

Je ne le vois pas.
zhuh nuh luh vwah PAH

Je vais le faire.
zhuh veh luh FEHR

Tu peux m'aider ?
tew puh meh-DAY

Stressed pronouns

Use moi, toi, lui, elle, nous, vous, eux, elles after a preposition, for emphasis, and on their own.

Moi, je suis prof.
MWAH, zhuh swee PROF

C'est pour toi.
seh poor TWAH

Il vient avec nous.
eel vyan ah-vek NOO

Et lui ?
ay LWEE

Chez eux.
sheh ZUH

TIP

Moi aussi = Me too. Moi non plus = Me neither. C'est moi ! = It's me!

Ce livre, je le lis ce soir.

Ce	livre	je	le	lis	ce	soir
this	book	I	it	read	this	evening

suh LEEVR, zhuh luh lee suh SWAHR

That book? I'm reading it tonight.

Party plans

Paul Tu connais Léa ?
tew koh-neh lay-AH
Do you know Léa?

Nora Oui, je la connais bien.
WEE, zhuh lah koh-neh BYAN
Yes, I know her well.

Paul Tu peux l'inviter à ma fête ?
tew puh lan-vee-TAY ah mah FET
Can you invite her to my party?

Nora D'accord. Et ses frères ?
dah-KOR. ay say FREHR
OK. And her brothers?

Paul Non, je ne les invite pas. Ils sont pénibles !
NOHN, zhuh nuh lay-zan-veet PAH. eel sohn pay-NEEBL
No, I'm not inviting them. They're annoying!

Nora D'accord, pas eux !
dah-KOR, pah-ZUH
OK, not them!

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Replace the noun with a pronoun aloud, then check the second line.

Je mange la pomme.

Je la mange.

Tu regardes le match ?

Tu le regardes ?

Elle aime ses amis.

Elle les aime.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

78. Replace the noun: Je mange la pomme. → Je ___ mange.

- ○ A) le
- ○ B) lui
- ○ C) la
- ○ D) les

79. How do you say 'I see him'?

- ○ A) Je le vois.
- ○ B) Je vois le.
- ○ C) Je vois lui.
- ○ D) Le je vois.

80. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: Je t'aime.)

- ○ A) I love you.
- ○ B) I like it.
- ○ C) I'm calling you.
- ○ D) You love me.

81. Complete (me): C'est pour ___.

- ○ A) me
- ○ B) moi
- ○ C) je
- ○ D) m'

82. Replace the noun: Il regarde les photos.

- ○ A) Il les regarde.
- ○ B) Il regarde les.
- ○ C) Il leur regarde.
- ○ D) Les il regarde.

83. Make it negative: Je le vois.

- ○ A) Je le ne vois pas.
- ○ B) Je ne le vois pas.
- ○ C) Je ne vois le pas.
- ○ D) Ne je le vois pas.

84. What does Moi aussi mean?

- ○ A) Me neither
- ○ B) Me too
- ○ C) Not me
- ○ D) Me first

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vu

UNIT 4 · LESSON 13 · 16 MINUTES

The Past (1): Passé Composé with Avoir

Say what you did

- Form the passé composé with avoir
- Make past participles of regular verbs
- Use common irregular participles

To say what you **did**, French uses the **passé composé** (compound past). It has two parts: a helper verb, usually avoir, plus a past participle. You already know avoir!

avoir + past participle

Present of avoir + past participle = 'I did' or 'I have done'.

J'ai mangé.
zhay mahn-ZHAY

Tu as fini ?
tew ah fee-NEE

Nous avons vendu la voiture.
noo-zah-vohn vahn-DEW lah vwah-TEWR

Making the past participle

Infinitive ends in	Participle ends in	Example
-er	-é	parler → parlé
-ir	-i	finir → fini
-re	-u	vendre → vendu

manger in the passé composé

French	Say it	English
j'ai mangé	zhay mahn-ZHAY	I ate / I have eaten
tu as mangé	tew ah mahn-ZHAY	you ate
il / elle a mangé	eel ah mahn-ZHAY	he / she ate
nous avons mangé	noo-zah-vohn mahn-ZHAY	we ate
vous avez mangé	voo-zah-vay mahn-ZHAY	you ate
ils / elles ont mangé	eel-zohn mahn-ZHAY	they ate

TIP

One French form = two English ones: J'ai mangé means 'I ate' **and** 'I have eaten'.

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Irregular participles

French	Say it	Meaning
j'ai eu	zhay EW	I had (avoir)
j'ai été	zhay ay-TAY	I was / I have been (être)
j'ai fait	zhay FEH	I did / I made (faire)
j'ai pris	zhay PREE	I took (prendre)
j'ai vu	zhay VEW	I saw (voir)
j'ai bu	zhay BEW	I drank (boire)
j'ai lu	zhay LEW	I read (lire)
j'ai dit	zhay DEE	I said (dire)
j'ai écrit	zhay ay-KREE	I wrote (écrire)
j'ai voulu	zhay voo-LEW	I wanted (vouloir)
j'ai pu	zhay PEW	I was able to (pouvoir)
j'ai mis	zhay MEE	I put (mettre)

Negative: wrap avoir

ne… pas goes around avoir only. The participle stays outside.

Je n'ai pas mangé.
zhuh neh pah mahn-ZHAY

Il n'a pas vu le film.
eel nah pah vew luh FEELM

Nous n'avons rien fait.
noo nah-vohn ryan FEH

MEMORY TRICK

Sandwich again: ne + ai + pas, then the participle sits outside the bread: Je n'ai pas fini.

Past time words

French	Say it	Meaning
hier	ee-YEHR	yesterday
hier soir	ee-yehr SWAHR	last night
ce matin	suh mah-TAN	this morning
la semaine dernière	lah suh-men dehr-NYEHR	last week
l'année dernière	lah-nay dehr-NYEHR	last year

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French	Say it	Meaning
il y a deux jours	eel-yah duh ZHOOR	two days ago
déjà	day-ZHAH	already

Hier soir, j'ai vu un film avec mes amis.

Hier	soir	j'ai	vu	un	film	avec	mes	amis
yesterday	evening	I have	seen	a	film	with	my	friends

ee-yehr SWAHR, zhay vew an FEELM ah-vek may-zah-MEE

Last night, I saw a film with my friends.

Monday morning

Clara Tu as passé un bon week-end ?
tew ah pah-SAY an bohn wee-KEND
Did you have a good weekend?

Omar Oui ! Samedi, j'ai joué au foot.
WEE. sahm-DEE, zhay zhoo-AY oh FOOT
Yes! On Saturday, I played football.

Clara Et dimanche ?
ay dee-MAHNSH
And on Sunday?

Omar J'ai fait un gâteau et j'ai lu un livre.
zhay feh an gah-TOH ay zhay lew an LEEVR
I made a cake and I read a book.

Clara Tu as fini le livre ?
tew ah fee-NEE luh LEEVR
Did you finish the book?

Omar Non, pas encore !
NOHN, pah-zahn-KOR
No, not yet!

Tell your last weekend aloud.

Samedi, j'ai regardé un film.

Dimanche, j'ai fait du sport.

J'ai mangé une pizza.

Je n'ai pas travaillé.

Hier soir, j'ai lu un livre.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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85. What is the past participle of finir?

- ○ A) finé
- ○ B) finu
- ○ C) fini
- ○ D) finit

86. How do you say 'I ate'?

- ○ A) Je suis mangé.
- ○ B) Je mangé.
- ○ C) J'ai mangé.
- ○ D) J'ai manger.

87. What is the past participle of faire?

- ○ A) faisé
- ○ B) fait
- ○ C) fairé
- ○ D) fu

88. Listen. What did they do? (listen in the web app: Nous avons vu la mer.)

- ○ A) We want the sea.
- ○ B) We saw the sea.
- ○ C) We'll see the sea.
- ○ D) We love the sea.

89. Make it negative: J'ai fini.

- ○ A) Je n'ai fini pas.
- ○ B) Je n'ai pas fini.
- ○ C) Je ne pas ai fini.
- ○ D) Je ai pas fini.

90. What does J'ai pris le train mean?

- ○ A) I take the train.
- ○ B) I took the train.
- ○ C) I'm going to take the train.
- ○ D) I missed the train.

91. Complete: Ils ___ bu du thé.

- ○ A) ont
- ○ B) sont
- ○ C) avons
- ○ D) a

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né

UNIT 4 · LESSON 14 · 16 MINUTES

The Past (2): Passé Composé with Être

Movement verbs and agreement

- Know which verbs use être
- Make the participle agree with the subject
- Tell a short story in the past

About twenty verbs use être instead of avoir in the passé composé. Most are about **movement** or **change**: going, coming, arriving, leaving, being born, dying…

The être verbs

Verb	Meaning	Participle
aller	to go	allé
venir	to come	venu
arriver	to arrive	arrivé
partir	to leave	parti
entrer	to go in	entré
sortir	to go out	sorti
monter	to go up	monté
descendre	to go down	descendu
naître	to be born	né
mourir	to die	mort
rester	to stay	resté
tomber	to fall	tombé
rentrer	to come home	rentré
revenir	to come back	revenu
devenir	to become	devenu
retourner	to go back	retourné

MEMORY TRICK

Picture the **House of Être**: you arrive (arriver), go in (entrer), go up the stairs (monter), come down (descendre), go out (sortir) and leave (partir). People are born (naître) and die (mourir) in it too!

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Agreement with être

With être, the participle agrees with the subject, like an adjective: add **-e** for feminine and **-s** for plural.

Il est allé.
eel eh-tah-LAY

Elle est allée.
el eh-tah-LAY

Ils sont allés.
eel sohn-tah-LAY

Elles sont allées.
el sohn-tah-LAY

TIP

Good news: allé, allée, allés, allées all sound the same. The agreement usually shows only in writing.

aller in the passé composé

French	Say it	English
je suis allé(e)	zhuh swee-zah-LAY	I went
tu es allé(e)	tew eh-zah-LAY	you went
il est allé / elle est allée	eel eh-tah-LAY	he / she went
nous sommes allé(e)s	noo som-zah-LAY	we went
vous êtes allé(e)(s)	voo-zet-zah-LAY	you went
ils sont allés / elles sont allées	eel sohn-tah-LAY	they went

Avoir or être?

J'ai mangé.

avoir: most verbs

No agreement with the subject: elle a mangé.

Je suis parti(e).

être: movement & change

Agrees with the subject: elle est partie.

Je suis né à Londres.
zhuh swee NAY ah LOHNDR
I was born in London.

Elle est arrivée hier.
el eh-tah-ree-VAY ee-YEHR
She arrived yesterday.

Nous sommes restés à la maison.
noo som res-TAY ah lah meh-ZOHN
We stayed at home.

Tu es tombé ?
tew eh tohm-BAY
Did you fall?

Ils ne sont pas venus.
eel nuh sohn pah vuh-NEW
They didn't come.

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Marie est partie en vacances lundi.

Marie	est	partie	en	vacances	lundi
Marie	is	left	on	holiday	Monday

mah-REE eh par-TEE ahn vah-KAHNS lun-DEE

Marie went on holiday on Monday.

partie has an extra -e because Marie is female.

Holiday story

Hugo Qu'est-ce que tu as fait pendant les vacances ?
kess-kuh tew ah FEH pahn-dahn lay vah-KAHNS
What did you do during the holidays?

Lisa Je suis allée en Espagne avec ma sœur.
zhuh swee-zah-LAY ahn-nes-PANY ah-vek mah SUHR
I went to Spain with my sister.

Hugo Super ! Vous êtes parties quand ?
sew-PEHR. voo-zet par-TEE KAHN
Great! When did you leave?

Lisa Nous sommes parties le deux août et nous sommes rentrées hier.
noo som par-TEE luh duh OOT ay noo som rahn-TRAY ee-YEHR
We left on 2 August and we came home yesterday.

Hugo Et tu as aimé ?
ay tew ah eh-MAY
And did you like it?

Lisa J'ai adoré ! Mais ma sœur est tombée malade…
zhay ah-doh-RAY. meh mah suhr eh tohm-BAY mah-LAHD
I loved it! But my sister got ill…

Read the story aloud. Spot the être verbs.

Je suis né en avril.

Hier, je suis sorti avec mes amis.

Nous sommes allés au cinéma.

Ma sœur est arrivée en retard.

Nous sommes rentrés à minuit.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

92. Which verb uses être in the passé composé?

- ○ A) manger
- ○ B) regarder
- ○ C) finir
- ○ D) partir

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93. Complete: Elle est ___ (arriver).

- ○ A) arrivé
- ○ B) arrivés
- ○ C) arriver
- ○ D) arrivée

94. Two men say 'We went to the cinema'. Which is correct?

- ○ A) Nous sommes allés au cinéma.
- ○ B) Nous avons allé au cinéma.
- ○ C) Nous sommes allées au cinéma.
- ○ D) Nous allons au cinéma.

95. Listen. What does it mean? (listen in the web app: Je suis né en avril.)

- ○ A) I was born in April.
- ○ B) I'm going in April.
- ○ C) I arrived in April.
- ○ D) I'll be back in April.

96. Which sentence is correct?

- ○ A) Il a tombé.
- ○ B) Il est tombée.
- ○ C) Il est tombé.
- ○ D) Il tombé.

97. Make it negative: Ils sont venus.

- ○ A) Ils ne sont pas venus.
- ○ B) Ils ne sont venus pas.
- ○ C) Ils sont ne pas venus.
- ○ D) Ils n'ont pas venus.

98. Why does elles sont sorties end in -ies?

- ○ A) The subject is feminine plural.
- ○ B) Sortir always ends like that.
- ○ C) It is the future tense.

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sur

UNIT 4 · LESSON 15 · 13 MINUTES

Prepositions of Place

Where things and places are

- Say where things and people are
- Use du and des after près de, à côté de…
- Use à, en, au and aux with cities and countries

Where's my phone? Where's the station? Prepositions of place answer the question Où ? (Where?).

Where is it?

French	Say it	Meaning
sur	SEWR	on Le chat est sur le lit. (luh shah eh sewr luh LEE) — The cat is on the bed.
sous	SOO	under
dans	DAHN	in, inside
devant	duh-VAHN	in front of
derrière	deh-RYEHR	behind
entre	AHNTR	between
à côté de	ah koh-TAY duh	next to
près de	PREH duh	near
loin de	LWAN duh	far from
en face de	ahn FAHSS duh	opposite
à gauche (de)	ah GOHSH	on the left (of)
à droite (de)	ah DRWAHT	on the right (of)

MEMORY TRICK

devant hides the word avant (before): in front of. derrière sounds a bit like 'derrière' in English, the thing behind you!

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de + le = du

Prepositions ending in de follow the same rule as à: de + le = du, de + les = des. de la and de l' don't change.

à côté du cinéma
ah koh-TAY dew see-nay-MAH

près de la gare
preh duh lah GAR

en face de l'hôtel
ahn fahss duh loh-TEL

loin des magasins
lwan day mah-gah-ZAN

Cities and countries

Place	Use	Example
a city	à	J'habite à Rome.
a feminine country (most end in -e)	en	Je vais en France.
a masculine country	au	Il travaille au Canada.
a plural country	aux	Elle vit aux États-Unis.

WATCH OUT

Most countries ending in -e are feminine (la France, l'Italie); most others are masculine (le Japon, le Brésil). Watch out for le Mexique: masculine, so au Mexique.

Around town

La banque est entre la poste et le café.
lah bahnk eh ahntr lah POST ay luh kah-FAY
The bank is between the post office and the café.

La pharmacie est en face de l'école.
lah far-mah-SEE eh-tahn fahss duh lay-KOL
The pharmacy is opposite the school.

Mon appartement est près du parc.
moh-nah-par-tuh-MAHN eh preh dew PARK
My flat is near the park.

Le vélo est derrière la maison.
luh vay-LOH eh deh-ryehr lah meh-ZOHN
The bike is behind the house.

La boulangerie est à côté de la pharmacie.

La	boulangerie	est	à	côté	de	la	pharmacie
the	bakery	is	at	side	of	the	pharmacy

lah boo-lahn-ZHREE eh-tah koh-TAY duh lah far-mah-SEE

The bakery is next to the pharmacy.

à côté de is literally 'at the side of'.

Asking the way

Tourist Pardon, madame, où est la gare ?
par-DOHN, mah-DAHM, oo eh lah GAR
Excuse me, madam, where is the station?

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Lady C'est tout droit, puis à gauche.
seh too DRWAH, pwee ah GOHSH
It's straight on, then left.

Tourist C'est loin d'ici ?
seh lwan dee-SEE
Is it far from here?

Lady Non, c'est à cinq minutes. La gare est en face du musée.
NOHN, seh-tah sank mee-NEWT. lah gar eh-tahn fahss dew mew-ZAY
No, it's five minutes away. The station is opposite the museum.

Tourist Merci beaucoup !
mehr-SEE boh-KOO
Thank you very much!

Lady Je vous en prie. Bonne journée !
zhuh voo-zahn PREE. bun zhoor-NAY
You're welcome. Have a good day!

WATCH OUT

tout droit (straight on, 'too DRWAH') and à droite (on the right, 'ah DRWAHT') sound close. Listen for the final T!

Describe where things are, aloud.

Le livre est sur la table.

Le chien est sous la chaise.

La gare est près du centre.

J'habite à Paris, en France.

Mon frère travaille au Japon.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

99. What does sous mean?

- ○ A) under
- ○ B) on
- ○ C) in
- ○ D) next to

100. Complete: La poste est à côté ___ cinéma.

- ○ A) de le
- ○ B) de la
- ○ C) des
- ○ D) du

101. Listen. Where is it? (listen in the web app: derrière la maison)

- ○ A) in front of the house
- ○ B) behind the house
- ○ C) next to the house
- ○ D) inside the house

102. Complete: Je vais ___ Portugal.

- ○ A) en
- ○ B) à
- ○ C) aux
- ○ D) au

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103. Complete: Elle habite ___ Londres.

- ○ A) en
- ○ B) à
- ○ C) au

104. What does tout droit mean?

- ○ A) on the right
- ○ B) all right
- ○ C) turn back
- ○ D) straight on

105. Complete: Nous allons ___ Italie.

- ○ A) au
- ○ B) à la
- ○ C) aux
- ○ D) en

☐ Lesson done Date: _____

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UNIT 4

Answer key

1. A) situation
Nouns ending in -tion are feminine.

2. C) les bateaux

3. B) To know their gender

4. B) Plural: you hear 'lay'

5. C) -ment

6. B) une actrice

7. C) plage
la plage (beach) is a famous exception.

8. D) l'
école starts with a vowel, so la becomes l'.

9. B) du
lait is masculine: du lait.

10. C) de
After ne... pas, use de.

11. A) le
After adorer, use le / la / les.

12. B) some apples

13. A) J'ai des amis à Paris.

14. C) some water

15. D) sommes

16. B) êtes

17. A) They are.

18. D) Elle est médecin.
No article before a job after il est / elle est.

19. B) C'est
Before an article + noun, use c'est.

20. C) We're ready!

21. D) suis

22. B) avons

23. C) J'ai froid.

24. B) They're hungry.

25. C) to need

26. A) avoir (they have)
You hear a Z sound: elles ont.

27. A) You're wrong.

28. A) ai

29. C) parles

30. B) aimons

31. A) It is silent

32. B) je parle and ils parlent

33. C) J'écoute de la musique.

34. C) habitez

35. A) she works / she's working

36. B) Je ne parle pas chinois.

37. B) n'
aime starts with a vowel, so ne becomes n'.

38. C) I never eat fish.

39. B) He doesn't live here any more.

40. B) Je n'ai pas de voiture.

41. B) Me neither

42. D) Je ne veux pas partir.

43. C) Parlez-vous anglais ?

44. A) where

45. D) Why are you leaving?

46. A) Est-ce que

47. B) Parle-t-il français ?

48. C) Parce que...

49. C) How much does it cost?

50. A) blanche

51. A) un livre intéressant

52. C) jolie
joli is a Beauty adjective: BAGS.

53. A) a good idea

54. C) vieil
Before a masculine noun starting with a vowel, vieux becomes vieil.

55. A) heureuses

56. A) une grande voiture rouge

57. C) ma

58. A) His car
sa agrees with voiture (feminine). The owner is il, so: his car.

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59. A) mon
Before a vowel, use mon even for a feminine noun.

60. D) leurs parents

61. D) our children

62. B) le livre d'Anna

63. A) votre

64. D) allons

65. D) au
cinéma is masculine: à + le = au.

66. C) Je vais manger.

67. D) tomorrow

68. C) Je ne vais pas travailler.

69. B) aux
les États-Unis is plural: à + les = aux.

70. D) next week

71. B) faites

72. C) prennent

73. B) Can I come in?

74. D) Il fait beau.

75. A) I've just eaten.

76. C) voulons

77. C) Je voudrais un café.

78. C) la

79. A) Je le vois.
The object pronoun goes before the verb.

80. A) I love you.

81. B) moi
After a preposition like pour, use a stressed pronoun.

82. A) Il les regarde.

83. B) Je ne le vois pas.

84. B) Me too

85. C) fini

86. C) J'ai mangé.

87. B) fait

88. B) We saw the sea.

89. B) Je n'ai pas fini.

90. B) I took the train.

91. A) ont

92. D) partir

93. D) arrivée
Feminine subject: add -e.

94. A) Nous sommes allés au cinéma.

95. A) I was born in April.

96. C) Il est tombé.

97. A) Ils ne sont pas venus.

98. A) The subject is feminine plural.

99. A) under

100. D) du
de + le = du.

101. B) behind the house

102. D) au
le Portugal is masculine: au.

103. B) à
Use à with cities.

104. D) straight on

105. D) en
l'Italie is feminine: en.

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Ça

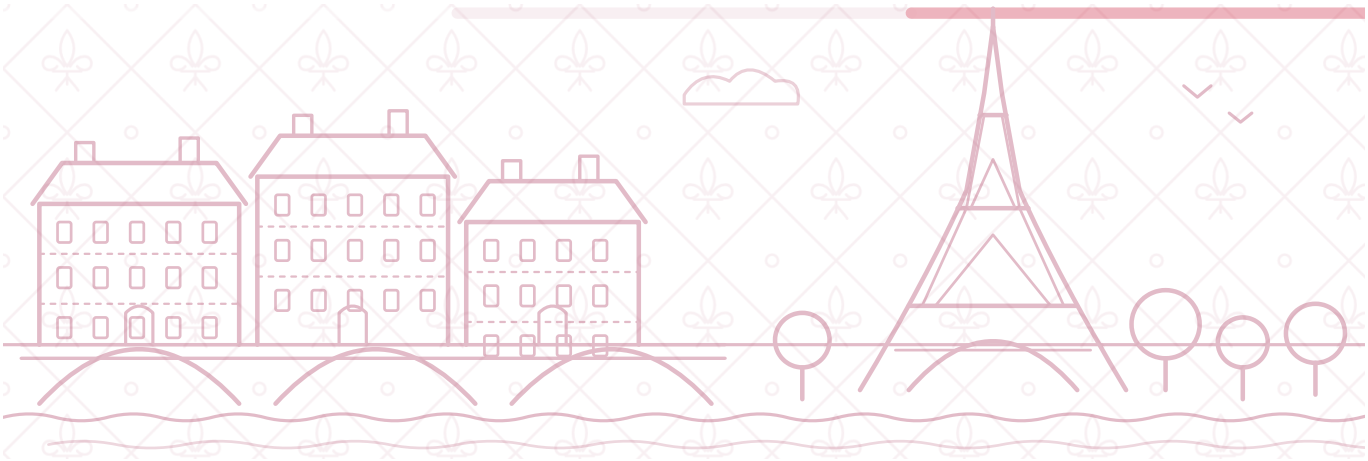
UNIT 5

Everyday Conversations

Real French for cafés, shops, travel, health, the phone and friends

1. At the Café
2. At the Restaurant
3. Shopping & the Market
4. Asking for Directions
5. Transport & the Train Station
6. At the Hotel
7. At the Doctor & Pharmacy
8. Phone Calls & Appointments
9. Making Plans with Friends
10. Small Talk & the Weather

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Ca

UNIT 5 · LESSON 1 · 12 MINUTES

At the Café

Order a drink, ask for the bill and pay

- Order drinks and snacks politely
- Ask for the bill and pay by card
- Understand how French cafés work

Cafés are at the heart of French daily life. In this lesson you will order a drink and a snack, ask for the bill and pay, all in polite, natural French.

Café words

French	Say it	Meaning
un café	uhn ka-FAY	an espresso (small black coffee)
un café crème	uhn ka-FAY KREM	a coffee with frothy milk
un thé	uhn TAY	a tea
un chocolat chaud	uhn sho-ko-LA SHOH	a hot chocolate
un jus d'orange	uhn zhew do-RAHNZH	an orange juice
un croissant	uhn krwah-SAHN	a croissant
une carafe d'eau	ewn ka-RAF DOH	a jug of tap water
l'addition	la-dee-SYOHN	the bill / the check
la terrasse	la teh-RASS	the outdoor seating area
Je voudrais…	zhuh voo-DRAY	I would like… Je voudrais un thé. (zhuh voo-DRAY uhn TAY.) — I would like a tea.

On the terrace

Serveur Bonjour madame ! Vous avez choisi ?
bohn-ZHOOR ma-DAM ! voo za-vay shwa-ZEE ?
Hello madam! Have you chosen?

Léa Bonjour ! Je voudrais un café crème, s'il vous plaît.
bohn-ZHOOR ! zhuh voo-DRAY uhn ka-fay KREM, seel voo PLAY.
Hello! I'd like a coffee with milk, please.

Serveur Très bien. Et avec ça ?
tray BYAN. ay ah-vek SA ?
Very good. Anything else? (lit. And with that?)

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Léa Un croissant et une carafe d'eau, s'il vous plaît.
uhn krwah-SAHN ay ewn ka-raf DOH, seel voo PLAY.
A croissant and a jug of water, please.

Serveur Je vous apporte ça tout de suite.
zhuh voo za-PORT sa toot SWEET.
I'll bring it right away.

Léa Excusez-moi ! L'addition, s'il vous plaît.
ek-skew-zay-MWAH ! la-dee-SYOHN, seel voo PLAY.
Excuse me! The bill, please.

Serveur Bien sûr. Ça fait six euros cinquante.
byan SEWR. sa feh see zuh-ROH san-KAHNT.
Of course. That's six euros fifty.

Léa Je peux payer par carte ?
zhuh puh pay-yay par KART ?
Can I pay by card?

Serveur Oui, pas de problème. Voilà.
WEE, pahd pro-BLEM. vwah-LA.
Yes, no problem. Here you go.

Léa Merci, bonne journée !
mair-SEE, bun zhoor-NAY !
Thanks, have a nice day!

Je voudrais un café, s'il vous plaît.

Je	voudrais	un	café	s'il	vous	plaît
I	would like	a	coffee	if it	you	pleases

zhuh voo-DRAY uhn ka-FAY, seel voo PLAY.

I would like a coffee, please.

S'il vous plaît literally means 'if it pleases you'. With a friend, say s'il te plaît.

L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

L'addition	s'il	vous	plaît
the bill	if it	you	pleases

la-dee-SYOHN, seel voo PLAY.

The bill, please.

Je peux payer par carte ?

Je	peux	payer	par	carte
I	can	pay	by	card

zhuh puh pay-yay par KART ?

Can I pay by card?

Just raise your voice at the end and a statement becomes a question.

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CULTURE NOTE

In France, un café is a small, strong espresso. For a bigger coffee with milk, ask for un café crème (in Paris often just un crème). Café au lait is mostly something people make at home.

CULTURE NOTE

Service is included in the price by law (service compris). Leaving a few coins is a kind extra, never an obligation. To call the waiter, say Excusez-moi ! or S'il vous plaît ! Never shout Garçon !: it sounds rude today.

TIP

In many cafés a drink costs a little less at the counter (au comptoir) than at a table or on the terrace.

Role-play: your turn

1 **Greet the waiter**

Bonjour !

bohn-ZHOOR !

Hello!

2 **Order a drink**

Je voudrais un thé, s'il vous plaît.

zhuh voo-DRAY uhn TAY, seel voo PLAY.

I'd like a tea, please.

3 **Add a snack**

Et un croissant, s'il vous plaît.

ay uhn krwah-SAHN, seel voo PLAY.

And a croissant, please.

4 **Ask for the bill**

L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

la-dee-SYOHN, seel voo PLAY.

The bill, please.

5 **Pay and leave**

Merci, bonne journée !

mair-SEE, bun zhoor-NAY !

Thanks, have a nice day!

In the evening, say Bonne soirée ! (Have a nice evening!) instead.

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Read each line aloud. Then order your own favourite drink.

Bonjour ! Je voudrais un chocolat chaud, s'il vous plaît.

Et avec ça ?

Un croissant et une carafe d'eau, s'il vous plaît.

L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

Je peux payer par carte ?

Merci, bonne journée !

Quick quiz

QUIZ

1. In a French café, what do you get if you order un café?
   - ○ A) A large filter coffee
   - ○ B) A coffee with milk
   - ○ C) A cup of tea
   - ○ D) A small espresso
2. Listen. What is the customer asking for? (listen in the web app: L'addition, s'il vous plaît.)
   - ○ A) The menu
   - ○ B) Some water
   - ○ C) The bill
   - ○ D) A table
3. How do you say 'I would like a tea'?
   - ○ A) Je voudrais un thé.
   - ○ B) Je voudrais une thé.
   - ○ C) Je suis voudrais un thé.
   - ○ D) J'ai un thé.
4. What is the polite way to call the waiter?
   - ○ A) Garçon !
   - ○ B) Hé, vous là-bas !
   - ○ C) Excusez-moi !
   - ○ D) Allô !
5. Listen. How much is it? (listen in the web app: Ça fait six euros cinquante.)
   - ○ A) €5.60
   - ○ B) €16.50
   - ○ C) €6.15
   - ○ D) €6.50
6. Is service (the tip) included in a French café bill?
   - ○ A) No, always add 20%
   - ○ B) Only on the terrace
   - ○ C) Yes, by law
   - ○ D) Only in Paris

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 2 · 14 MINUTES

At the Restaurant

Book a table, order a meal and pay

- Book and ask for a table
- Order a starter, main course and drinks
- Avoid the menu / carte trap

Eating out in France is a real pleasure, and a little French goes a long way. Learn how to get a table, order a full meal and say it was delicious.

Restaurant words

French	Say it	Meaning
la carte	la KART	the menu (the full list of dishes)
le menu	luh muh-NEW	a set meal at a fixed price
l'entrée	lahn-TRAY	the starter
le plat principal	luh pla pran-see-PAL	the main course
le dessert	luh deh-SAIR	the dessert
le plat du jour	luh pla dew ZHOOR	today's special
l'eau gazeuse	loh ga-ZUHZ	sparkling water
l'eau plate	loh PLAT	still water
saignant / à point / bien cuit	seh-NYAHN / ah PWAN / byan KWEE	rare / medium / well done (meat)
C'était délicieux !	say-TAY day-lee-SYUH !	It was delicious!

Watch out: false friends

la carte

the menu

The full list of dishes. Ask: La carte, s'il vous plaît.

le menu

a set meal

Two or three courses at one fixed price, e.g. entrée + plat.

l'entrée

the starter

In France the entrée comes first. It is not the main course.

Dinner for two

Serveuse Bonsoir ! Vous avez réservé ?
bohn-SWAR ! voo za-vay ray-zair-VAY ?
Good evening! Do you have a reservation?

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Marc Oui, une table pour deux, au nom de Martin.
WEE, ewn TABL poor DUH, oh nohm duh mar-TAN.
Yes, a table for two, in the name of Martin.

Serveuse Suivez-moi, s'il vous plaît. Voici la carte.
swee-vay-MWAH, seel voo PLAY. vwah-SEE la KART.
Follow me, please. Here is the menu.

Marc Merci. Qu'est-ce que vous nous conseillez ?
mair-SEE. kess-kuh voo noo kohn-seh-YAY ?
Thank you. What do you recommend?

Serveuse Le plat du jour : un bœuf bourguignon maison.
luh pla dew ZHOOR : uhn buhf boor-gee-NYOHN meh-ZOHN.
Today's special: a homemade beef bourguignon.

Marc Parfait ! Deux plats du jour, s'il vous plaît.
par-FAY ! duh pla dew ZHOOR, seel voo PLAY.
Perfect! Two of today's special, please.

Serveuse Et comme boisson ?
ay kom bwah-SOHN ?
And to drink?

Marc Une bouteille d'eau gazeuse, s'il vous plaît.
ewn boo-TAY doh ga-ZUHZ, seel voo PLAY.
A bottle of sparkling water, please.

Serveuse Tout s'est bien passé ?
too say byan pa-SAY ?
Was everything all right?

Marc Oui, c'était délicieux ! L'addition, s'il vous plaît.
WEE, say-TAY day-lee-SYUH ! la-dee-SYOHN, seel voo PLAY.
Yes, it was delicious! The bill, please.

Une table pour deux, s'il vous plaît.

Une	table	pour	deux	s'il	vous	plaît
a	table	for	two	if it	you	pleases

ewn TABL poor DUH, seel voo PLAY.

A table for two, please.

Qu'est-ce que vous nous conseillez ?

Qu'est-ce	que	vous	nous	conseillez
what (is it)	that	you	to us	advise

kess-kuh voo noo kohn-seh-YAY ?

What do you recommend (to us)?

Qu'est-ce que is a very common way to start a 'what' question.

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Je suis allergique aux cacahuètes.

Je	suis	allergique	aux	cacahuètes
I	am	allergic	to the	peanuts

zhuh swee za-lair-ZHEEK oh ka-ka-WET.

I'm allergic to peanuts.

Swap in your own allergy: au lait (milk), au gluten (gluten), aux fruits de mer (seafood).

CULTURE NOTE

Waiters will not bring the bill until you ask. Taking your time is normal, and rushing guests would be rude. When you are ready, say L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

CULTURE NOTE

Tap water (une carafe d'eau) is free with a meal in French restaurants, and bread is usually free too.

TIP

Lunch is usually served from about 12:00 to 14:00 and dinner from about 19:30. Between meals many kitchens close, so look for a brasserie, which often serves food all day.

Role-play: your turn

1 **Ask for a table**

Bonsoir, une table pour deux, s'il vous plaît.

bohn-SWAR, ewn TABL poor DUH, seel voo PLAY.

Good evening, a table for two, please.

2 **Order your meal**

En entrée, la soupe, et en plat, le poulet.

ahn nahn-TRAY, la SOOP, ay ahn PLA, luh poo-LAY.

For the starter, the soup, and for the main, the chicken.

3 **Ask for water**

Une carafe d'eau, s'il vous plaît.

ewn ka-raf DOH, seel voo PLAY.

A jug of tap water, please.

4 **Say thank you**

C'était délicieux, merci !

say-TAY day-lee-SYUH, mair-SEE !

It was delicious, thank you!

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5

Ask for the bill

L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

la-dee-SYOHN, seel voo PLAY.

The bill, please.

Read the lines aloud as if you were the customer.

Bonsoir ! Une table pour deux, s'il vous plaît.

La carte, s'il vous plaît.

Qu'est-ce que vous nous conseillez ?

Le plat du jour, s'il vous plaît. À point, merci.

Une bouteille d'eau gazeuse, s'il vous plaît.

C'était délicieux ! L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

7. In a French restaurant, what is l'entrée?
   - ○ A) The main course
   - ○ B) The way in
   - ○ C) The dessert
   - ○ D) The starter

8. You want the full list of dishes. You ask for…
   - ○ A) le menu
   - ○ B) la carte
   - ○ C) la liste
   - ○ D) l'addition

9. Listen. What does the customer want? (listen in the web app: Une carafe d'eau, s'il vous plaît.)
   - ○ A) Tap water
   - ○ B) A bottle of wine
   - ○ C) Sparkling water
   - ○ D) The bill

10. How do you ask for meat cooked medium?
    - ○ A) saignant
    - ○ B) à point
    - ○ C) bien cuit
    - ○ D) à moitié

11. When does the waiter usually bring the bill?
    - ○ A) With the dessert
    - ○ B) As soon as you finish eating
    - ○ C) After exactly one hour
    - ○ D) When you ask for it

12. Listen. What did the customer say? (listen in the web app: C'était délicieux !)
    - ○ A) It was too expensive!
    - ○ B) It's my birthday!
    - ○ C) It was delicious!
    - ○ D) The bill, please!

☐ Lesson done Date: _____

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 3 · 14 MINUTES

Shopping & the Market

Ask prices, choose quantities and try things on

- Ask how much something costs
- Buy food by the kilo at a market
- Shop for clothes politely

From the open-air market to a clothes shop, these phrases help you ask prices, choose quantities and pay with confidence.

Shopping words

French	Say it	Meaning
le marché	luh mar-SHAY	the market
Combien ça coûte ?	kohm-BYAN sa KOOT ?	How much does it cost?
C'est combien ?	say kohm-BYAN ?	How much is it?
un kilo de…	uhn kee-LOH duh	a kilo of… un kilo de pommes (uhn kee-LOH duh POM) — a kilo of apples
une barquette	ewn bar-KET	a small tray / punnet (for berries)
C'est tout.	say TOO.	That's all.
la monnaie	la mo-NEH	the change (money back)
trop cher	troh SHAIR	too expensive
la taille	la TIE	the size (clothes)
essayer	eh-seh-YAY	to try on
la caisse	la KESS	the checkout / till
les soldes	lay SOLD	the sales

At the market stall

Vendeur Bonjour madame ! Qu'est-ce qu'il vous faut ?
bohn-ZHOOR ma-DAM ! kess-keel voo FOH ?
Hello madam! What do you need?

Sophie Bonjour ! Un kilo de tomates, s'il vous plaît.
bohn-ZHOOR ! uhn kee-loh duh to-MAT, seel voo PLAY.
Hello! A kilo of tomatoes, please.

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Vendeur Voilà. Et avec ceci ?
vwah-LA. ay ah-vek suh-SEE ?
There you go. Anything else?

Sophie Elles sont combien, les fraises ?
el sohn kohm-BYAN, lay FREZ ?
How much are the strawberries?

Vendeur Quatre euros la barquette.
ka-truh-ROH la bar-KET.
Four euros a punnet.

Sophie D'accord, une barquette. C'est tout, merci.
da-KOR, ewn bar-KET. say TOO, mair-SEE.
OK, one punnet. That's all, thanks.

Vendeur Ça fait six euros vingt.
sa feh see zuh-roh VAN.
That's six euros twenty.

Sophie Voilà dix euros.
vwah-LA dee zuh-ROH.
Here's ten euros.

Vendeur Et voici votre monnaie. Bonne journée !
ay vwah-SEE votr mo-NEH. bun zhoor-NAY !
And here's your change. Have a nice day!

Sophie Merci, vous aussi !
mair-SEE, voo zoh-SEE !
Thanks, you too!

Je regarde, merci.

Je	regarde	merci
I	am looking	thanks

zhuh ruh-GARD, mair-SEE.

I'm just looking, thanks.

The perfect answer when a shop assistant asks Je peux vous aider ? (Can I help you?).

Je peux l'essayer ?

Je	peux	l'essayer
I	can	try it on

zhuh puh leh-seh-YAY ?

Can I try it on?

Vous l'avez en plus grand ?

Vous	l'avez	en	plus	grand
you	have it	in	more	big

voo la-VAY ahn plew GRAHN ?

Do you have it in a bigger size?

Change grand to petit for a smaller size.

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CULTURE NOTE

Always say Bonjour when you walk into a shop, and Merci, au revoir when you leave. In France, asking a question without a greeting can seem rude.

CULTURE NOTE

At many market stalls the seller chooses the fruit for you, so ask before you touch. Prices are written with a comma: 6,20 € means six euros twenty.

DID YOU KNOW?

France has official sales seasons (les soldes): one in winter, starting in January, and one in summer, starting in late June. The dates are set nationally.

Role-play: your turn

1

Greet the seller

Bonjour !

bohn-ZHOOR !

Hello!

2

Ask the price

C'est combien ?

say kohm-BYAN ?

How much is it?

3

Choose a quantity

Cinq cents grammes de cerises, s'il vous plaît.

san sahn GRAM duh suh-REEZ, seel voo PLAY.

500 grams of cherries, please.

4

Finish your order

C'est tout, merci.

say TOO, mair-SEE.

That's all, thanks.

5

Pay and say goodbye

Merci, au revoir !

mair-SEE, oh ruh-VWAR !

Thanks, goodbye!

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Read aloud. Then change the fruit and the quantity.

Bonjour ! Un kilo de pommes, s'il vous plaît.

Elles sont combien, les fraises ?

C'est tout, merci.

Je regarde, merci.

Je peux l'essayer ?

Vous l'avez en plus petit ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

13. A shop assistant asks Je peux vous aider ? You only want to browse. You say…

- ○ A) Je voudrais l'addition.
- ○ B) Je regarde, merci.
- ○ C) Combien ça coûte ?
- ○ D) C'est trop cher.

14. Listen. What is the question? (listen in the web app: C'est combien ?)

- ○ A) What size is it?
- ○ B) Where is it?
- ○ C) How much is it?
- ○ D) Is that all?

15. What does la monnaie mean at the till?

- ○ A) The money bag
- ○ B) The change
- ○ C) The receipt
- ○ D) The price tag

16. What should you do first when you walk into a French shop?

- ○ A) Say Bonjour
- ○ B) Ask the price at once
- ○ C) Touch the products
- ○ D) Say nothing and look

17. Listen. How much is it? (listen in the web app: Six euros vingt.)

- ○ A) €2.60
- ○ B) €6.20
- ○ C) €16.20
- ○ D) €6.02

18. Je peux l'essayer ? means…

- ○ A) Can I try it on?
- ○ B) Can I pay by card?
- ○ C) Do you have it in blue?
- ○ D) Is it on sale?

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 4 · 12 MINUTES

Asking for Directions

Ask the way and understand the answer

- Ask where a place is
- Understand left, right and straight on
- Use Il y a… to ask what is nearby

Lost in a new town? With a few words you can ask the way and, more importantly, understand the answer.

Direction words

French	Say it	Meaning
Où est… ?	oo EH	Where is…? Où est la gare ? (oo eh la GAR ?) — Where is the station?
à gauche	ah GOHSH	on the left / to the left
à droite	ah DRWAHT	on the right / to the right
tout droit	too DRWAH	straight on
tournez	toor-NAY	turn
prenez	pruh-NAY	take
la rue	la REW	the street
les feux	lay FUH	the traffic lights
le carrefour	luh kar-FOOR	the crossroads
près d'ici	preh dee-SEE	near here
loin	LWAN	far
en face de	ahn FASS duh	opposite
à côté de	ah koh-TAY duh	next to

Don't mix them up

à droite
to the right
You can hear the T at the end: drwaht.

tout droit
straight on
The T is silent: drwah. No turn at all!

à gauche
to the left
The opposite of à droite.

Finding the station

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Tom Excusez-moi, madame. Où est la gare, s'il vous plaît ?
ek-skew-zay-MWAH, ma-DAM. oo eh la GAR, seel voo PLAY ?
Excuse me, madam. Where is the station, please?

Passante La gare ? Ce n'est pas loin. Allez tout droit.
la GAR ? suh neh pa LWAN. a-lay too DRWAH.
The station? It's not far. Go straight on.

Passante Aux feux, tournez à gauche.
oh FUH, toor-nay ah GOHSH.
At the traffic lights, turn left.

Tom Aux feux, à gauche… Et après ?
oh FUH, ah GOHSH… ay ah-PREH ?
At the lights, left… And then?

Passante Prenez la deuxième rue à droite.
pruh-nay la duh-zyem REW ah DRWAHT.
Take the second street on the right.

Passante La gare est en face de la poste.
la GAR eh tahn FASS duh la POST.
The station is opposite the post office.

Tom C'est à combien de minutes à pied ?
say tah kohm-BYAN duh mee-NEWT ah PYAY ?
How many minutes is it on foot?

Passante Environ dix minutes.
ahn-vee-ROHN dee mee-NEWT.
About ten minutes.

Tom Merci beaucoup, madame !
mair-SEE boh-KOO, ma-DAM !
Thank you very much, madam!

Passante Je vous en prie. Bonne journée !
zhuh voo zahn PREE. bun zhoor-NAY !
You're welcome. Have a nice day!

Où est la gare ?

Où	est	la	gare
where	is	the	station

oo eh la GAR ?

Where is the station?

C'est loin d'ici ?

C'est	loin	d'ici
it is	far	from here

say LWAN dee-SEE ?

Is it far from here?

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Il y a une pharmacie près d'ici ?

Il	y	a	une	pharmacie	près	d'ici
it	there	has	a	pharmacy	near	from here

eel ya ewn far-ma-SEE preh dee-SEE ?

Is there a pharmacy near here?

Il y a means 'there is / there are'. It is one of the most useful phrases in French.

CULTURE NOTE

Before asking for help, always start with Excusez-moi and Bonjour (or Bonsoir in the evening). People are much happier to help.

TIP

If the answer is too fast, say Pardon, vous pouvez répéter plus lentement ? (Sorry, can you repeat more slowly?).

Role-play: your turn

1 **Get attention**

Excusez-moi, monsieur.

ek-skew-zay-MWAH, muh-SYUH.

Excuse me, sir.

2 **Ask the way**

Où est le musée, s'il vous plaît ?

oo eh luh mew-ZAY, seel voo PLAY ?

Where is the museum, please?

3 **Check the distance**

C'est loin ?

say LWAN ?

Is it far?

4 **Repeat the key words**

À droite, puis tout droit ?

ah DRWAHT, pwee too DRWAH ?

Right, then straight on?

5 **Say thank you**

Merci beaucoup !

mair-SEE boh-KOO !

Thank you very much!

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Read aloud. Then give directions from your home to the nearest shop.

Excusez-moi, où est la poste, s'il vous plaît ?

Allez tout droit, puis tournez à gauche.

Prenez la première rue à droite.

La banque est à côté de la pharmacie.

C'est loin d'ici ?

Non, c'est à cinq minutes à pied.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

19. Listen. What should you do? (listen in the web app: Tournez à droite.)

- ○ A) Turn left
- ○ B) Go straight on
- ○ C) Turn right
- ○ D) Go back

20. How do you say 'straight on'?

- ○ A) à droite
- ○ B) à gauche
- ○ C) au carrefour
- ○ D) tout droit

21. en face de la poste means...

- ○ A) opposite the post office
- ○ B) just next to the post office
- ○ C) inside the post office
- ○ D) behind the post office

22. Listen. How far is it? (listen in the web app: C'est à dix minutes à pied.)

- ○ A) Ten minutes on foot
- ○ B) Ten minutes by bus
- ○ C) Two minutes on foot
- ○ D) Ten kilometres away

23. What does Il y a une banque près d'ici ? mean?

- ○ A) Where is the bank?
- ○ B) Is there a bank near here?
- ○ C) Is the bank open today?
- ○ D) Is the bank far from here?

24. les feux are...

- ○ A) traffic lights
- ○ B) the street signs
- ○ C) the crossroads
- ○ D) the bus stops

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 5 · 14 MINUTES

Transport & the Train Station

Buy tickets and find your way by train, metro and bus

- Buy a one-way or return ticket
- Ask about times and tracks
- Say how you travel

France has fast trains, big-city metros and buses almost everywhere. Learn how to buy a ticket, find your train and ask about times.

Travel words

French	Say it	Meaning
la gare	la GAR	the train station
un billet	uhn bee-YAY	a ticket
un aller simple	uhn na-lay SAMPL	a one-way ticket
un aller-retour	uhn na-lay ruh-TOOR	a return ticket
la voie	la VWAH	the track (where your train leaves)
le quai	luh KAY	the platform
le départ / l'arrivée	luh day-PAR / la-ree-VAY	departure / arrival
en retard	ahn ruh-TAR	late / delayed
à l'heure	ah LUHR	on time
le métro	luh may-TROH	the underground / subway
l'arrêt de bus	la-REH duh BEWS	the bus stop
la correspondance	la ko-res-pohn-DAHNS	the connection / change of line

At the ticket office

Nina Bonjour, un billet pour Lyon, s'il vous plaît.
bohn-ZHOOR, uhn bee-YAY poor lee-OHN, seel voo PLAY.
Hello, a ticket to Lyon, please.

Agent Un aller simple ou un aller-retour ?
uhn na-lay SAMPL oo uhn na-lay ruh-TOOR ?
One-way or return?

Nina Un aller-retour. Je pars demain et je reviens dimanche.
uhn na-lay ruh-TOOR. zhuh par duh-MAN ay zhuh ruh-vyan dee-MAHNSH.
A return. I leave tomorrow and come back on Sunday.

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Agent Il y a un train demain à huit heures douze. Ça vous va ?
eel ya uhn TRAN duh-MAN ah wee tuhr DOOZ. sa voo VA ?
There's a train tomorrow at 8:12. Does that suit you?

Nina Oui, parfait. C'est direct ?
WEE, par-FAY. say dee-REKT ?
Yes, perfect. Is it direct?

Agent Oui, c'est direct. Ça fait quatre-vingt-cinq euros.
WEE, say dee-REKT. sa feh ka-truh-van-san-kuh-ROH.
Yes, it's direct. That's 85 euros.

Nina Le train part de quelle voie ?
luh TRAN par duh kel VWAH ?
Which track does the train leave from?

Agent Regardez le tableau des départs. La voie est affichée vingt minutes avant.
ruh-gar-DAY luh ta-BLOH day day-PAR. la VWAH eh ta-fee-SHAY van mee-NEWT ah-VAHN.
Check the departures board. The track is shown twenty minutes before.

Nina D'accord, merci beaucoup !
da-KOR, mair-SEE boh-KOO !
OK, thanks a lot!

How do you travel?

French	Meaning
en train	by train
en bus	by bus
en métro	by metro
en voiture	by car
en avion	by plane
à pied	on foot
à vélo	by bike

A simple rule of thumb: use en for vehicles you sit inside, and à for pied (foot) and vélo (bike).

Un aller-retour pour Lyon, s'il vous plaît.

Un	aller-retour	pour	Lyon	s'il	vous	plaît
a	return ticket	for / to	Lyon	if it	you	pleases

uhn na-lay ruh-TOOR poor lee-OHN, seel voo PLAY.

A return ticket to Lyon, please.

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À quelle heure part le prochain train ?

À	quelle	heure	part	le	prochain	train
at	what	hour / time	leaves	the	next	train

ah kel UHR par luh pro-shan TRAN ?

What time does the next train leave?

Je descends au prochain arrêt.

Je	descends	au	prochain	arrêt
I	get off	at the	next	stop

zhuh day-SAHN oh pro-shan na-REH.

I'm getting off at the next stop.

CULTURE NOTE

Timetables, tickets and announcements use the 24-hour clock: seize heures is 4 pm and vingt heures trente is 8:30 pm.

CULTURE NOTE

On high-speed trains (TGV) your seat is reserved, so check your coach number (la voiture) and seat. On a crowded metro, say Pardon to get past people.

WATCH OUT

Some paper tickets for regional trains and buses must be validated in a machine before you travel (composter or valider). If you forget, you can be fined.

Role-play: your turn

1 **Ask for a ticket**

Un billet pour Marseille, s'il vous plaît.

uhn bee-YAY poor mar-SAY, seel voo PLAY.

A ticket to Marseille, please.

2 **Choose the type**

Un aller simple, s'il vous plaît.

uhn na-lay SAMPL, seel voo PLAY.

A one-way ticket, please.

3 **Ask the time**

À quelle heure part le train ?

ah kel UHR par luh TRAN ?

What time does the train leave?

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4 **Ask about the track**

C'est quelle voie ?

say kel VWAH ?

Which track is it?

5 **Check the route**

C'est direct ?

say dee-REKT ?

Is it direct?

Read aloud. Then plan a trip to a French city you'd like to visit.

Un aller-retour pour Paris, s'il vous plaît.

À quelle heure part le prochain train ?

Le train est en retard.

Je vais à la gare à pied.

Où est l'arrêt de bus ?

Je descends au prochain arrêt.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

25. A ticket there and back is…

- A) un aller simple
- B) un billet simple
- C) un retour-départ
- D) un aller-retour

26. Listen. What's the problem? (listen in the web app: Le train est en retard.)

- A) The train is on time.
- B) The train is full.
- C) The train is direct.
- D) The train is late.

27. How do you say 'on foot'?

- A) en pied
- B) en voiture
- C) à pied
- D) par pied

28. Listen. When does the train leave? (listen in the web app: Le train part à seize heures.)

- A) 6 pm
- B) 4 pm
- C) 4 am
- D) 10 pm

29. la correspondance on the metro is…

- A) a change of line
- B) a letter
- C) the ticket machine
- D) the last train

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30. On a TGV, la voiture means…

- ○ A) your own car
- ○ B) the train coach
- ○ C) the taxi rank outside
- ○ D) the driver's cabin

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 6 · 12 MINUTES

H At the Hotel

Check in, ask questions and solve problems

- Check in with a reservation
- Ask about breakfast and check-out
- Report a problem in your room

Checking in, asking about breakfast, reporting a problem: here is the French you need for a smooth hotel stay.

Hotel words

French	Say it	Meaning
une chambre	ewn SHAHMBR	a room (bedroom)
une chambre double	ewn shahmbr DOOBL	a double room
une nuit	ewn NWEE	a night
la clé	la KLAY	the key
le petit-déjeuner	luh puh-tee day-zhuh-NAY	breakfast
compris	kohm-PREE	included
la réception	la ray-sep-SYOHN	the reception desk
l'ascenseur	la-sahn-SUHR	the lift / elevator
le rez-de-chaussée	luh rayd-shoh-SAY	the ground floor
le premier étage	luh pruh-myeh ray-TAZH	the first floor (one floor up)
la douche	la DOOSH	the shower
… ne marche pas	nuh marsh PA	… doesn't work

Checking in

Réceptionniste Bonsoir monsieur, bienvenue !
bohn-SWAR muh-SYUH, byan-vuh-NEW !
Good evening, sir, welcome!

M. Diallo Bonsoir. J'ai une réservation au nom de Diallo.
bohn-SWAR. zhay ewn ray-zair-va-SYOHN oh nohm duh dya-LOH.
Good evening. I have a reservation in the name of Diallo.

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Réceptionniste Oui, une chambre double pour trois nuits.
WEE, ewn shahmbr DOOBL poor trwah NWEE.
Yes, a double room for three nights.

M. Diallo C'est ça. Le petit-déjeuner est compris ?
say SA. luh puh-tee day-zhuh-NAY eh kohm-PREE ?
That's right. Is breakfast included?

Réceptionniste Oui, il est servi de sept heures à dix heures, au rez-de-chaussée.
WEE, eel eh sair-VEE duh seh TUHR ah dee ZUHR, oh rayd-shoh-SAY.
Yes, it's served from 7 to 10, on the ground floor.

M. Diallo Très bien. Et le wifi ?
tray BYAN. ay luh wee-FEE ?
Very good. And the wifi?

Réceptionniste Le code est sur votre carte. Voici votre clé : chambre 214, au deuxième étage.
luh KOD eh sewr votr KART. vwah-SEE votr KLAY : SHAHMBR duh sahn ka-TORZ, oh duh-zyem ay-TAZH.
The code is on your card. Here's your key: room 214, on the second floor.

M. Diallo Merci. Le départ, c'est à quelle heure ?
mair-SEE. luh day-PAR, say tah kel UHR ?
Thanks. What time is check-out?

Réceptionniste Avant onze heures. L'ascenseur est à droite.
ah-VAHN ohn-ZUHR. la-sahn-SUHR eh tah DRWAHT.
Before 11. The lift is on the right.

M. Diallo Parfait, merci. Bonne soirée !
par-FAY, mair-SEE. bun swah-RAY !
Perfect, thanks. Have a nice evening!

J'ai une réservation au nom de Diallo.

J'ai	une	réservation	au	nom	de	Diallo
I have	a	reservation	in the	name	of	Diallo

zhay ewn ray-zair-va-SYOHN oh nohm duh dya-LOH.

I have a reservation in the name of Diallo.

Est-ce que le petit-déjeuner est compris ?

Est-ce	que	le	petit-déjeuner	est	compris
is it (question)	that	the	breakfast	is	included

ess-kuh luh puh-tee day-zhuh-NAY eh kohm-PREE ?

Is breakfast included?

Put Est-ce que at the front to turn any sentence into a yes/no question.

La douche ne marche pas.

La	douche	ne	marche	pas
the	shower	not	works	(not)

la DOOSH nuh marsh PA.

The shower doesn't work.

Swap in le chauffage (the heating), la climatisation (the air conditioning) or le wifi.

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CULTURE NOTE

Floors are counted as in the UK: le rez-de-chaussée is the ground floor and le premier étage is one floor up (the '2nd floor' in the US).

CULTURE NOTE

Most French towns charge a small tourist tax per person per night (la taxe de séjour). It is often added to your bill at the end of your stay.

Role-play: your turn

1 **Greet the receptionist**

Bonsoir !

bohn-SWAR !

Good evening!

2 **Give your name**

J'ai une réservation au nom de...

zhay ewn ray-zair-va-SYOHN oh nohm duh...

I have a reservation in the name of...

3 **Ask about breakfast**

Le petit-déjeuner est à quelle heure ?

luh puh-tee day-zhuh-NAY eh tah kel UHR ?

What time is breakfast?

4 **Report a problem**

Excusez-moi, le wifi ne marche pas.

ek-skew-zay-MWAH, luh wee-FEE nuh marsh PA.

Excuse me, the wifi doesn't work.

5 **Check out**

Je voudrais régler la note, s'il vous plaît.

zhuh voo-DRAY ray-glay la NOT, seel voo PLAY.

I'd like to pay the bill, please.

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Read aloud as the guest.

Bonsoir ! J'ai une réservation au nom de Martin.

Le petit-déjeuner est compris ?

L'ascenseur est où, s'il vous plaît ?

Excusez-moi, la douche ne marche pas.

Je voudrais régler la note, s'il vous plaît.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

31. In a French hotel, le rez-de-chaussée is…

- ○ A) the ground floor
- ○ B) the first floor up
- ○ C) the basement car park
- ○ D) the top floor

32. Listen. What does the receptionist say? (listen in the web app: Le petit-déjeuner est compris.)

- ○ A) Breakfast is not available.
- ○ B) Breakfast is at seven.
- ○ C) Lunch is included.
- ○ D) Breakfast is included.

33. How do you say 'The shower doesn't work'?

- ○ A) La douche ne parle pas.
- ○ B) La clé ne marche pas.
- ○ C) Le douche ne marchent pas.
- ○ D) La douche ne marche pas.

34. l'ascenseur is…

- ○ A) the lift
- ○ B) the staircase
- ○ C) the key card
- ○ D) the receipt

35. Listen. Which room? (listen in the web app: Chambre deux cent quatorze.)

- ○ A) 240
- ○ B) 214
- ○ C) 204
- ○ D) 114

36. Une chambre pour deux nuits is a room for…

- ○ A) two people
- ○ B) two weeks
- ○ C) two nights
- ○ D) twelve nights

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 7 · 14 MINUTES

At the Doctor & Pharmacy

Say what hurts and get the right help

- Say how you feel and what hurts
- Understand simple advice from a doctor
- Get help at a pharmacy and in an emergency

Nobody plans to get ill on a trip, but it helps to be ready. Learn to describe how you feel, understand the doctor and get help at a pharmacy.

Health words

French	Say it	Meaning
le médecin	luh mayd-SAN	the doctor
la pharmacie	la far-ma-SEE	the pharmacy / chemist's
malade	ma-LAD	ill / sick
J'ai mal à la tête.	zhay mal ah la TET.	I have a headache.
J'ai mal à la gorge.	zhay mal ah la GORZH.	I have a sore throat.
J'ai de la fièvre.	zhay duh la FYEVR.	I have a fever.
Je tousse.	zhuh TOOSS.	I'm coughing.
un rhume	uhn REWM	a cold
une ordonnance	ewn or-do-NAHNS	a prescription
un médicament	uhn may-dee-ka-MAHN	a medicine
un comprimé	uhn kohm-pree-MAY	a tablet / pill
les urgences	lay zewr-ZHAHNS	the emergency department (A&E / ER)

avoir mal à + body part

To say something hurts, use J'ai mal + à + the body part. à joins with le and les.

How to say it: à + le = au · à + la = à la · à + l' = à l' · à + les = aux

J'ai mal au dos.
zhay mal oh DOH.

J'ai mal à la tête.
zhay mal ah la TET.

J'ai mal à l'oreille.
zhay mal ah lo-RAY.

J'ai mal aux dents.
zhay mal oh DAHN.

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Where does it hurt?

French	Meaning
J'ai mal à la tête.	My head hurts.
J'ai mal au dos.	My back hurts.
J'ai mal au ventre.	My stomach hurts.
J'ai mal aux dents.	My teeth hurt.
J'ai mal à l'oreille.	My ear hurts.
J'ai mal au pied.	My foot hurts.

At the doctor's

Médecin Bonjour, asseyez-vous. Qu'est-ce qui ne va pas ?
bohn-ZHOOR, a-seh-yay-VOO. kess-kee nuh va PA ?
Hello, take a seat. What's the matter?

Paul J'ai mal à la gorge et j'ai de la fièvre.
zhay mal ah la GORZH ay zhay duh la FYEVR.
I have a sore throat and a fever.

Médecin Depuis quand ?
duh-pwee KAHN ?
Since when?

Paul Depuis deux jours. Et je tousse beaucoup.
duh-pwee duh ZHOOR. ay zhuh tooss boh-KOO.
For two days. And I'm coughing a lot.

Médecin Bon, ce n'est pas grave. C'est un gros rhume.
BOHN, suh neh pa GRAV. say tuhn groh REWM.
Well, it's not serious. It's a bad cold.

Médecin Voici une ordonnance. Reposez-vous et buvez beaucoup d'eau.
vwah-SEE ewn or-do-NAHNS. ruh-poh-zay-VOO ay bew-VAY boh-koo DOH.
Here's a prescription. Rest and drink plenty of water.

Paul Merci, docteur. Je dois revenir ?
mair-SEE, dok-TUHR. zhuh dwah ruh-vuh-NEER ?
Thank you, doctor. Do I need to come back?

Médecin Si ça ne va pas mieux dans trois jours, oui.
see sa nuh va pa MYUH dahn trwah ZHOOR, WEE.
If you're not better in three days, yes.

At the pharmacy

Pharmacienne Bonjour, je peux vous aider ?
bohn-ZHOOR, zhuh puh voo zeh-DAY ?
Hello, can I help you?

Paul Bonjour, j'ai une ordonnance.
bohn-ZHOOR, zhay ewn or-do-NAHNS.
Hello, I have a prescription.

Pharmacienne Merci. Prenez un comprimé trois fois par jour, pendant le repas.
mair-SEE. pruh-NAY uhn kohm-pree-MAY trwah FWAH par ZHOOR, pahn-dahn luh ruh-PA.
Thank you. Take one tablet three times a day, with meals.

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Paul D'accord. Merci beaucoup !
da-KOR. mair-SEE boh-KOO !
OK. Thank you very much!

J'ai besoin d'un médecin.

J'ai	besoin	d'un	médecin
I have	need	of a	doctor

zhay buh-ZWAN duhn mayd-SAN.

I need a doctor.

J'ai besoin de… = I need… (literally 'I have need of…').

J'ai mal à la tête.

J'ai	mal	à	la	tête
I have	pain / ache	at	the	head

zhay mal ah la TET.

I have a headache.

CULTURE NOTE

Look for the green cross. French pharmacists are trained to give advice for small health problems, so a pharmacy is a good first stop. At night and on Sundays, a pharmacie de garde (on-duty pharmacy) is open; its address is posted on pharmacy doors.

WATCH OUT

Emergency numbers in France: 15 for an ambulance (SAMU), 18 for the fire brigade, 17 for the police, and 112 anywhere in the EU.

Role-play: your turn

1 **Say you're ill**

Je suis malade.

zhuh swee ma-LAD.

I'm ill.

2 **Say what hurts**

J'ai mal au ventre.

zhay mal oh VAHNTR.

I have a stomach ache.

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3 **Say since when**

Depuis hier.

duh-pwee YAIR.

Since yesterday.

4 **Mention an allergy**

Je suis allergique à la pénicilline.

zhuh swee za-lair-ZHEEK ah la pay-nee-see-LEEN.

I'm allergic to penicillin.

5 **Ask how to take it**

Je le prends comment ?

zhuh luh prahn ko-MAHN ?

How do I take it?

Read aloud. Then say what hurts using a new body part.

Bonjour, je suis malade.

J'ai mal à la gorge et j'ai de la fièvre.

Depuis deux jours.

J'ai besoin d'un médecin.

Je le prends comment ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

37. Listen. What's wrong? (listen in the web app: J'ai mal à la tête.)

- A) I have a sore throat.
- B) I have a fever.
- C) I have a headache.
- D) I'm very tired.

38. Complete: J'ai mal ___ ventre.

- A) à la
- B) aux
- C) à le
- D) au

39. une ordonnance is…

- A) an order at a café
- B) an appointment
- C) a prescription
- D) a tablet

40. Which number calls an ambulance (SAMU) in France?

- A) 15
- B) 17
- C) 18
- D) 911

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41. Listen. How long has the patient been ill? (listen in the web app: Depuis deux jours.)

- ○ A) For two weeks
- ○ B) Since this morning
- ○ C) For two days
- ○ D) For ten days

42. It's Sunday night and you need medicine. You look for…

- ○ A) le bureau de poste
- ○ B) la pharmacie de garde
- ○ C) la boulangerie
- ○ D) le cabinet du dentiste

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Tél

UNIT 5 · LESSON 8 · 12 MINUTES

Phone Calls & Appointments

Make calls, leave messages and book appointments

- Start and end a phone call
- Book, move or cancel an appointment
- Spell your name and read phone numbers

Phone calls feel harder than face-to-face chats because you can't see faces or gestures. Don't worry: a few fixed phrases do most of the work.

Phone words

French	Say it	Meaning
Allô ?	a-LOH ?	Hello? (on the phone only)
C'est de la part de qui ?	say duh la PAR duh KEE ?	Who's calling, please?
Ne quittez pas.	nuh kee-tay PA.	Hold the line.
rappeler	ra-PLAY	to call back
laisser un message	leh-SAY uhn meh-SAZH	to leave a message
prendre rendez-vous	prahndr rahn-day-VOO	to make an appointment
libre	LEEBR	free / available
annuler	a-new-LAY	to cancel
épeler	ay-PLAY	to spell
le numéro	luh new-may-ROH	the number

Booking the dentist

Secrétaire Cabinet dentaire, bonjour !
ka-bee-NAY dahn-TAIR, bohn-ZHOOR !
Dental practice, hello!

Emma Bonjour, je voudrais prendre rendez-vous, s'il vous plaît.
bohn-ZHOOR, zhuh voo-DRAY prahndr rahn-day-VOO, seel voo PLAY.
Hello, I'd like to make an appointment, please.

Secrétaire Mardi à quatorze heures, ça vous convient ?
mar-DEE ah ka-tor-ZUHR, sa voo kohn-VYAN ?
Tuesday at 2 pm, does that suit you?

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Emma Mardi, je ne suis pas libre. Vous avez quelque chose jeudi ?
mar-DEE, zhuh nuh swee pa LEEBR. voo za-VAY kel-kuh SHOHZ zhuh-DEE ?
I'm not free on Tuesday. Do you have anything on Thursday?

Secrétaire Jeudi à neuf heures et demie ?
zhuh-DEE ah nuh-vuhr ay duh-MEE ?
Thursday at half past nine?

Emma Parfait, merci.
par-FAY, mair-SEE.
Perfect, thank you.

Secrétaire C'est à quel nom ?
say tah kel NOHM ?
What name is it under?

Emma Laurent. Je vous épelle : L-A-U-R-E-N-T.
lo-RAHN. zhuh voo zay-PEL : el, ah, ew, air, uh, en, tay.
Laurent. I'll spell it: L-A-U-R-E-N-T.

Secrétaire Très bien, c'est noté. À jeudi !
tray BYAN, say no-TAY. ah zhuh-DEE !
Very good, that's booked. See you on Thursday!

Asking for someone

Lucas Allô, bonjour. Je voudrais parler à madame Petit, s'il vous plaît.
a-LOH, bohn-ZHOOR. zhuh voo-DRAY par-LAY ah ma-dam puh-TEE, seel voo PLAY.
Hello. I'd like to speak to Ms Petit, please.

Accueil C'est de la part de qui ?
say duh la PAR duh KEE ?
Who's calling, please?

Lucas De Lucas Bernard.
duh lew-KA bair-NAR.
Lucas Bernard.

Accueil Ne quittez pas, je vous la passe.
nuh kee-tay PA, zhuh voo la PASS.
Hold the line, I'll put you through to her.

Je voudrais prendre rendez-vous.

Je	voudrais	prendre	rendez-vous
I	would like	to take	appointment

zhuh voo-DRAY prahndr rahn-day-VOO.

I'd like to make an appointment.

Vous pouvez parler plus lentement ?

Vous	pouvez	parler	plus	lentement
you	can	speak	more	slowly

voo poo-VAY par-LAY plew lahnt-MAHN ?

Can you speak more slowly?

A life-saver on the phone! Also useful: Vous pouvez répéter ? (Can you repeat?).

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Je vous rappelle plus tard.

Je	vous	rappelle	plus	tard
I	you	call back	more	late

zhuh voo ra-PEL plew TAR.

I'll call you back later.

plus tard = later (literally 'more late').

CULTURE NOTE

French phone numbers have ten digits and are read in pairs: 06 12 34 56 78 is zéro six, douze, trente-quatre, cinquante-six, soixante-dix-huit. Mobile numbers start with 06 or 07.

TIP

Use Allô ? only on the phone. To end a call, say Au revoir, bonne journée !

Role-play: your turn

1 **Greet**

Allô, bonjour !

a-LOH, bohn-ZHOOR !

Hello!

2 **Say who you are**

C'est Emma Laurent.

say e-MA lo-RAHN.

It's Emma Laurent.

3 **Say why you're calling**

J'appelle pour prendre rendez-vous.

zha-PEL poor prahndr rahn-day-VOO.

I'm calling to make an appointment.

4 **Confirm the time**

Jeudi à neuf heures et demie, c'est parfait.

zhuh-DEE ah nuh-vuhr ay duh-MEE, say par-FAY.

Thursday at 9:30 is perfect.

5 **Cancel if you need to**

Je dois annuler mon rendez-vous.

zhuh dwah a-new-LAY mohn rahn-day-VOO.

I have to cancel my appointment.

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Read aloud. Then spell your own name with French letter names.

Allô, bonjour !

Je voudrais prendre rendez-vous, s'il vous plaît.

Vous avez quelque chose jeudi ?

Vous pouvez parler plus lentement ?

Je vous rappelle plus tard.

Au revoir, bonne journée !

Quick quiz

QUIZ

43. On the phone, someone says Ne quittez pas. You should...

- A) hang up now
- B) call back tomorrow
- C) wait on the line
- D) leave a message

44. Listen. What are they asking? (listen in the web app: C'est de la part de qui ?)

- A) Where are you calling from?
- B) Who's calling?
- C) What's your number?
- D) Can you call back?

45. How do you say 'to cancel'?

- A) annuler
- B) rappeler
- C) épeler
- D) attendre

46. Listen. When is the appointment? (listen in the web app: Jeudi à neuf heures et demie.)

- A) Tuesday at 9:30
- B) Thursday at 10:30
- C) Thursday at 9:00
- D) Thursday at 9:30

47. How is the number 06 45 22 10 89 usually read?

- A) In pairs: zéro six, quarante-cinq...
- B) Digit by digit: zéro, six, quatre...
- C) As one big number
- D) In groups of three

48. Je vous rappelle plus tard. means...

- A) I'll remind you tomorrow.
- B) I'll call you back later.
- C) Please call me later.
- D) I can't hear you.

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RDV

UNIT 5 · LESSON 9 · 12 MINUTES

Making Plans with Friends

Invite, accept, say no kindly and fix a time

- Invite a friend using tu
- Accept or refuse politely
- Agree on a time and a meeting place

Time to make plans! With friends, French people use tu and a relaxed style. Learn to invite, accept, say no kindly and fix a time and place.

Plans words

French	Say it	Meaning
Tu es libre ?	tew eh LEEBR ?	Are you free?
Ça te dit ?	sa tuh DEE ?	Do you fancy it? / Interested?
ce soir	suh SWAR	tonight / this evening
ce week-end	suh wee-KEND	this weekend
aller au cinéma	a-lay oh see-nay-MA	to go to the cinema
boire un verre	bwar uhn VAIR	to have a drink (lit. drink a glass)
On se retrouve où ?	ohn suh ruh-troov OO ?	Where shall we meet?
Avec plaisir !	ah-vek pleh-ZEER !	I'd love to! (lit. with pleasure)
Ça marche !	sa MARSH !	Deal! / Sounds good!
Une autre fois ?	ewn ohtr FWAH ?	Another time?
À plus !	ah PLEWSS !	See you later! (casual)

Saturday night plans

Inès Salut Hugo ! Tu es libre samedi soir ?
sa-LEW ew-GOH ! tew eh leebr sam-dee SWAR ?
Hi Hugo! Are you free on Saturday evening?

Hugo Samedi ? Oui, pourquoi ?
sam-DEE ? WEE, poor-KWAH ?
Saturday? Yes, why?

Inès Ça te dit d'aller au cinéma ? Il y a un nouveau film.
sa tuh DEE da-LAY oh see-nay-MA ? eel ya uhn noo-voh FEELM.
Fancy going to the cinema? There's a new film.

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Hugo Bonne idée ! Ça commence à quelle heure ?
bun ee-DAY ! sa ko-MAHNS ah kel UHR ?
Good idea! What time does it start?

Inès À vingt heures. On se retrouve au café d'en face à sept heures et demie ?
ah van TUHR. ohn suh ruh-TROOV oh ka-FAY dahn FASS ah seh tuhr ay duh-MEE ?
At 8 pm. Shall we meet at the café opposite at half past seven?

Hugo Ça marche ! Et après, on mange une pizza ?
sa MARSH ! ay ah-PREH, ohn mahnzh ewn peed-ZA ?
Deal! And afterwards, shall we have a pizza?

Inès Avec plaisir ! J'invite Léo aussi ?
ah-vek pleh-ZEER ! zhan-VEET lay-OH oh-SEE ?
I'd love to! Shall I invite Léo too?

Hugo Oui, bien sûr. À samedi !
WEE, byan SEWR. ah sam-DEE !
Yes, of course. See you on Saturday!

Inès À samedi ! Bisous !
ah sam-DEE ! bee-ZOO !
See you Saturday! Love, Inès! (lit. kisses)

Yes or no?

Say yes	Say no kindly
Avec plaisir ! I'd love to!	Désolé, je ne peux pas. Sorry, I can't.
Bonne idée ! Good idea!	Je suis pris ce soir. I'm busy tonight.
Ça marche ! Deal!	Une autre fois ? Another time?
Pourquoi pas ? Why not?	Ce week-end, ce n'est pas possible. This weekend isn't possible.

TIP

A woman says Je suis prise (busy), with a Z sound at the end, and writes Désolée (sorry), which sounds just like Désolé.

Ça te dit d'aller au cinéma ?

Ça	te	dit	d'aller	au	cinéma
that	to you	says	to go	to the	cinema

sa tuh DEE da-LAY oh see-nay-MA ?

Do you fancy going to the cinema?

Literally 'Does it say (something) to you to go…?' A very friendly way to invite.

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On se retrouve où ?

On	se	retrouve	où
we	each other	meet up	where

ohn suh ruh-troov OO ?

Where shall we meet?

In everyday speech, on usually means 'we'.

Désolé, je ne peux pas ce soir.

Désolé	je	ne	peux	pas	ce	soir
sorry	I	not	can	(not)	this	evening

day-zo-LAY, zhuh nuh puh PA suh SWAR.

Sorry, I can't tonight.

CULTURE NOTE

With friends and people your own age, use tu. Text messages between friends often end with Bisous or Bises (kisses). It's friendly, not romantic.

DID YOU KNOW?

Texting shortcuts: A+ = À plus (see you), stp = s'il te plaît, bjr = bonjour, mdr = mort de rire (LOL).

Role-play: your turn

1 **Ask if your friend is free**

Tu es libre ce soir ?

tew eh leebr suh SWAR ?

Are you free tonight?

2 **Suggest something**

Ça te dit de boire un verre ?

sa tuh DEE duh bwar uhn VAIR ?

Fancy a drink?

3 **Fix a time**

On se retrouve à dix-neuf heures ?

ohn suh ruh-troov ah deez-nuh-VUHR ?

Shall we meet at 7 pm?

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4 **Fix a place**

Devant la gare ?

duh-vahn la GAR ?

In front of the station?

5 **Close the chat**

Ça marche, à plus !

sa MARSH, ah PLEWSS !

Deal, see you later!

Read aloud. Then invite a friend to do something you enjoy.

Salut ! Tu es libre samedi ?

Ça te dit d'aller au cinéma ?

Avec plaisir ! On se retrouve où ?

Devant le café, à huit heures.

Désolé, je ne peux pas. Une autre fois ?

Ça marche, à plus !

Quick quiz

QUIZ

49. Your friend asks Ça te dit d'aller au cinéma ? You want to go. You say...

- ○ A) Je vous en prie.
- ○ B) Une autre fois ?
- ○ C) Je suis malade.
- ○ D) Avec plaisir !

50. Listen. What is your friend asking? (listen in the web app: On se retrouve où ?)

- ○ A) Where shall we meet?
- ○ B) What time shall we meet?
- ○ C) Who is coming with us?
- ○ D) Are you free tonight?

51. In everyday French, on usually means...

- ○ A) they
- ○ B) you (formal)
- ○ C) it
- ○ D) we

52. Which phrase politely says no?

- ○ A) Bonne idée, j'arrive tout de suite !
- ○ B) Désolé, je ne peux pas.
- ○ C) Ça marche !
- ○ D) Pourquoi pas ?

53. A friend's text ends with Bisous. This is...

- ○ A) just friendly
- ○ B) very romantic
- ○ C) a bit rude
- ○ D) a spelling mistake

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54. Listen. What does it mean here? (listen in the web app: Ça marche !)

- ○ A) It's walking!
- ○ B) Deal! / OK!
- ○ C) It doesn't work.
- ○ D) Let's walk!

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UNIT 5 · LESSON 10 · 12 MINUTES

Small Talk & the Weather

Chat about the weather and get to know people

- Describe the weather
- Ask where someone is from
- Keep a friendly chat going

Talking about the weather is the easiest way to start a chat with anyone. Add a few friendly questions and you can make small talk like a local.

Weather words

French	Say it	Meaning
Quel temps fait-il ?	kel tahn feh-TEEL ?	What's the weather like?
Il fait beau.	eel feh BOH.	The weather's nice.
Il fait mauvais.	eel feh mo-VEH.	The weather's bad.
Il fait chaud.	eel feh SHOH.	It's hot.
Il fait froid.	eel feh FRWAH.	It's cold.
Il pleut.	eel PLUH.	It's raining.
Il neige.	eel NEZH.	It's snowing.
Il y a du vent.	eel ya dew VAHN.	It's windy.
Il y a du soleil.	eel ya dew so-LAY.	It's sunny.
la météo	la may-tay-OH	the weather forecast

il fait / il y a du / weather verbs

Most weather phrases use il fait + an adjective. Some use il y a du + a noun. Rain and snow have their own verbs.

Il fait chaud. (eel feh SHOH.) Il y a du brouillard. (eel ya dew broo-YAR.) Il pleut. (eel PLUH.)

At the bus stop

Mme Roux Bonjour ! Quel beau temps aujourd'hui !
bohn-ZHOOR ! kel boh TAHN oh-zhoor-DWEE !
Hello! What lovely weather today!

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Sam Oui, enfin du soleil ! Hier, il a plu toute la journée.
WEE, ahn-FAN dew so-LAY ! YAIR, eel a PLEW toot la zhoor-NAY.
Yes, sunshine at last! Yesterday it rained all day.

Mme Roux Vous n'êtes pas d'ici, non ?
voo net pa dee-SEE, NOHN ?
You're not from here, are you?

Sam Non, je suis canadien. Je viens de Toronto.
NOHN, zhuh swee ka-na-DYAN. zhuh vyan duh to-rohn-TOH.
No, I'm Canadian. I'm from Toronto.

Mme Roux Oh, il fait très froid là-bas en hiver, non ?
OH, eel feh tray FRWAH la-BA ahn nee-VAIR, NOHN ?
Oh, it's very cold there in winter, isn't it?

Sam Oui, et il neige beaucoup !
WEE, ay eel nezh boh-KOO !
Yes, and it snows a lot!

Mme Roux Et vous êtes ici en vacances ?
ay voo zet ee-SEE ahn va-KAHNS ?
And are you here on holiday?

Sam Non, je travaille ici pour six mois.
NOHN, zhuh tra-VIGH ee-SEE poor see MWAH.
No, I'm working here for six months.

Mme Roux Super ! Alors, bon séjour en France !
sew-PAIR ! a-LOR, bohn say-ZHOOR ahn FRAHNS !
Great! Well, enjoy your stay in France!

Sam Merci, c'est gentil ! Bonne journée !
mair-SEE, say zhahn-TEE ! bun zhoor-NAY !
Thanks, that's kind! Have a nice day!

Il fait beau aujourd'hui.

Il	fait	beau	aujourd'hui
it	makes / does	nice	today

eel feh BOH oh-zhoor-DWEE.

The weather's nice today.

French uses il fait (literally 'it makes') for most weather.

Quel temps fait-il chez vous ?

Quel	temps	fait-il	chez	vous
what	weather	does it make	at the home of	you

kel tahn feh-teel shay VOO ?

What's the weather like where you live?

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Vous êtes d'où ?

Vous	êtes	d'où
you	are	from where

voo zet DOO ?

Where are you from?

With a friend: Tu es d'où ?

CULTURE NOTE

France uses degrees Celsius: Il fait vingt-cinq degrés means it's 25 °C, a warm day (about 77 °F).

CULTURE NOTE

Good small-talk topics: the weather, food, holidays, sport and where people are from. Salary, money and religion are usually seen as private, so avoid them with people you have just met.

TIP

Add non ? at the end of a sentence to mean 'isn't it?': Il fait froid, non ?

Role-play: your turn

1 **Open with the weather**

Il fait beau aujourd'hui, non ?

eel feh BOH oh-zhoor-DWEE, NOHN ?

Nice weather today, isn't it?

2 **Ask where they're from**

Vous êtes d'où ?

voo zet DOO ?

Where are you from?

3 **Talk about yourself**

Je viens d'Angleterre.

zhuh vyan dahn-gluh-TAIR.

I'm from England.

4 **Ask about their visit**

Vous êtes ici en vacances ?

voo zet ee-SEE ahn va-KAHNS ?

Are you here on holiday?

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5 **Close politely**

Bonne journée !

bun zhoor-NAY !

Have a nice day!

Read aloud. Then describe today's weather where you are.

Quel temps fait-il aujourd'hui ?

Il fait beau et il y a du soleil.

Hier, il a plu toute la journée.

Il fait froid, non ?

Vous êtes d'où ?

Je viens des États-Unis.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

55. Listen. What's the weather like? (listen in the web app: Il pleut.)

- A) It's snowing.
- B) It's windy.
- C) It's raining.
- D) It's sunny.

56. How do you say 'It's cold'?

- A) Il fait froid.
- B) Il est froid.
- C) Il a froid.
- D) Il fait chaud dehors.

57. Complete: Il y a du ___. (It's windy.)

- A) froid
- B) pleut
- C) beau
- D) vent

58. Listen. What is the question? (listen in the web app: Vous êtes d'où ?)

- A) Where are you going?
- B) How are you today?
- C) Where are you from?
- D) Who are you with?

59. Il fait vingt-cinq degrés is...

- A) a freezing day
- B) a snowy day
- C) a stormy night
- D) a warm day

60. Which topic is best avoided with someone you've just met?

- A) The weather today
- B) Holidays
- C) Their salary
- D) Food

61. What does Il fait beau, non ? mean?

- A) It's nice weather, isn't it?
- B) It's not nice weather.
- C) Is it nice weather tomorrow?
- D) It's nice, no thanks.

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UNIT 5

Answer key

1. D) A small espresso
Un café is an espresso. For milk, ask for un café crème.

2. C) The bill
L'addition = the bill.

3. A) Je voudrais un thé.
Thé is masculine: un thé.

4. C) Excusez-moi !
Excusez-moi or S'il vous plaît is polite. Allô is only for the phone.

5. D) €6.50
six euros cinquante = €6.50.

6. C) Yes, by law
Service compris: a tip is a kind extra, not required.

7. D) The starter
In France, l'entrée is the first course.

8. B) la carte
La carte is the full menu; le menu is a set meal.

9. A) Tap water
Une carafe d'eau is a jug of free tap water.

10. B) à point
saignant = rare, à point = medium, bien cuit = well done.

11. D) When you ask for it
Ask: L'addition, s'il vous plaît.

12. C) It was delicious!

13. B) Je regarde, merci.
Je regarde = I'm (just) looking.

14. C) How much is it?

15. B) The change
Voici votre monnaie = Here's your change.

16. A) Say Bonjour
A greeting is expected in every shop.

17. B) €6.20

18. A) Can I try it on?

19. C) Turn right

20. D) tout droit
tout droit (silent T) = straight on; à droite = right.

21. A) opposite the post office
en face de = opposite; à côté de = next to.

22. A) Ten minutes on foot

23. B) Is there a bank near here?

24. A) traffic lights
Aux feux, tournez à gauche = At the lights, turn left.

25. D) un aller-retour
aller = going, retour = return.

26. D) The train is late.

27. C) à pied
à pied and à vélo use à.

28. B) 4 pm
seize heures = 16:00 = 4 pm.

29. A) a change of line

30. B) the train coach
On trains, coaches are called voitures: voiture 12, place 45.

31. A) the ground floor
rez-de-chaussée = ground floor; premier étage = one floor up.

32. D) Breakfast is included.

33. D) La douche ne marche pas.
La douche is feminine and singular: ne marche pas.

34. A) the lift

35. B) 214

36. C) two nights

37. C) I have a headache.

38. D) au
à + le = au: J'ai mal au ventre.

39. C) a prescription

40. A) 15
15 = SAMU, 17 = police, 18 = fire brigade, 112 = EU emergency number.

41. C) For two days

42. B) la pharmacie de garde
The pharmacie de garde is open when others are closed.

43. C) wait on the line
Ne quittez pas = Don't hang up / Hold the line.

44. B) Who's calling?

45. A) annuler

46. D) Thursday at 9:30

47. A) In pairs: zéro six, quarante-cinq…

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48. B) I'll call you back later.

49. D) Avec plaisir !

50. A) Where shall we meet?

51. D) we
On y va ? = Shall we go?

52. B) Désolé, je ne peux pas.

53. A) just friendly

54. B) Deal! / OK!
Ça marche ! = That works for me!

55. C) It's raining.

56. A) Il fait froid.
Weather uses il fait. (Il a froid means a person feels cold.)

57. D) vent

58. C) Where are you from?

59. D) a warm day

60. C) Their salary

61. A) It's nice weather, isn't it?

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Lu

UNIT 6

Reading & Culture

Stories, songs, proverbs and life in the French-speaking world

1. Story 1: Léo's Morning
2. Story 2: Saturday at the Market
3. Story 3: A Weekend in Brussels
4. Songs & Rhymes
5. Expressions & Proverbs
6. Culture: La Bise, Tu & Vous
7. Culture: Meals & the French-Speaking World
8. Final Review Lab

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A1

UNIT 6 · LESSON 1 · 12 MINUTES

Story 1: Léo's Morning

A short story in the present tense

- Read a short story in French
- Understand everyday verbs in the present
- Answer questions about a text

Your first French story! Read each sentence, tap the words you don't know, then read it again. Everything is in the present tense.

Words to know

French	Say it	Meaning
habiter	a-bee-TAY	to live (somewhere)
le matin	luh ma-TAN	the morning
se lever	suh luh-VAY	to get up
boire	BWAR	to drink
une tartine	ewn tar-TEEN	a slice of bread with butter or jam
prendre le bus	prahndr luh BEWS	to take the bus
écouter	ay-koo-TAY	to listen (to)
en retard	ahn ruh-TAR	late
le cours	luh KOOR	the class / lesson
sourire	soo-REER	to smile

Le matin de Léo

Read the story one sentence at a time.

Léo a vingt ans.

Léo	a	vingt	ans
Léo	has	twenty	years

lay-OH a van TAHN.

Léo is twenty.

In French you 'have' an age: avoir ... ans.

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Il habite à Lyon avec son chat, Pixel.

Il	habite	à	Lyon	avec	son	chat	Pixel
he	lives	in	Lyon	with	his	cat	Pixel

eel a-BEET ah lee-OHN ah-vek sohn SHA, peek-SEL.

He lives in Lyon with his cat, Pixel.

Le matin, il se lève à sept heures.

Le	matin	il	se	lève	à	sept	heures
the	morning	he	himself	gets up	at	seven	hours / o'clock

luh ma-TAN, eel suh LEV ah seh TUHR.

In the morning, he gets up at seven.

Il boit un café et il mange une tartine.

Il	boit	un	café	et	il	mange	une	tartine
he	drinks	a	coffee	and	he	eats	a	slice of bread

eel bwah uhn ka-FAY ay eel mahnzh ewn tar-TEEN.

He drinks a coffee and eats a slice of bread.

Puis il prend le bus pour aller à l'université.

Puis	il	prend	le	bus	pour	aller	à	l'université
then	he	takes	the	bus	in order to	go	to	the university

pwee eel prahn luh BEWS poor a-LAY ah lew-nee-vair-see-TAY.

Then he takes the bus to go to university.

Dans le bus, il écoute de la musique.

Dans	le	bus	il	écoute	de	la	musique
in	the	bus	he	listens to	some	(the)	music

dahn luh BEWS, eel ay-KOOT duh la mew-ZEEK.

On the bus, he listens to music.

Mais aujourd'hui, le bus est en retard.

Mais	aujourd'hui	le	bus	est	en	retard
but	today	the	bus	is	in	delay

meh oh-zhoor-DWEE, luh BEWS eh tahn ruh-TAR.

But today, the bus is late.

en retard = late (literally 'in delay').

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Léo arrive en cours à neuf heures dix.

Léo	arrive	en	cours	à	neuf	heures	dix
Léo	arrives	in	class	at	nine	hours	ten

lay-OH a-REEV ahn KOOR ah nuh-vuhr DEESS.

Léo gets to class at ten past nine.

Le professeur sourit. Léo aussi !

Le	professeur	sourit	Léo	aussi
the	teacher	smiles	Léo	too

luh pro-feh-SUHR soo-REE. lay-OH oh-SEE !

The teacher smiles. So does Léo!

CULTURE NOTE

A tartine is a slice of baguette with butter and jam, a classic French breakfast. For many families, croissants are more of a weekend treat.

Listen and write

A teacher or friend reads each item aloud, or press "Listen" in the web app. Write what you hear; answers are at the end of the unit.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

Did you understand?

QUIZ

1. How old is Léo?
   - ○ A) 12
   - ○ B) 2
   - ○ C) 22
   - ○ D) 20

2. Where does Léo live?
   - ○ A) In Paris
   - ○ B) In Lille
   - ○ C) In Lyon
   - ○ D) In Toulouse

3. Who is Pixel?
   - ○ A) His cat
   - ○ B) His brother
   - ○ C) His bus driver
   - ○ D) His teacher

4. Listen. What does Léo have for breakfast? (listen in the web app: Il boit un café et il mange une tartine.)
   - ○ A) Tea and a croissant
   - ○ B) Juice and cereal
   - ○ C) Coffee and bread
   - ○ D) Nothing at all

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5. Why is Léo late today?

- ○ A) He gets up late
- ○ B) He forgets his bag
- ○ C) His cat is ill
- ○ D) The bus is late

6. Il se lève à sept heures. means…

- ○ A) He goes to bed at seven.
- ○ B) He leaves at seven.
- ○ C) He gets up at seven.
- ○ D) He eats at seven.

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A1+

UNIT 6 · LESSON 2 · 12 MINUTES

Story 2: Saturday at the Market

Chloé and her grandmother go shopping

- Read a longer story
- Notice du, de la and des (some)
- Answer questions about a text

In this story, Chloé and her grandmother go to the market. Look out for du, de la and des: they mean 'some'.

Words to know

French	Say it	Meaning
la grand-mère	la grahn-MAIR	the grandmother
la place	la PLASS	the town square
l'église	lay-GLEEZ	the church
beaucoup de monde	boh-koo duh MOHND	lots of people
ça sent bon	sa sahn BOHN	it smells good
acheter	ash-TAY	to buy
le fromage	luh fro-MAZH	the cheese
cher / chère	SHAIR	expensive
goûter	goo-TAY	to taste
ensemble	ahn-SAHMBL	together

Samedi au marché

Read the story one sentence at a time.

Le samedi, Chloé va au marché avec sa grand-mère.

Le	samedi	Chloé	va	au	marché	avec	sa	grand-mère
the	Saturday	Chloé	goes	to the	market	with	her	grandmother

luh sam-DEE, klo-AY va oh mar-SHAY ah-vek sa grahn-MAIR.

On Saturdays, Chloé goes to the market with her grandmother.

Le samedi (with le) means 'every Saturday'.

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Le marché est sur la place, près de l'église.

Le	marché	est	sur	la	place	près	de	l'église
the	market	is	on	the	square	near	of	the church

luh mar-SHAY eh sewr la PLASS, preh duh lay-GLEEZ.

The market is on the square, near the church.

Il y a beaucoup de monde et ça sent bon.

Il	y	a	beaucoup	de	monde	et	ça	sent	bon
it	there	has	a lot	of	people (world)	and	it	smells	good

eel ya boh-koo duh MOHND ay sa sahn BOHN.

There are lots of people and it smells good.

La grand-mère achète des pommes, des carottes et du fromage.

La	grand-mère	achète	des	pommes	des	carottes	et	du	fromage
the	grandmother	buys	some	apples	some	carrots	and	some	cheese

la grahn-MAIR a-SHET day POM, day ka-ROT ay dew fro-MAZH.

Grandma buys apples, carrots and cheese.

Chloé veut des fraises, mais elles sont chères.

Chloé	veut	des	fraises	mais	elles	sont	chères
Chloé	wants	some	strawberries	but	they	are	expensive

klo-AY vuh day FREZ, meh el sohn SHAIR.

Chloé wants strawberries, but they are expensive.

Le vendeur sourit et donne une fraise à Chloé.

Le	vendeur	sourit	et	donne	une	fraise	à	Chloé
the	seller	smiles	and	gives	a	strawberry	to	Chloé

luh vahn-DUHR soo-REE ay dun ewn FREZ ah klo-AY.

The seller smiles and gives Chloé a strawberry.

Chloé goûte la fraise. Elle est délicieuse !

Chloé	goûte	la	fraise	Elle	est	délicieuse
Chloé	tastes	the	strawberry	it (she)	is	delicious

klo-AY GOOT la FREZ. el eh day-lee-SYUHZ !

Chloé tastes the strawberry. It's delicious!

La fraise is feminine, so 'it' is elle and the adjective is délicieuse.

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Alors la grand-mère achète une barquette de fraises.

Alors	la	grand-mère	achète	une	barquette	de	fraises
so	the	grandmother	buys	a	punnet	of	strawberries

a-LOR la grahn-MAIR a-SHET ewn bar-KET duh FREZ.

So Grandma buys a punnet of strawberries.

À midi, elles mangent ensemble. Et en dessert, des fraises, bien sûr !

À	midi	elles	mangent	ensemble	Et	en	dessert	des	fraises	bien	sûr
at	noon	they	eat	together	and	for	dessert	some	strawberries	well	sure

ah mee-DEE, el MAHNZH ahn-SAHMBL. ay ahn deh-SAIR, day FREZ, byan SEWR !

At noon, they eat together. And for dessert: strawberries, of course!

bien sûr = of course.

du, de la, des = some

Use these for an amount that isn't counted exactly. In English we often say 'some', or nothing at all.

How to say it: du + masculine · de la + feminine · de l' + vowel · des + plural

du fromage	de la confiture	de l'eau	des pommes
dew fro-MAZH	duh la kohn-fee-TEWR	duh LOH	day POM

CULTURE NOTE

Almost every French town has an open-air market on one or more mornings a week. Many people have a favourite stall and chat with the sellers they know.

Did you understand?

QUIZ

7. Who does Chloé go to the market with?
   - ○ A) Her mother
   - ○ B) Her best friend
   - ○ C) Her grandfather
   - ○ D) Her grandmother

8. Where is the market?
   - ○ A) In the church
   - ○ B) On the square
   - ○ C) At the station
   - ○ D) Next to the school

9. Why doesn't Chloé buy strawberries at first?
   - ○ A) They are expensive
   - ○ B) She doesn't like them
   - ○ C) They are not ripe
   - ○ D) The stall is closed

10. Listen. What does Chloé say about the strawberry? (listen in the web app: Elle est délicieuse !)
    - ○ A) It's expensive!
    - ○ B) It's delicious!
    - ○ C) It's very small!
    - ○ D) It's not ripe!

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11. Complete: La grand-mère achète ___ fromage.

- ○ A) de la
- ○ B) des
- ○ C) un des
- ○ D) du

12. What do they eat for dessert?

- ○ A) Cheese
- ○ B) Apple tart
- ○ C) Strawberries
- ○ D) Chocolate cake

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A2

UNIT 6 · LESSON 3 · 15 MINUTES

Story 3: A Weekend in Brussels

A trip told in the past tense

- Read a story in the past tense (passé composé)
- Spot verbs with avoir and être
- Learn a little about Belgium

This story is about the past, so it uses the passé composé: j'ai mangé (I ate), nous sommes entrées (we went in). Nadia tells you about her trip to Belgium.

Words to know

French	Say it	Meaning
le week-end dernier	luh wee-kend dair-NYAY	last weekend
je suis allée	zhuh swee za-LAY	I went (a woman speaking)
nous avons pris	noo za-vohn PREE	we took
le voyage	luh vwah-YAZH	the journey
durer	dew-RAY	to last
visiter	vee-zee-TAY	to visit (a place)
ancien / ancienne	ahn-SYAN / ahn-SYEN	old
les moules-frites	lay mool-FREET	mussels and fries
une gaufre	ewn GOHFR	a waffle
adorer	a-do-RAY	to love

Un week-end à Bruxelles

Read the story one sentence at a time.

Le week-end dernier, je suis allée à Bruxelles avec mon amie Julie.

Le	week-end	dernier	je	suis	allée	à	Bruxelles	avec	mon	amie	Julie
the	weekend	last	I	am	gone	to	Brussels	with	my	friend	Julie

luh wee-kend dair-NYAY, zhuh swee za-LAY ah brew-SEL ah-vek moh na-MEE zhew-LEE.

Last weekend, I went to Brussels with my friend Julie.

Verbs of movement like aller use être. Nadia is a woman, so she writes allée.

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Nous avons pris le train à Paris.

Nous	avons	pris	le	train	à	Paris
we	have	taken	the	train	in	Paris

noo za-vohn PREE luh TRAN ah pa-REE.

We took the train in Paris.

Le voyage a duré une heure et demie.

Le	voyage	a	duré	une	heure	et	demie
the	journey	has	lasted	one	hour	and	half

luh vwah-YAZH a dew-RAY ew-NUHR ay duh-MEE.

The journey took an hour and a half.

Le samedi matin, nous avons visité la Grand-Place.

Le	samedi	matin	nous	avons	visité	la	Grand-Place
the	Saturday	morning	we	have	visited	the	Grand-Place (main square)

luh sam-dee ma-TAN, noo za-vohn vee-zee-TAY la grahn-PLASS.

On Saturday morning, we visited the Grand-Place.

C'est une très belle place, entourée de maisons anciennes.

C'est	une	très	belle	place	entourée	de	maisons	anciennes
it is	a	very	beautiful	square	surrounded	by	houses	old

seh tewn tray BEL PLASS, ahn-too-RAY duh meh-zohn ahn-SYEN.

It's a very beautiful square, surrounded by old houses.

À midi, nous avons mangé des moules-frites.

À	midi	nous	avons	mangé	des	moules-frites
at	noon	we	have	eaten	some	mussels and fries

ah mee-DEE, noo za-vohn mahn-ZHAY day mool-FREET.

At noon, we ate mussels and fries.

L'après-midi, il a plu, alors nous sommes entrées dans un musée.

L'après-midi	il	a	plu	alors	nous	sommes	entrées	dans	un	musée
the afternoon	it	has	rained	so	we	are	entered	in	a	museum

la-preh-mee-DEE, eel a PLEW, a-LOR noo som zahn-TRAY dahn zuhn mew-ZAY.

In the afternoon it rained, so we went into a museum.

Two women, so entrées ends in -es.

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Le soir, nous avons goûté une gaufre au chocolat.

Le	soir	nous	avons	goûté	une	gaufre	au	chocolat
the	evening	we	have	tasted	a	waffle	with the	chocolate

luh SWAR, noo za-vohn goo-TAY ewn GOHFR oh sho-ko-LA.

In the evening, we tried a chocolate waffle.

Dimanche, j'ai acheté du chocolat belge pour ma famille.

Dimanche	j'ai	acheté	du	chocolat	belge	pour	ma	famille
Sunday	I have	bought	some	chocolate	Belgian	for	my	family

dee-MAHNSH, zhay ash-TAY dew sho-ko-LA BELZH poor ma fa-MEE-y.

On Sunday, I bought Belgian chocolate for my family.

J'ai adoré ce week-end, et je veux y retourner bientôt !

J'ai	adoré	ce	week-end	et	je	veux	y	retourner	bientôt
I have	loved	this	weekend	and	I	want	there	to go back	soon

zhay a-do-RAY suh wee-KEND, ay zhuh vuh zee ruh-toor-NAY byan-TOH !

I loved this weekend, and I want to go back soon!

The passé composé in the story

French	Meaning	Helper verb
nous avons pris	we took	avoir
il a plu	it rained	avoir
j'ai acheté	I bought	avoir
je suis allée	I went	être
nous sommes entrées	we went in	être

CULTURE NOTE

French is one of Belgium's three official languages, with Dutch and German. Brussels is officially bilingual (French and Dutch). Belgians say septante for 70 and nonante for 90.

Did you understand?

QUIZ

13. Who did Nadia travel with?

- ○ A) Her sister
- ○ B) Julie
- ○ C) Her parents
- ○ D) Nobody: she went alone

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14. How did they travel to Brussels?

- ○ A) By plane
- ○ B) By car
- ○ C) By train
- ○ D) By bus

15. What did they do when it rained?

- ○ A) They went back to the hotel
- ○ B) They went into a museum
- ○ C) They bought umbrellas
- ○ D) They took the train home

16. Listen. What did they eat at lunchtime? (listen in the web app: À midi, nous avons mangé des moules-frites.)

- ○ A) Mussels and fries
- ○ B) A chocolate waffle
- ○ C) Fish and salad
- ○ D) Cheese and bread

17. Why is it je suis allée with an extra e?

- ○ A) Because it's plural
- ○ B) Because Nadia is a woman
- ○ C) Because it's a question
- ○ D) Because Brussels is feminine

18. In Belgium, nonante means…

- ○ A) 90
- ○ B) 70
- ○ C) 80
- ○ D) 19

19. What does Nadia want to do?

- ○ A) Never travel again
- ○ B) Move to Paris next year
- ○ C) Go back soon
- ○ D) Learn Dutch first

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UNIT 6 · LESSON 4 · 12 MINUTES

Songs & Rhymes

Traditional French songs to sing along with

- Sing three traditional French songs
- Understand what the words mean
- Practise rhythm and rhyme

Songs are a great way to remember French sounds. These traditional songs are centuries old, and French children still sing them today. Read the meaning, then sing along!

Frère Jacques

Frère Jacques, frère Jacques,	Dormez-vous ? Dormez-vous ?	Sonnez les matines, sonnez les matines,	Ding, dang, dong. Ding, dang, dong.
frair ZHAHK, frair ZHAHK	dor-may-VOO ? dor-may-VOO ?	so-nay lay ma-TEEN, so-nay lay ma-TEEN	deeng, dahng, dohng
Brother Jacques, Brother Jacques,	Are you sleeping? Are you sleeping?	Ring the morning bells, ring the morning bells,	Ding, dang, dong.

CULTURE NOTE

Les matines are very early morning prayers in a monastery. Brother Jacques is a monk who has overslept and should be ringing the bell! The English version, 'Are you sleeping, Brother John?', tells the story a little differently.

Dormez-vous ? is a question made by swapping the verb and the subject: Vous dormez (you sleep) becomes Dormez-vous ? (do you sleep?).

Sonnez les matines !

Sonnez	les	matines
ring	the	morning prayers

so-nay lay ma-TEEN !

Ring the morning bells!

Au clair de la lune (first verse)

Au clair de la lune,	Mon ami Pierrot,	Prête-moi ta plume	Pour écrire un mot.
oh klair duh la LEWN	moh na-mee pyeh-ROH	pret-mwah ta PLEWM	poor ay-kree ruhn MOH
By the light of the moon,	My friend Pierrot,	Lend me your quill (pen)	To write a word.

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Ma chandelle est morte,	Je n'ai plus de feu.	Ouvre-moi ta porte	Pour l'amour de Dieu.
ma shahn-del eh MORT	zhuh nay plew duh FUH	oo-vruh-mwah ta PORT	poor la-moor duh DYUH
My candle has gone out,	I have no more fire.	Open your door to me	For the love of God.

CULTURE NOTE

Pierrot is a classic sad clown from old French theatre. In the 1700s people wrote with a feather quill (une plume) by candlelight.

Prête-moi ta plume.

Prête-moi	ta	plume
lend me	your	quill / pen

pret-mwah ta PLEWM.

Lend me your pen.

Prête-moi is a friendly command with tu. Today you might say Prête-moi ton stylo (lend me your pen).

Un, deux, trois, nous irons au bois

Un, deux, trois, nous irons au bois,	Quatre, cinq, six, cueillir des cerises,	Sept, huit, neuf, dans mon panier neuf,	Dix, onze, douze, elles seront toutes rouges.
uhn, duh, TRWAH, noo zee-rohn oh BWAH	katr, sank, SEESS, kuh-yeer day suh-REEZ	set, weet, NUHF, dahn mohn pa-nyay NUHF	deess, ohnz, DOOZ, el suh-rohn toot ROOZH
One, two, three, we'll go to the woods,	Four, five, six, to pick cherries,	Seven, eight, nine, in my new basket,	Ten, eleven, twelve, they will all be red.

MEMORY TRICK

Listen for the rhymes: trois / bois, six / cerises, neuf / neuf, douze / rouges. Neuf means both 'nine' and 'new', and the song plays with that!

Sing or read the songs aloud. Tap any word to hear it.

Frère Jacques, frère Jacques, dormez-vous ?
Sonnez les matines, ding, dang, dong.
Au clair de la lune, mon ami Pierrot,
Prête-moi ta plume pour écrire un mot.
Un, deux, trois, nous irons au bois,
Quatre, cinq, six, cueillir des cerises.

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Quick quiz

QUIZ

20. In 'Frère Jacques', what does Dormez-vous ? mean?

- ○ A) Are you dreaming?
- ○ B) Are you coming?
- ○ C) Where are you going?
- ○ D) Are you sleeping?

21. What does the singer of 'Au clair de la lune' want to borrow?

- ○ A) A pen
- ○ B) A candle
- ○ C) A door key
- ○ D) Some bread

22. Why does he need help?

- ○ A) His candle has gone out
- ○ B) He is hungry and tired
- ○ C) He has lost his way home
- ○ D) His door is broken

23. Listen. What will they pick? (listen in the web app: Quatre, cinq, six, cueillir des cerises.)

- ○ A) Apples
- ○ B) Cherries
- ○ C) Strawberries
- ○ D) Flowers

24. Neuf can mean...

- ○ A) nine or new
- ○ B) nine or nineteen
- ○ C) new or now
- ○ D) nine only

25. Les matines are...

- ○ A) morning newspapers
- ○ B) church towers
- ○ C) breakfast foods
- ○ D) morning prayers

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UNIT 6 · LESSON 5 · 12 MINUTES

Expressions & Proverbs

Sound natural with everyday phrases, idioms and proverbs

- Use everyday expressions at the right moment
- Understand colourful French idioms
- Learn well-known proverbs

Every language has little phrases that make you sound natural. Here are everyday expressions, colourful idioms and some famous proverbs.

Everyday expressions

French	Say it	Meaning
Bon courage !	bohn koo-RAZH !	Good luck! / Hang in there!
Bon appétit !	bo na-pay-TEE !	Enjoy your meal!
Santé !	sahn-TAY !	Cheers! (lit. health)
À tes souhaits !	ah tay SWEH !	Bless you! (after a sneeze)
Pas de souci.	pahd soo-SEE.	No worries.
Tant pis !	tahn PEE !	Oh well! / Too bad!
Tant mieux !	tahn MYUH !	Good! / So much the better!
Ce n'est pas grave.	suh neh pa GRAV.	It doesn't matter. / No big deal.
Oh là là !	oh la LA !	Oh dear! / Wow!
Bof.	BOF.	Meh. (not impressed)
J'ai la flemme.	zhay la FLEM.	I can't be bothered. (informal)

TIP

In everyday speech, people often drop the ne: C'est pas grave, Je sais pas. That's normal when speaking, but keep the ne when you write.

Colourful idioms

French	Word for word	Real meaning
Il pleut des cordes.	It's raining ropes.	It's pouring.
Ça coûte les yeux de la tête.	It costs the eyes of the head.	It costs an arm and a leg.

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French	Word for word	Real meaning
poser un lapin	to put down a rabbit	to stand someone up
avoir le cafard	to have the cockroach	to feel down
avoir un coup de foudre	to have a lightning strike	to fall in love at first sight
Ce n'est pas la mer à boire.	It's not the sea to drink.	It's not that hard.
quand les poules auront des dents	when hens have teeth	when pigs fly (never)

Il pleut des cordes.

Il	pleut	des	cordes
it	rains	some	ropes

eel pluh day KORD.

It's pouring (lit. it's raining ropes).

Proverbs

Petit à petit, l'oiseau fait son nid.
puh-TEE ta puh-TEE, lwah-ZOH feh sohn NEE.
Little by little, the bird builds its nest.
Big goals are reached in small steps, like learning French!

Mieux vaut tard que jamais.
myuh voh TAR kuh zha-MEH.
Better late than never.

Après la pluie, le beau temps.
a-preh la PLWEE, luh boh TAHN.
After the rain, good weather.
Good times follow bad times.

L'habit ne fait pas le moine.
la-BEE nuh feh pa luh MWAN.
The robe doesn't make the monk.
Don't judge by appearances.

Qui se ressemble s'assemble.
kee suh ruh-SAHMBL sa-SAHMBL.
Those who are alike come together.
Birds of a feather flock together.

Vouloir, c'est pouvoir.
voo-LWAR, say poo-VWAR.
To want is to be able.
Where there's a will, there's a way.

Petit à petit, l'oiseau fait son nid.

Petit	à	petit	l'oiseau	fait	son	nid
little	by	little	the bird	makes	its	nest

puh-TEE ta puh-TEE, lwah-ZOH feh sohn NEE.

Little by little, the bird builds its nest.

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CULTURE NOTE

Before eating, French people say Bon appétit ! When drinking together, they say Santé ! and look each other in the eye as they clink glasses.

Read aloud. Which proverb is your favourite?

Bon courage pour ton examen !

Tant pis, ce n'est pas grave.

Il pleut des cordes aujourd'hui !

Ce n'est pas la mer à boire.

Petit à petit, l'oiseau fait son nid.

Mieux vaut tard que jamais.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

26. Someone sneezes. You say…

- ○ A) Bon appétit à tous !
- ○ B) Santé !
- ○ C) Tant mieux !
- ○ D) À tes souhaits !

27. Your friend has an exam tomorrow. You say…

- ○ A) Bon appétit !
- ○ B) Tant pis !
- ○ C) Bon courage !
- ○ D) Oh là là, bof !

28. Listen. What's the weather like? (listen in the web app: Il pleut des cordes.)

- ○ A) It's a little cloudy.
- ○ B) It's pouring.
- ○ C) Someone needs a rope.
- ○ D) It's snowing hard.

29. Il m'a posé un lapin means…

- ○ A) He stood me up.
- ○ B) He gave me a rabbit.
- ○ C) He cooked me dinner.
- ○ D) He told me a joke.

30. Which proverb means 'Better late than never'?

- ○ A) Petit à petit, l'oiseau fait son nid.
- ○ B) Mieux vaut tard que jamais.
- ○ C) Vouloir, c'est pouvoir.
- ○ D) Après la pluie, le beau temps.

31. Ça coûte les yeux de la tête describes something…

- ○ A) very expensive
- ○ B) very beautiful
- ○ C) bad for your eyes
- ○ D) very easy to find

32. When you clink glasses, you say…

- ○ A) Bon courage !
- ○ B) À tes souhaits !
- ○ C) Pas de souci !
- ○ D) Santé !

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Tu

UNIT 6 · LESSON 6 · 12 MINUTES

Culture: La Bise, Tu & Vous

Greetings, cheek kisses and polite forms

- Understand la bise and when to shake hands
- Choose between tu and vous
- Use everyday politeness words

Knowing a few social rules helps you feel at ease in France. Let's look at greetings, the famous bise, and when to say tu or vous.

La bise

La bise is a light touch of cheeks with a small kissing sound. Friends and family greet each other this way, and so do many colleagues who know each other well.

CULTURE NOTE

The number of kisses depends on the region. Two is the most common (for example in Paris), but some areas do one, three or even four! When in doubt, follow the other person's lead.

TIP

In business, or with people you don't know, a handshake (une poignée de main) is normal. Some people now prefer a simple wave or nod, and that's fine too.

Tu or vous?

Use tu with...	Use vous with...
friends and family	people you don't know
children	older people
people your age (especially young people)	shop staff, waiters, officials
pets!	your boss or teacher (usually)

Vous is also simply the plural 'you'. Use it whenever you talk to more than one person, even friends.

Same question, two styles

Tu veux un café ?
tew vuh uhn ka-FAY ?
Do you want a coffee? (friendly)

Vous voulez un café ?
voo voo-LAY uhn ka-FAY ?
Would you like a coffee? (polite)

Comment tu t'appelles ?
ko-mahn tew ta-PEL ?
What's your name? (friendly)

Comment vous appelez-vous ?
ko-mahn voo za-play-VOO ?
What's your name? (polite)

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On peut se tutoyer ?

On	peut	se	tutoyer
we	can	each other	say tu to

ohn puh suh tew-twah-YAY ?

Shall we say 'tu' to each other?

tutoyer = to say tu; vouvoyer = to say vous. Usually the older or more senior person suggests the switch.

Switching to tu

Mme Blanc Vous voulez encore du thé, Julien ?
voo voo-LAY ahn-kor dew TAY, zhew-LYAN ?
Would you like more tea, Julien?

Julien Oui, merci beaucoup, madame.
WEE, mair-SEE boh-KOO, ma-DAM.
Yes, thank you very much, madam.

Mme Blanc Appelez-moi Claire. Et on peut se tutoyer, non ?
a-play-MWAH KLAIR. ay ohn puh suh tew-twah-YAY, NOHN ?
Call me Claire. And we can say 'tu', can't we?

Julien Avec plaisir ! Alors… tu as un jardin magnifique, Claire.
ah-vek pleh-ZEER ! a-LOR… tew a uhn zhar-DAN ma-nyee-FEEK, KLAIR.
With pleasure! So… you have a wonderful garden, Claire.

Mme Blanc Merci ! Tu veux le voir ?
mair-SEE ! tew vuh luh VWAR ?
Thanks! Do you want to see it?

Julien Oui, je veux bien !
WEE, zhuh vuh BYAN !
Yes, I'd love to!

CULTURE NOTE

Politeness words matter a lot: Bonjour when you arrive, Merci, S'il vous plaît, and Au revoir when you leave, in shops, on the bus, even in a lift. Adding Monsieur or Madame makes it extra polite.

Read each pair aloud: first friendly, then polite.

Tu veux un café ?

Vous voulez un café ?

Comment tu t'appelles ?

Comment vous appelez-vous ?

Tu es d'où ?

Vous êtes d'où ?

Quick quiz

QUIZ

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33. You meet your new boss. You should probably use…

- ○ A) tu
- ○ B) either: it doesn't matter
- ○ C) toi
- ○ D) vous

34. You talk to two of your friends together. You use…

- ○ A) vous
- ○ B) tu
- ○ C) nous
- ○ D) on

35. What is la bise?

- ○ A) A firm two-handed handshake
- ○ B) A cheek-kiss greeting
- ○ C) A small bow
- ○ D) A kind of hug

36. How many kisses is most common in Paris?

- ○ A) One
- ○ B) Three
- ○ C) Two
- ○ D) Four

37. Listen. What is the person suggesting? (listen in the web app: On peut se tutoyer ?)

- ○ A) Meeting tomorrow
- ○ B) Speaking more slowly
- ○ C) Saying 'tu'
- ○ D) Having a drink

38. Which question uses the polite vous form?

- ○ A) Tu veux un café ?
- ○ B) Tu prends un café, toi ?
- ○ C) Un café, ça te dit ?
- ○ D) Vous voulez un café ?

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UNIT 6 · LESSON 7 · 14 MINUTES

Culture: Meals & the French-Speaking World

How the French eat, and where French is spoken

- Know French mealtimes and courses
- Learn table manners
- Discover French-speaking countries

Food and language bring people together. Discover how French meals work, then travel around the world of French speakers.

A day of French meals

Meal	When	What's typical
le petit-déjeuner	7:00–9:00	bread with butter and jam, coffee, tea or hot chocolate; croissants at the weekend
le déjeuner	12:00–14:00	often a hot meal; many schools and workplaces have a canteen
le goûter	about 16:30	an after-school snack for children: bread and chocolate, fruit or biscuits
le dîner	19:30–21:00	the evening meal, often with the family

CULTURE NOTE

A full meal can have several courses: entrée (starter), plat (main course), fromage (cheese) and dessert. Cheese comes before dessert!

CULTURE NOTE

At the table, bread is often placed straight on the tablecloth next to your plate. Keep your hands (wrists) on the table, not in your lap, and wait for Bon appétit ! before you start.

WATCH OUT

In Québec, Belgium and Switzerland, meal names are different: le déjeuner = breakfast, le dîner = lunch and le souper = dinner.

French around the world

About 320 million people speak French, on every continent. It is an official language in around 29 countries, and one of the two working languages of the United Nations Secretariat, with English.

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Where French is spoken

Country	Capital	Did you know?
France	Paris	About 68 million people live in France.
Belgium	Brussels	French, Dutch and German are all official languages.
Switzerland	Bern	French is one of four national languages.
Canada	Ottawa	Québec is the main French-speaking province.
Senegal	Dakar	French is the official language; Wolof is spoken by most people.
Côte d'Ivoire	Yamoussoukro	Its biggest city, Abidjan, is a major French-speaking hub.
DR Congo	Kinshasa	Kinshasa is one of the biggest French-speaking cities in the world.
Haiti	Port-au-Prince	French and Haitian Creole are both official.
Madagascar	Antananarivo	Malagasy and French are both official.

Words from around the French-speaking world

French	Say it	Meaning
magasiner	ma-ga-zee-NAY	to go shopping (Québec)
le char	luh SHAR	the car (Québec, informal)
la fin de semaine	la fan duh suh-MEN	the weekend (Québec)
le courriel	luh koo-RYEL	email (Québec, and the official word in France too)
septante	sep-TAHNT	seventy (Belgium, Switzerland)
nonante	no-NAHNT	ninety (Belgium, Switzerland)
huitante	wee-TAHNT	eighty (parts of Switzerland)

Le français est parlé sur cinq continents.

Le	français	est	parlé	sur	cinq	continents
the	French (language)	is	spoken	on	five	continents

luh frahn-SEH eh par-LAY sewr sank kohn-tee-NAHN.

French is spoken on five continents.

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Read aloud. Then say which French-speaking country you'd like to visit.

Le petit-déjeuner, le déjeuner, le goûter, le dîner.

Le fromage, puis le dessert.

Bon appétit !

Je voudrais visiter le Québec.

Septante, huitante, nonante.

Quick quiz

QUIZ

39. What is le goûter?

- A) A big Sunday lunch
- B) A late dinner
- C) An afternoon snack
- D) A breakfast drink

40. In a French meal, what is the usual order?

- A) Cheese, then dessert
- B) Dessert, then cheese
- C) Cheese with the starter
- D) Dessert with the main course

41. In Québec, le dîner is...

- A) dinner
- B) breakfast
- C) lunch
- D) a snack

42. About how many people speak French in the world?

- A) About 30 million
- B) About 320 million
- C) About 1.5 billion
- D) About 80 million

43. What is the capital of Senegal?

- A) Abidjan
- B) Kinshasa
- C) Dakar
- D) Bamako

44. Listen. In Belgium, this number is... (listen in the web app: septante)

- A) 17
- B) 70
- C) 60
- D) 700

45. Where do you keep your hands during a French meal?

- A) On the table
- B) In your lap
- C) Behind your back
- D) On your knees

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Fin

UNIT 6 · LESSON 8 · 18 MINUTES

Final Review Lab

Mix everything: talk, read, listen and remember

- Use everyday conversation phrases together
- Read, listen and write in French
- Check everything you have learned

Congratulations, you've reached the last lesson! This lab mixes everything: conversation, reading, listening and culture. Take your time and enjoy it.

Plans in town

Lucie Salut Ben ! Tu es libre cet après-midi ?
sa-LEW BEN ! tew eh LEEBR seh ta-preh-mee-DEE ?
Hi Ben! Are you free this afternoon?

Ben Oui ! On se retrouve où ?
WEE ! ohn suh ruh-troov OO ?
Yes! Where shall we meet?

Lucie Au café en face de la gare, à quinze heures ?
oh ka-FAY ahn FASS duh la GAR, ah kan ZUHR ?
At the café opposite the station, at 3 pm?

Ben Ça marche. Mais où est la gare ?
sa MARSH. meh oo eh la GAR ?
Deal. But where is the station?

Lucie C'est facile : tout droit, puis la première rue à gauche.
say fa-SEEL : too DRWAH, pwee la pruh-myair REW ah GOHSH.
It's easy: straight on, then the first street on the left.

Ben Parfait. Il fait beau, on prend une table en terrasse ?
par-FAY. eel feh BOH, ohn prahn ewn TABL ahn teh-RASS ?
Perfect. The weather's nice, shall we sit outside on the terrace?

Lucie Bonne idée ! À tout à l'heure !
bun ee-DAY ! ah too ta LUHR !
Good idea! See you later!

Build the sentence

Tap each word, then say the whole sentence.

Je voudrais un aller-retour pour Paris.

Je	voudrais	un	aller-retour	pour	Paris
I	would like	a	return ticket	for / to	Paris

zhuh voo-DRAY uhn na-lay ruh-TOOR poor pa-REE.

I'd like a return ticket to Paris.

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Il y a du vent aujourd'hui.

Il	y	a	du	vent	aujourd'hui
it	there	has	some	wind	today

eel ya dew VAHN oh-zhoor-DWEE.

It's windy today.

Nous avons mangé une gaufre au chocolat.

Nous	avons	mangé	une	gaufre	au	chocolat
we	have	eaten	a	waffle	with the	chocolate

noo za-vohn mahn-ZHAY ewn GOHFR oh sho-ko-LA.

We ate a chocolate waffle.

J'ai mal au ventre depuis hier.

J'ai	mal	au	ventre	depuis	hier
I have	pain	at the	stomach	since	yesterday

zhay mal oh VAHNTR duh-pwee YAIR.

I've had a stomach ache since yesterday.

French uses the present tense with **depuis**: 'I have pain since yesterday'.

Listen and write

A teacher or friend reads each item aloud, or press "Listen" in the web app. Write what you hear; answers are at the end of the unit.

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

8. _____

Final quiz

QUIZ

46. Listen. Where are you most likely to hear this? (listen in the web app: *Je voudrais un thé, s'il vous plaît.*)

- ○ A) At the doctor's
- ○ B) At the train station
- ○ C) On the phone to a friend
- ○ D) In a café

47. You arrive at a hotel. You say…

- ○ A) J'ai une réservation.
- ○ B) J'ai une ordonnance du médecin.
- ○ C) J'ai mal à la tête.
- ○ D) Je regarde, merci.

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48. Which one means 'straight on'?

- ○ A) à droite
- ○ B) tout droit
- ○ C) à gauche
- ○ D) au carrefour

49. Which is correct for 'I have a sore throat'?

- ○ A) Je suis mal à la gorge.
- ○ B) J'ai mal au gorge.
- ○ C) J'ai la gorge malade aujourd'hui.
- ○ D) J'ai mal à la gorge.

50. Bof shows that you are...

- ○ A) not impressed
- ○ B) very excited about it
- ○ C) hungry
- ○ D) late

51. Listen. Which track? (listen in the web app: Le train part de la voie trois.)

- ○ A) Track 13
- ○ B) Track 2
- ○ C) Platform 30
- ○ D) Track 3

52. In Story 3, where did Nadia go?

- ○ A) Lyon
- ○ B) Brussels
- ○ C) Geneva
- ○ D) Montréal

53. In France, which comes after the main course?

- ○ A) Cheese
- ○ B) The starter
- ○ C) The aperitif
- ○ D) The soup

Can you...?

Check yourself

- ☐ Order food and drink and ask for the bill
- ☐ Ask for directions and understand the answer
- ☐ Buy a train ticket and find your track
- ☐ Check in at a hotel and report a problem
- ☐ Say what hurts at the doctor's
- ☐ Make an appointment on the phone
- ☐ Invite a friend and accept or refuse
- ☐ Chat about the weather
- ☐ Read a short story in French
- ☐ Choose between tu and vous

Give your work today some stars ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

DID YOU KNOW?

Félicitations ! Keep going: listen to French songs, watch films with subtitles, and talk with French speakers whenever you can. Petit à petit, l'oiseau fait son nid.

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Your final reading: say each line with confidence!

Bonjour ! Je voudrais un café, s'il vous plaît.

Excusez-moi, où est la gare ?

Un aller-retour pour Lyon, s'il vous plaît.

Il fait beau aujourd'hui, non ?

Tu es libre ce soir ? On va au cinéma ?

Merci pour tout, et à bientôt !

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UNIT 6

Answer key

Dictation

1. Léo a vingt ans. (lay-OH a van TAHN.)
2. Il prend le bus. (eel prahn luh BEWS.)
3. Le bus est en retard. (luh BEWS eh tahn ruh-TAR.)
4. Où est la pharmacie ? (oo eh la far-ma-SEE ?)
5. L'addition, s'il vous plaît. (la-dee-SYOHN, seel voo PLAY.)
6. Il fait froid ce matin. (eel feh FRWAH suh ma-TAN.)
7. Tu es libre samedi ? (tew eh leebr sam-DEE ?)
8. Petit à petit, l'oiseau fait son nid. (puh-TEE ta puh-TEE, lwah-ZOH feh sohn NEE.)

Quiz

1. D) 20
2. C) In Lyon
3. A) His cat
4. C) Coffee and bread
5. D) The bus is late
6. C) He gets up at seven.
7. D) Her grandmother
8. B) On the square
9. A) They are expensive
10. B) It's delicious!
11. D) du
fromage is masculine: du fromage.
12. C) Strawberries
13. B) Julie
14. C) By train
15. B) They went into a museum
16. A) Mussels and fries
17. B) Because Nadia is a woman
18. A) 90
19. C) Go back soon
20. D) Are you sleeping?
21. A) A pen
Prête-moi ta plume = Lend me your quill (pen).
22. A) His candle has gone out
23. B) Cherries
des cerises = cherries.
24. A) nine or new
25. D) morning prayers
26. D) À tes souhaits !
27. C) Bon courage !
28. B) It's pouring.
29. A) He stood me up.
30. B) Mieux vaut tard que jamais.
31. A) very expensive
32. D) Santé !
33. D) vous
34. A) vous
Vous is always used for more than one person.
35. B) A cheek-kiss greeting
36. C) Two
37. C) Saying 'tu'
38. D) Vous voulez un café ?
39. C) An afternoon snack
40. A) Cheese, then dessert
41. C) lunch
42. B) About 320 million
43. C) Dakar
44. B) 70
45. A) On the table
46. D) In a café
47. A) J'ai une réservation.
48. B) tout droit
49. D) J'ai mal à la gorge.
50. A) not impressed
51. D) Track 3

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52. B) Brussels

53. A) Cheese

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WORD SEARCH 1

Hello, Goodbye & Please

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

N	L	S	R	L	D	I	T	I	I
I	L	P	A	R	D	O	N	T	E
R	D	R	B	S	S	S	L	O	N
D	D	B	O	N	J	O	U	R	S
L	N	N	U	E	R	C	U	G	D
N	O	N	U	E	L	S	T	N	T
B	T	S	R	M	G	E	N	L	E
H	M	E	R	C	I	O	U	I	F
H	U	R	B	O	N	S	O	I	R
O	B	T	A	S	A	L	U	T	U

1. **Bonjour** — Hello / Good morning (daytime)
2. **Bonsoir** — Good evening
3. **Salut** — Hi / Bye (with friends)
4. **Merci** — Thank you
5. **Pardon** — Sorry / Excuse me (if you bump into someone)
6. **Oui** — Yes
7. **Non** — No

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WORD SEARCH 2

Numbers 0–20

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

N	E	S	U	F	U	S	I	T	S
I	L	E	N	S	E	E	C	N	E
L	E	S	S	I	U	P	I	O	M
D	E	U	X	U	L	T	N	O	T
L	T	G	E	M	H	N	Q	D	T
D	R	C	N	H	I	E	U	T	G
N	E	P	L	U	E	L	F	R	Z
S	A	E	I	I	I	R	U	O	E
I	Q	U	A	T	R	E	O	I	R
X	S	R	B	D	U	A	L	S	O

1. zéro — 0 (zero)
2. deux — 2 (two)
3. trois — 3 (three)
4. quatre — 4 (four)
5. cinq — 5 (five)
6. six — 6 (six)
7. sept — 7 (seven)
8. huit — 8 (eight)

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WORD SEARCH 3

Numbers to 100 & Prices

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

T	R	E	N	T	E	S	T	T	A
E	V	S	E	L	S	I	U	O	I
U	I	A	L	E	O	T	S	I	U
U	N	F	P	I	I	E	L	I	S
C	G	G	M	L	X	G	F	U	O
R	T	U	H	A	A	U	S	I	N
A	U	P	C	F	N	H	G	T	R
E	C	E	N	T	T	U	A	U	L
E	G	P	G	A	E	C	P	S	R
Q	U	A	R	A	N	T	E	N	S

1. vingt — 20
2. trente — 30
3. quarante — 40
4. soixante — 60
5. cent — 100

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WORD SEARCH 4

Days, Months & Dates

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

D	J	P	I	E	T	I	R	L	B
V	A	S	S	A	M	E	D	I	O
E	N	A	I	E	L	O	I	S	D
N	V	G	L	A	I	U	H	A	I
D	I	T	U	A	D	R	F	U	M
R	E	R	N	P	N	G	P	M	A
E	R	T	D	N	D	E	C	A	N
D	M	A	I	P	L	I	C	R	C
I	J	E	U	D	I	F	C	D	H
L	M	E	R	C	R	E	D	I	E

1. **lundi** — Monday
2. **mardi** — Tuesday
3. **mercredi** — Wednesday
4. **jeudi** — Thursday
5. **vendredi** — Friday
6. **samedi** — Saturday
7. **dimanche** — Sunday
8. **janvier** — January

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WORD SEARCH 5

Colours & Clothes

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

C	L	E	N	O	F	R	O	S	E
S	L	L	S	R	S	G	A	I	M
R	N	U	T	A	D	B	G	S	A
N	T	E	R	N	U	B	O	S	R
T	E	U	R	G	E	C	T	U	R
A	I	U	B	E	E	S	N	U	O
R	O	U	G	E	F	D	O	S	N
A	L	D	E	J	A	U	N	E	L
O	L	R	M	U	C	A	P	T	C
S	T	L	D	O	I	D	T	N	D

1. rouge — red
2. jaune — yellow
3. rose — pink
4. orange — orange
5. marron — brown

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WORD SEARCH 6

Regular -er Verbs

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

I	H	E	C	O	U	T	E	R	A
E	E	F	J	O	U	E	R	O	I
C	B	L	N	N	L	I	P	G	M
L	P	A	R	L	E	R	N	N	E
T	L	P	L	L	D	N	A	I	R
L	O	H	A	B	I	T	E	R	N
L	S	H	H	N	U	F	D	M	S
R	E	G	A	R	D	E	R	A	I
H	L	C	H	E	R	C	H	E	R
E	D	M	A	N	G	E	R	E	L

1. **parler** — to speak
2. **aimer** — to like / to love
3. **habiter** — to live (somewhere)
4. **manger** — to eat
5. **regarder** — to watch / to look at
6. **écouter** — to listen (to)
7. **jouer** — to play
8. **chercher** — to look for

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WORD SEARCH 7

Asking Questions

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

D	C	O	M	B	I	E	N	H	D
Q	U	O	I	R	R	E	R	G	U
L	R	I	E	T	P	P	D	N	P
C	T	M	E	R	T	T	I	L	O
O	R	N	U	E	L	H	U	M	U
M	C	S	R	P	E	O	C	L	R
M	E	D	I	Q	U	A	N	D	Q
E	M	C	N	N	B	M	Q	N	U
N	U	U	T	L	E	D	U	H	O
T	M	S	O	U	U	R	I	E	I

1. **qui** — who
2. **quoi** — what (at the end)
3. **quand** — when
4. **comment** — how
5. **pourquoi** — why
6. **combien** — how much / how many

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WORD SEARCH 8

Prepositions of Place

Find and circle the words in the grid. They run left to right or top to bottom. The grid uses capital letters without accents.

T	D	P	F	L	O	F	R	D	U
D	F	U	S	U	R	U	E	E	I
E	D	A	N	S	E	F	S	V	E
R	D	I	E	N	U	R	P	A	N
R	G	L	P	R	U	L	D	N	T
I	E	L	N	U	L	M	S	T	R
E	I	S	U	H	L	G	L	O	E
R	M	H	E	E	S	O	U	S	C
E	G	D	S	P	P	E	S	F	R
A	L	G	B	G	E	R	S	F	H

1. **sur** — on
2. **sous** — under
3. **dans** — in, inside
4. **devant** — in front of
5. **derrière** — behind
6. **entre** — between

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SENTENCE PUZZLES

Rebuild each sentence

Write the correct order number under each word (first word = 1). Use the English meaning as a clue, then write the whole sentence on the line below.

1. My name is Léa.

m'appelle ◯ | Léa ◯ | Je ◯

2. I am sixteen.

ans ◯ | seize ◯ | J'ai ◯

3. I live in London.

à ◯ | Londres ◯ | J'habite ◯

4. I speak English.

anglais ◯ | parle ◯ | Je ◯

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5. I like music.

la ◯ J'aime ◯ musique ◯

6. Hello, how are you?

Bonjour ◯ allez-vous ◯ comment ◯

7. My name is Sophie.

m'appelle ◯ Je ◯ Sophie ◯

8. I'm twenty-five.

vingt-cinq ◯ J'ai ◯ ans ◯

9. How much is the croissant?

le ◯ combien ◯ croissant ◯ C'est ◯

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10. My birthday is on the tenth of May.

mai ○ | le ○ | c'est ○ | dix ○ | anniversaire ○ | Mon ○

11. It's three o'clock.

heures ○ | trois ○ | est ○ | Il ○

12. The train leaves at 6 pm.

heures ○ | dix-huit ○ | à ○ | train ○ | Le ○ | part ○

13. I have one sister and two brothers.

deux ○ | et ○ | frères ○ | une ○ | sœur ○ | J'ai ○

14. I'm looking for a white shirt.

une ○ | chemise ○ | blanche ○ | Je ○ | cherche ○

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15. The cakes are on the table.

gâteaux ○ | table ○ | Les ○ | sur ○ | la ○ | sont ○

16. I'd like some bread and some jam.

et ○ | confiture ○ | de ○ | pain ○ | voudrais ○ | Je ○ | du ○ | la ○

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APPENDIX

My French journal

Three new French words I learned today

A sentence about me in French

What I did today (in French)

A question I want to ask a French speaker

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APPENDIX

Blank copybook pages

The bold line is the baseline: letters sit on it. The dashed lines help you measure height.

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APPENDIX

Puzzle answers

Sentence puzzles

1. 2, 3, 1 — Je m'appelle Léa.

2. 3, 2, 1 — J'ai seize ans.

3. 2, 3, 1 — J'habite à Londres.

4. 3, 2, 1 — Je parle anglais.

5. 2, 1, 3 — J'aime la musique.

6. 1, 3, 2 — Bonjour, comment allez-vous ?

7. 2, 1, 3 — Je m'appelle Sophie.

8. 2, 1, 3 — J'ai vingt-cinq ans.

9. 3, 2, 4, 1 — C'est combien, le croissant ?

10. 6, 4, 3, 5, 2, 1 — Mon anniversaire, c'est le dix mai.

11. 4, 3, 2, 1 — Il est trois heures.

12. 6, 5, 4, 2, 1, 3 — Le train part à dix-huit heures.

13. 5, 4, 6, 2, 3, 1 — J'ai une sœur et deux frères.

14. 3, 4, 5, 1, 2 — Je cherche une chemise blanche.

15. 2, 6, 1, 4, 5, 3 — Les gâteaux sont sur la table.

16. 5, 8, 6, 4, 2, 1, 3, 7 — Je voudrais du pain et de la confiture.

Word search

1. Hello, Goodbye & Please

N	L	S	R	L	D	I	T	I	I
I	L	**P**	**A**	**R**	**D**	**O**	**N**	T	E
R	D	R	B	S	S	S	L	O	N
D	D	**B**	**O**	**N**	**J**	**O**	**U**	**R**	S
L	N	N	U	E	R	C	U	G	D
N	**O**	**N**	U	E	L	S	T	N	T
B	T	S	R	M	G	E	N	L	E
H	**M**	**E**	**R**	**C**	**I**	**O**	**U**	**I**	F
H	U	R	**B**	**O**	**N**	**S**	**O**	**I**	**R**
O	B	T	A	**S**	**A**	**L**	**U**	**T**	U

2. Numbers 0–20

N	E	S	U	F	U	**S**	I	T	S
I	L	E	N	S	E	**E**	**C**	N	E
L	E	S	S	I	U	**P**	**I**	O	M
D	**E**	**U**	**X**	U	L	**T**	**N**	O	T
L	T	G	E	M	H	N	**Q**	D	T
D	R	C	N	**H**	I	E	U	**T**	G
N	E	P	L	**U**	E	L	F	**R**	**Z**
S	A	E	I	**I**	I	R	U	**O**	**E**
I	**Q**	**U**	**A**	**T**	**R**	**E**	O	**I**	**R**
X	S	R	B	D	U	A	L	**S**	**O**

3. Numbers to 100 & Prices

T	**R**	**E**	**N**	**T**	**E**	S	T	T	A
E	**V**	S	E	L	**S**	I	U	O	I
U	**I**	A	L	E	**O**	T	S	I	U
U	**N**	F	P	I	**I**	E	L	I	S
C	**G**	G	M	L	**X**	G	F	U	O
R	**T**	U	H	A	**A**	U	S	I	N
A	U	P	C	F	**N**	H	G	T	R
E	**C**	**E**	**N**	**T**	**T**	U	A	U	L
E	G	P	G	A	**E**	C	P	S	R
Q	**U**	**A**	**R**	**A**	**N**	**T**	**E**	N	S

4. Days, Months & Dates

D	**J**	P	I	E	T	I	R	L	B
V	**A**	S	**S**	**A**	**M**	**E**	**D**	**I**	O
E	**N**	A	I	E	L	O	I	S	**D**
N	**V**	G	**L**	A	I	U	H	A	**I**
D	**I**	T	**U**	A	D	R	F	U	**M**
R	**E**	R	**N**	P	N	G	P	**M**	**A**
E	**R**	T	**D**	N	D	E	C	**A**	**N**
D	M	A	**I**	P	L	I	C	**R**	**C**
I	**J**	**E**	**U**	**D**	**I**	F	C	**D**	**H**
L	**M**	**E**	**R**	**C**	**R**	**E**	**D**	**I**	**E**

5. Colours & Clothes

C	L	E	N	**O**	F	**R**	**O**	**S**	**E**
S	L	L	S	**R**	S	G	A	I	**M**
R	N	U	T	**A**	D	B	G	S	**A**
N	T	E	R	**N**	U	B	O	S	**R**
T	E	U	R	**G**	E	C	T	U	**R**
A	I	U	B	**E**	E	S	N	U	**O**
R	**O**	**U**	**G**	**E**	F	D	O	S	**N**
A	L	D	E	**J**	**A**	**U**	**N**	**E**	L
O	L	R	M	U	C	A	P	T	C
S	T	L	D	O	I	D	T	N	D

6. Regular -er Verbs

I	H	**E**	**C**	**O**	**U**	**T**	**E**	**R**	**A**
E	E	F	**J**	**O**	**U**	**E**	**R**	O	**I**
C	B	L	N	N	L	I	P	G	**M**
L	**P**	**A**	**R**	**L**	**E**	**R**	N	N	**E**
T	L	P	L	L	D	N	A	I	**R**
L	O	**H**	**A**	**B**	**I**	**T**	**E**	**R**	N
L	S	H	H	N	U	F	D	M	S
R	**E**	**G**	**A**	**R**	**D**	**E**	**R**	A	I
H	L	**C**	**H**	**E**	**R**	**C**	**H**	**E**	**R**
E	D	**M**	**A**	**N**	**G**	**E**	**R**	E	L

7. Asking Questions

D	**C**	**O**	**M**	**B**	**I**	**E**	**N**	H	D
Q	**U**	**O**	**I**	R	R	E	R	G	U
L	R	I	E	T	P	P	D	N	**P**
C	T	M	E	R	T	T	I	L	**O**
O	R	N	U	E	L	H	U	M	**U**
M	C	S	R	P	E	O	C	L	**R**
M	E	D	I	**Q**	**U**	**A**	**N**	**D**	**Q**
E	M	C	N	N	B	M	**Q**	N	**U**
N	U	U	T	L	E	D	**U**	H	**O**
T	M	S	O	U	U	R	**I**	E	**I**

8. Prepositions of Place

T	D	P	F	L	O	F	R	**D**	U
D	F	U	**S**	**U**	**R**	U	E	**E**	I
E	**D**	**A**	**N**	**S**	E	F	S	**V**	**E**
R	D	I	E	N	U	R	P	**A**	**N**
R	G	L	P	R	U	L	D	**N**	**T**
I	E	L	N	U	L	M	S	**T**	**R**
E	I	S	U	H	L	G	L	O	**E**
R	M	H	E	E	**S**	**O**	**U**	**S**	C
E	G	D	S	P	P	E	S	F	R
A	L	G	B	G	E	R	S	F	H

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APPENDIX

Progress tracker

#	Lesson	Date	Quiz	✓
1	How French Sounds		/6	
2	The French Alphabet		/7	
3	Vowels & Accents		/7	
4	Silent Final Letters		/6	
5	Nasal Vowels		/7	
6	The French R, U and OU		/7	
7	Sound Spellings		/8	
8	Liaison & Elision		/7	
9	Reading Lab		/6	
10	Writing Letters & Accents		/7	
11	Common Spelling Patterns		/7	
12	Capitals & Punctuation		/7	
13	Apostrophes & Elision		/7	
14	Dictation Practice		/7	
15	Your First Sentences		/6	
16	Hello, Goodbye & Please		/7	
17	Introducing Yourself		/6	
18	Numbers 0–20		/7	
19	Numbers to 100 & Prices		/7	
20	Days, Months & Dates		/7	
21	Telling the Time		/7	
22	Family		/7	
23	Food & Drinks		/7	
24	Colours & Clothes		/7	
25	Home & Everyday Objects		/7	
26	Nouns & Gender		/7	

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#	Lesson	Date	Quiz	✓
27	Articles: the, a, some		/7	
28	Être: to be		/7	
29	Avoir: to have		/7	
30	Regular -er Verbs		/7	
31	Saying No: ne… pas		/7	
32	Asking Questions		/7	
33	Adjectives: Agreement & Placement		/7	
34	Possessives: my, your, his, her		/7	
35	Aller & the Near Future		/7	
36	Key Irregular Verbs		/7	
37	Pronouns: I, me, him, it		/7	
38	The Past (1): Passé Composé with Avoir		/7	
39	The Past (2): Passé Composé with Être		/7	
40	Prepositions of Place		/7	
41	At the Café		/6	
42	At the Restaurant		/6	
43	Shopping & the Market		/6	
44	Asking for Directions		/6	
45	Transport & the Train Station		/6	
46	At the Hotel		/6	
47	At the Doctor & Pharmacy		/6	
48	Phone Calls & Appointments		/6	
49	Making Plans with Friends		/6	
50	Small Talk & the Weather		/7	
51	Story 1: Léo's Morning		/6	
52	Story 2: Saturday at the Market		/6	
53	Story 3: A Weekend in Brussels		/7	
54	Songs & Rhymes		/6	

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#	Lesson	Date	Quiz	✓
55	Expressions & Proverbs		/7	
56	Culture: La Bise, Tu & Vous		/6	
57	Culture: Meals & the French-Speaking World		/7	
58	Final Review Lab		/8	

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